



INFERNO

Guelphs and Ghibellines
Vie for Tuscany

1259 - 1261

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Background Book

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Quickstart

START HERE if you are new to this game series! The Levy & Campaign system can be daunting to learn because it is hard to decide on selections during Levy before seeing at least once how a subsequent Campaign might unfold. Below we walk you through a “quickstart” setup for a short scenario that makes the initial Levy and Plan decisions for you, then offer some thoughts on Campaign strategy, so that you can jump right into Commanding your armies.

Cavallata per Cortona

Scenario A – Campaign/Levy/Campaign

Prepare

Follow sections 2.1 and 6.0 of the Rules of Play booklet to set up Scenario A, **Dolenti Note – 1259** found on page 27. Be sure to give Arts of War card F2 Event SURPRISE to the Guelph side. Then perform the following, representing the first Levy (3.0) and Plan (4.1). **NOTE:** If two players, **DO NOT READ** the other side's shaded sections or boxed cards below, as Held cards, Plan stacks, and strategy ideas would not be known to the opponent.

Then each side adds the following markers, pieces, and cards:

GUELPHS:

- At **Firenze's** mat, slide the purple Vassal marker showing two rectangular units (“Prato Comune” on back) up into the Forces area and add those units—1x Men-at-Arms and 1x Militia. (The Forces table on the foldout identifies which units are which.) In the Assets & Vassals area, add a third Cart by exchanging the 2x Carts marker for 3x Carts. Find and tuck Arts of War card F5 WAR ENGINEERS Capability under the mat's bottom edge as shown in the setup illustration below.
- At **Arezzo's** mat, slide both Vassal markers up and add their units—2x Berrovieri, 2x Armigeri, and 2x Militia. Put a blue “Feed x2” reminder marker somewhere on the mat (for the 11 units). Tuck card F9 BALESTRIERI along the bottom edge.

Guelph Held Events: Take Arts of War card F8 SWAMP as a drawn Event to add to SURPRISE.

GHIBELLINES:

- At **Siena's** mat, slide the Vassal showing two rectangular units (“Buonincontro Guastelloni”) into Forces area and add its 1x Men-at-Arms and 1x Militia units. Tuck cards S6 FEDITORI and S19 GUALDANA at the bottom edge.
- Muster **Provenzano**. Put his cylinder at Siena City, his yellow Service marker in box 4 of the Calendar, and his mat setup with its Forces, Assets, and Vassal markers near Siena's.

Ghibelline Held Event: Take Arts of War card S18 CORTONA as a drawn Event.

Next each side creates Plan stacks of Command cards as follows (4.1).

GUELPH PLAN: Stack facedown, top to bottom, Arezzo-Arezzo-Pass-Firenze-Firenze-Firenze-Arezzo (7 cards).

GHIBELLINE PLAN: Stack facedown, top to bottom, Pass-Siena-Siena-Provezano-Provenzano-Siena-Provenzano (7 cards).

Strategize

This scenario tees up Arezzo's historical dash to subdue rebels at Cortona.

GUELPH STRATEGY: With SURPRISE extra Forces, and a lucky draw of BALESTRIERI, Arezzo is set to go for a quick Storm of Cortona. Firenze is a way off and just gearing up but can move to support Arezzo if its Storm fails and the Ghibellines threaten eastward. Or Firenze with its WAR ENGINEERS can Besiege and perhaps take a Town by Siege, either the rebel Poggio Bonzio or a Ghibelline Stronghold across the dashed line. Lastly, just Taxing for a big Turn 2 purse can make sense.

GHIBELLINE STRATEGY: Together in the center, Siena can take both Lords against Arezzo or Firenze, or Provenzano can split off. The random draw of FEDITORI will help only if there is a Battle. But GUALDANA will yield more from Ravage (4.7.2), useful in Siege; note, though, that Grow will reduce Ravage VP (4.9.1). Play of CORTONA right away can grab a Treachery card for Turn 2, for which more Coin via Tax at Siena would help.

Start Play

Begin the Command Activation step of the first Turn's Campaign (4.2), referring to “Campaign”, 2nd bullet “Command”, on the foldout's Sequence of Play page and to Rules of Play 4.0 CAMPAIGN STEPS and 4.2 Command.

Flip the Guelphs' first Command card and select actions for the Lord shown on the card. Play through that card and then flip a Ghibelline card to take actions with that Lord, and continue alternating.

- To select actions, refer to the Commands page of the foldout and for details to Rules 4.3-4.7. Typical early Commands will be Supply (4.6), Forage (4.7.1), Tax (4.7.4), and/or March (4.3).
- If a Battle or Storm situation occurs, refer to the Forces and Strongholds / Battle and Storm side of the foldout and Rules sections 4.4 and 4.5.2, pages 14-17.

Continue play through the end of Turn 2, completing a Campaign, then a Levy, then a final Campaign. Congratulations and welcome to *Levy & Campaign*!

The opposite page shows the Quickstart setup of the gameboard and each side's Lord mats and Arts of War cards.

On Strategy

Here two ace playtesters give us their advice on skilful play of *Inferno*. For thoughts from the game's developers on that and more, see the Development Notes starting page 56.

Don't Abandon Hope!

Nine Strategy Tips for your Journey into the Heart of the *Inferno*

by Joe Dewhurst and Stephen Rangazas

Limbo – Your introduction to *Inferno*

Welcome ye to the cruel inferno of 13th-Century Tuscany, but do not yet abandon hope! While this third volume in the *Levy & Campaign* Series introduces some new concepts like Revolt and Treachery, it is in other respects simpler than its predecessors. The impact of Seasons is less severe than in *Nevsky*, the map is smaller than that of *Almoravid*, and there is (almost) only one kind of Transport to worry about. The feuding Guelphs and Ghibellines field practically symmetrical Forces and Capabilities, making it easier to remember what options might be available to your opponent. We will now guide you through the circles of this murky underworld, so that you will be prepared for your eventual ascent to victory and paradise.

Greed – Storming Castles and Besieging Towns and Cities

Before your Lords depart the safety of their Strongholds you must make sure that you have a plan for them, and that they are equipped accordingly. As in previous volumes, you have two main sources of victory points: Ravaging Enemy territory and conquering Enemy Strongholds. However, in *Inferno*, conquering Strongholds will also trigger Revolt rolls that can gain you additional victory points, and so conquering should form a central part of your strategy.

All three types of Stronghold boast strong Walls and formidable Garrisons, but the smaller Castles may still be vulnerable to Storm if you come prepared. Successfully Storming a Castle is a quick way to trigger a Revolt roll and gain a Treachery card, rewards you with Spoils, and places a Cavalieri unit in the other side's Captured Knights box, forcing your opponent at the end of the turn to either pay you a Coin or risk further Revolt or Treachery. A good selection of Capabilities is essential if you are planning to Storm Castles: F13-15/S13-15 PALVESARI or F21 DISTRINGITORES will help preserve your Forces, and either F9-11/S9-11 BALESTRIERI or F8/S8 BALESTRE GROSSE will provide you with armor-piercing missile attacks. Besieging Castles until they Surrender is of course also a viable option, albeit slower and not offering the additional reward of Spoils or Captured Knights.

The larger Towns and Cities are significantly harder to Storm, most likely requiring the investment of several Lords with some of the above capabilities, alongside F3/S3 SIEGE TOWERS and/or F4/S4 TREBUCHETS. A notable exception is offered by the Hold Event F3/S3 SURPRISE, which can allow you to successfully Storm a Town with a single well-prepared Lord and a fair bit of luck.

It is more likely that you will have to subject Enemy Towns and Cities to prolonged Sieges, either hoping for their eventual Surrender or building up strong enough Siegeworks to make Storming a viable proposition. Here, Capability F5/S5 WAR ENGINEERS can be crucial, allowing a single Lord to maintain a Siege at any Size Stronghold, although be careful that your solitary Lord does not become a target for Enemy attack or a victim of F7/S7 GREEK FIRE. Sieges can also directly trigger Revolts, via event F2/S2 BETRAYALS, but you will have to forego the powerful GUASTATORI Capability to have a shot at drawing this during the Arts of War phase.

Cust – When and Where to Ravage

The fertile Tuscan landscape in which *Inferno* takes place means that half of each side's Ravage markers will be removed at the end of every Spring and Autumn Turn. This makes Ravaging a much less attractive source of victory points, especially towards the start of longer scenarios, but it can still serve a purpose. The presence of a Ravage marker at a Siege can hasten the Garrison's Surrender while also providing the Besieging force with Provender and Loot that they can consume to prolong the Siege. You can even Ravage your own territory while Besieging traitor Strongholds, perhaps early enough in the game that you can plan on removing the Ravage marker at the end of a future Spring or Autumn turn.

Ravaging at Towns and Cities does cost two Command actions, but this can be reduced to zero with the Capability F20/S20 MASNADIERI, provided you don't mind giving up the Loot to these professional marauders. Any Lord with Berrovieri units or Capability F19/S19 GUALDANA will receive additional Provender and Loot when Ravaging, turning it into a viable way to sustain even a larger force. Towards the end of any scenario, Ravaging will become a safe way to stack up some additional victory points, especially when bolstered with F18/S18 LA CAVALLATA to more easily raid deeper into Enemy territory.

Heresy – Preparing for and against Revolts

The new Revolt system is central to *Inferno*, and positioning your forces to make best use of rolls on the Revolt table can be crucial for victory. Revolt rolls are triggered in several ways, including the Surrender or Sack of Enemy Strongholds, the permanent removal of Enemy Lords, and refusal to pay the Ransom for Captured Knights. However, to be eligible for Revolt when rolled on the table, an Enemy Stronghold must be either at or adjacent to one of your Lords or Allegiance markers (that is, another Stronghold that has already Revolted or Surrendered to you), and *not* at or adjacent to an Enemy Lord. This means that it can pay to be aggressive, as the more Lords and Allegiance markers you have in Enemy territory, the more likely you are to spread further Revolts. At the same time, an Enemy Lord or rebel Stronghold in your own territory can be a serious threat, and so it can be wise to crush dissent before it causes further trouble, even if that means Storming (and thus Ruining) an originally Friendly Castle.

Treachery – Using Treachery Cards

Treachery cards can be used for two purposes: attempting to persuade an Enemy Stronghold to Revolt, or Bribing Enemy Vassals to join you. Both require the Lord indicated on the card to be in the right position and have access to sufficient Coin (one Coin for Bribe and up to four Coin for Revolt, although these may be

provided by another Friendly Lord at the same location), and thus necessitate careful planning (if you reveal a Treachery card from your Command stack and are unable to use it, it is removed with no effect).

Podestà Lords are able to Tax for two Coin per Command card, and thus are especially well-suited for Treachery, although Treachery with other Lords can still be valuable if used at the right time. Treachery cards to try and trigger a Revolt are probably best used with four Coin, which has a 66% chance of success against a Castle, 44% chance of success against a Town, and approximately 30% chance against a City—and in each case you only have to pay the offered Coin if you succeed at the Revolt roll. The chance of Bribery succeeding depends on the Service Rating of the targeted Vassal, and is probably best used either to weaken a Lord who seems to be planning to attack you, or to bolster your own Forces before launching an attack or Storm.

There are several events that either trigger Revolt rolls or enhance Treachery cards, with a particularly notable effect on the fickle Towns of Grosseto, Volterra, and Cortona. It can be worth foregoing the Capabilities paired with some of these Events in order to maximize your chances of drawing them, or on the other hand stationing a Lord at or adjacent to these Towns if you are worried about their loyalty.

Gluttony – Keeping Large Armies in the Field

Both sides in *Inferno* are capable of Mustering very large armies, especially once the Podestà Lords of the two Leading Cities (Firenze and Siena) call up their Comuni for war. These armies can of course be very powerful, but it can also be a challenge to keep them supplied long enough to do anything useful with them.

There are a few key points to keep in mind when Mustering a large army, not least of which is to make sure you have a plan for what to do with it—perhaps Besieging a juicy Enemy Town or City, or intercepting an Enemy army before they can do the same to you. Next, you need to decide whether you will provide your army Provender, Coin, or more likely a mixture of the two. If the former, you will also need to bring along an adequate number of Carts, not just enough to carry some Provender but ideally enough also to enable efficient Supply actions reaching back to a Friendly Seat. (Remember that a Seat can Supply Provender up to its Size, provided you have enough Carts to carry it: one per Way traversed for each Provender gained.) If the latter, don't forget that a Podestà Lord will require two Coin for each Service shift, so you might be better off Supplying a Podestà with Provender and saving their Coin to Pay for the Service of any accompanying non-Podestà Lords once the Provender runs out.

There is a third option to Provender or Coin that a more desperate player should not be afraid to make use of—successful *Enemy Revolt* rolls allow you to shift the Service markers of your own Lords, as Exiles flock to your banners. So, you can end up in position to forego Feeding entirely, burning this excess Service to drive your vengeful armies forward on anger alone (especially towards the end of a scenario, when any additional Service will be wasted).

If you think that one of your Lords is going to come under Siege at their Seat, F1/S1 STORES & WELL WATER can keep them fed long enough for help to arrive, and it can even be Mustered by another (Unbesieged or Urban Army) Lord once another of your Lords is already under Siege. And you can Muster a Podestà Lord directly into his Main Seat even if Besieged—an essential way to prevent a Besieged Town or City from Surrendering. While Events are harder to plan around, there are also some that can either help or hinder Supply, such as F5/S5 ROAD WORKS to move faster and carry more Provender along Tracks and F12/S12 CAMP ATTACK or S19 BRIGANDS to steal Coin or Provender from an Enemy Lord.

Violence – When and How to Offer Battle

So far, we have focused primarily on Siege and Storm, and how to prepare for them, but you might occasionally find yourself in a position to seek out a field Battle. These are most likely to occur when one side wants to break a Siege, and the other side feels strong enough to stand and fight, especially if they are Holding some events that might turn the tide of Battle. While field Battles are very risky, they can also be used in the right circumstances just to weaken an Enemy force, especially if you are able to Withdraw into a Friendly Stronghold after Conceding, or if you have a Lord with excess Service from successful Enemy Revolts and can afford to lose a Battle without risking them permanently Disbanding or granting your opponent even more Revolt and Treachery.

Some Capabilities that are especially worth considering if you are planning for field Battle include F6-F7/S6 FEDITORI, F12/S12 ARMY RESERVE, F21 DISTRINGITORES, and of course BALESTRIERI paired with PALVESARI. Some crucial Events to Hold when preparing for Battle (and to beware of when seeking Battle) include F24/S24 DOCTORS, F4/S4 SUDDEN CLASH, F16 A BLOODY RED STREAM, S16 BOCCA DEGLI ABATI, and, if defending, F6/S6 HILLS and F8/S8 SWAMP.

Wrath – Declaring War and the Call to Arms

Both players are likely to be presented with the opportunity to declare war (a “Call to Arms”) at some point during a scenario, either from an Event effect or by trailing in score by at least four victory points. By declaring war, you are able to automatically Muster your Leading City's Podestà along with their Comune, free March any of your Lords towards your Leading City, and get an additional Muster segment with one Lord. However, your opponent will be able to do the same. Whether to declare Call to Arms is therefore an important choice, and ideally you will do so when your opponent is least able to make good use of the opportunities it presents.

The first case when you might want to declare war is *defensively*, if there is a large Enemy army bearing down on you and your Commander Podestà is not yet Mustered. In this case, your Enemy is less likely to want to use any of the steps of the Call to Arms, and you can use them to maximum effect. However, there is also room for declaring Call to Arms *offensively*, perhaps if you think you will be able to March your Commander and Comune to an Enemy Town or City and conquer it before help can arrive.

Of special note here is the opportunity for using your Commander and Comune fairly recklessly if you are four or more victory points behind—in this case you can potentially afford to declare Call to

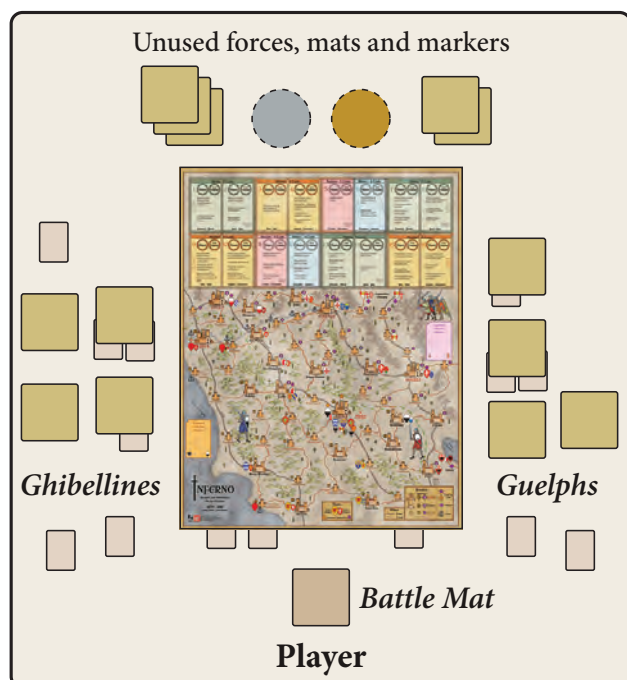
Arms several Turns in a row, your Commander and Comune attacking Enemy Lords or Storming Castles, safe in the knowledge that you can soon re-Muster them to restore their Forces. In this way, Call to Arms can offer an escape route for a player who is far behind on victory points and seems otherwise doomed to defeat.

fraud – Medieval Warfare is not always Rational, Predictable, or Honest

In closing, we want to emphasize that medieval warfare can be chaotic and unpredictable, driven by external factors and obscure cultural practices. Even the best laid plans may fall foul of poor die rolls or unexpected Events. Here, the Ghibellines might be able to take advantage of the deceptive FRIARS (S14) or the for-giving S13 GENTLE USILIA, while both players can hope for political and economic Events such as F21 PRIMO POPULO or S15 WAR LOANS that shift Lords' Service on either side. Or, they can take fate into their own hands and hope that their ASTROLOGERS (F24/S24) discern good fortune in the movement of the heavens. Whatever the outcome, your game of *Inferno* is sure to weave a rich and exciting narrative. We encourage you to dive in and enjoy the experience.

Solitaire

Inferno includes no solitaire system, but a single player readily can handle both sides. Set up the table as usual for the scenario and alternate in the Guelph and Ghibelline roles by the normal sequence of play. The only information that one side hides from the other will be Held Event cards (3.1.3) and Command Plan stacks (4.1). Keeping a side's cards face down can help you ignore them while playing the other side. Alternatively, keep all these cards face up throughout play—doing so somewhat alters decision-making, but the game will still work well. Either way, simply alternate making the best decisions that you can for each side with the information that you have available.



Explanations of Play

These explanations and examples, while not exhaustive, will help get you going with a walkthrough of most of the game's more common procedures with attention to tricky aspects and those new to this entry in Levy & Campaign. Rule references appear in parentheses. On Battle, see the Montaperti Minigame in the section after this one.

Muster and Disband

The main activity in the first half of each Turn (Levy, 3.0) is to build up your side's armies during the Muster segment (3.4). The Sequence of Play page of the foldout lists the options. Each Lord with his cylinder already on the map may participate, as long as they are at a Friendly Stronghold and not Besieged—once you are fighting in the midst of the enemy, too late to call for help!

- There is an exception to that restriction in *Inferno* called "Urban Army", to reflect how many Tuscan troops came from the cities. Half of the Lords in the game bear the title "Podestà" (mayor). These Lords may use their Lordship even while Besieged—if they are inside their "Main Seat" (the Lord's name and marked on the map with a pentagon icon, 1.3.1 SEATS).

Lord by Lord, each side during Muster uses actions equal to that Lord's Lordship rating (1.5.3, usually "2" or "3"). Each action can add one thing: a Cart, a card, a Vassal, or another Lord.

Muster Transport. One Levy action can simply add one Cart (1.7, 3.4.3) to Assets area of that Lord's mat (1.5.2). Carts help Lords during Campaign gather Provender using Supply Commands (4.6.1 TRANSPORT) and to carry that Provender with them as they March (4.3.2).

- A Levy action by the Podestà of Pisa, a Ghibelline Lord, uniquely may add a Ship instead of a Cart. With Ships, he can add Provender from Ports (1.3.1 PORTS, 4.6.2) and can Sail (4.7.3).

Muster a Capability. Alternatively, a Levy action can buy a card from the Arts of War deck (1.9.1, 3.4.4). The draw is not random: you can shop for the card you want, but it is always the more permanent bottom-half "Capability" that you get. If that text says "This Lord" in bold-italics, tuck the card under the bottom edge of that Lord's mat, showing that only the lower-half text is in play. There is room there for just two cards, so any third card at a mat gets discarded. If the card does not say "This Lord", tuck under the board edge—it can help several Lords at the same time.

- Not every Lord can Levy every card: you have to check the Coat-of-Arms icon on the bottom left of the card to be sure that the Levying Lord is able to obtain it.
- Also, you can't Levy any Capabilities on any cards that you currently Hold as Events (1.9.1, 3.1.3). And you may only discard Arts of War cards at certain times (4.0, 3.3.1, 4.9.6).

Muster a Vassal. A third Levy option is to add Forces from a Lord's Vassal (3.4.2). Typically, a Lord will have Vassal Service markers face up in his "Assets & Vassals" mat area, awaiting Muster (1.5.1 VASSAL MARKERS, 3.4.1 MUSTERING). Select and slide a marker up into the "Forces" area and add the units it shows (1.6, the back of the marker also lists them).

- Unlike earlier *Levy & Campaign* volumes, *Inferno* requires a check before a Vassal Musters: you have to find the Vassal Seat on the map (1.3.1 SEATS), usually at one of that Lord's Seats. That Vassal may Muster only if its Seat is Friendly to your side (1.3.1 ALLEGIANCE). The front of the Vassal marker has that Lord's large Coat of Arms and the smaller Vassal Seat Coat of Arms. There is a player aid sheet that lists all the Lords, Vassals, and Seats to help you find what you need.
- There are some "Special Vassals" that break the usual Muster procedure, as explained in the relevant rules sections (1.5.1 SPECIAL VASSALS MARKERS, 3.4.2, 3.5.3). A colored band around the edge of their marker and an added purple or tan symbol distinguish them.

Muster a Lord. Finally, Lords can Levy other Lords. Each Levy action may roll a die against any Ready Lord's Fealty rating (1.5.1)—a die symbol on the target Lord's mat, also shown on his Service marker. If the roll is equal to or less than the die shown, that Lord Musters: put his cylinder on the map at one of his Seats, put his Service marker on the Calendar ahead a number of boxes equal to his Service rating—showing when he will have to Disband (3.3)—and set up his mat (1.5.2). If the roll is higher, the Levy action is wasted.

- "Ready Lord" means his cylinder is on the Calendar in the current Turn's box or to the left (at an earlier box in time). But there is another Podestà exception in *Inferno*: if any Enemy Lords are at a Podestà's Main Seat, he is always Ready (3.4.1 Emergency Army).

- A price paid for an urban army is that it is harder to Muster a Podestà if his Main Seat is Enemy aligned: in that case, you can Muster him at another of his Seats, but it costs two Levy actions per roll (3.4.1 Exile Army).

As with Vassals, a Mustering Lord needs a free Seat to receive his cylinder: it may not be Enemy occupied or aligned (it may be Bypassed, 4.3.5).

- A Podestà gets an "Urban Army" exception here too (3.4.1 FEALTY ROLL): he can Muster right into a Siege at his Main Seat!

Podestà Muster (3.4)

- **Urban:** Podestà can use Lordship and be Mustered at his Besieged Main Seat.
- **Emergency:** Podestà always Ready if Enemy Lords at his Main Seat.
- **Exile:** Use 2 actions to roll Muster of Podestà whose Main Seat is Enemy.

NOTE: The Sequence of Play foldout page lists the Podestà Muster exceptions in a gray box to the right of "Muster" and "Call to Arms".

EXAMPLE: Let's look at all these Podestà exceptions in a sample situation. Here, the City of Lucca has gone over to the Ghibellines, while a big Ghibelline army Besieges Firenze, with Guido Guerra inside. Guelph Arezzo's army has Marched up to Figline Castle in hopes of lifting the Siege of Firenze. It is the Levy of June-July 1260. On the Calendar, Lucca's Podestà is Ready while Firenze's not quite yet.

Guelph Lords on map Muster first (3.4). Guido Guerra may not participate: he is Besieged and, since he is not a Podestà at his Main Seat, Urban Army does not apply. If Firenze's Lord were in



the City with him, Firenze could use Levy actions as an Urban Army—Firenze City is the Main Seat for the Podestà of Firenze—but Firenze's cylinder awaits on the Calendar, so cannot use Levy actions.

Arezzo's Lord, however, is at a Friendly Locale (Figline) and so can use his Lordship (shown on his mat as "2"). Arezzo will attempt Muster Lords to the fight.

- Lucca is Ready in the current Turn's box. However, Lucca is a Podestà (written on his mat), and his Main Seat is Enemy. He would therefore Muster (at his second Seat, Altopascio) as an "Exile Army": it would use up Arezzo's entire two Lordship to roll once.
- Instead, Arezzo could use one action to roll to Muster Firenze's Lord—even though Firenze's cylinder is right of the current Turn on the Calendar—as an "Emergency Army" because Ghibelline Lords are at Firenze's Main Seat (the City of Firenze). If the die roll is successful (equal to or less than a "5", the Fealty shown on Firenze's mat), the Guelph player could place Firenze's cylinder at Firenze's Prato Seat (or perhaps Poggio Bonizio further south) or even inside the Besieged Firenze City as an "Urban Army". The City Size limits the number of cylinders that fit inside to "3" (1.3.1 Strongholds, 4.3.4 WITHDRAW, 4.3.5), not a problem here.

If Arezzo rolled for Firenze to Muster and failed on a "6", Arezzo could use his second action to try again (or Levy something else). If Mustered, Firenze's Service marker would go three Turns ahead (his Service rating shown on his Service marker and mat), into box 12.

If Arezzo did successfully Levy either Lucca or Firenze to Muster, that newly arrived Lord would not yet get to Levy anything else (3.4 REQUIREMENTS). (He would still be busy assembling his core army.)

Also, in this situation, none of the Ghibelline Lords would participate in Muster, as none is at a Friendly Locale.

Call to Arms

Occasionally, players can trigger an added Levy sequence that follows Muster and can build the opposing armies up even further. A side may declare such a Call to Arms if it is at least four Victory Points behind the other (2.2.5, 5.1). If a side drew a "WAR" Event that Turn, or if the Guelphs are Holding and decide play F23 TREASURERS and pay two Coin, that side can declare Call to Arms regardless of Victory score.

- So, after the Ghibellines complete their Muster segment (3.4), check whether anyone can trigger Call to Arms, by VP score or cards.
- It does not matter who declares or how many times—if any Call to Arms occurs that Turn, each side follows the procedure once, Guelphs then Ghibellines.
- The only time that the order of declaring Call to Arms might matter is if the Ghibellines are able to do so and the Guelphs are Holding TREASURERS—in that case, the Guelph player is allowed to wait until the Ghibellines have decided whether or not to declare before committing the Guelph card and Coin.

If someone does declare Call to Arms, see the Sequence of Play sheet, "Call to Arms" steps [a] to [d]. The Guelphs proceed through the steps (all optional) then the Ghibellines may do so.

Gather. Call to Arms starts with a free March opportunity (3.5.1), generally aimed at gathering a side's armies at or nearer to the Leading City—Firenze or Siena (marked by a star icon, 1.3.1 SEATS). Each Lord as desired may March (4.3) as if using his entire Command rating (the number shown on his cylinder, plus any modifications), but without expending any Provender or Loot to Feed (4.8.1). (The community is supporting the war.)

- A hitch is that Gathering Lords may not enter any Locale where there is an Enemy Lord or Stronghold unless that Enemy is already Bypassed or Besieged (4.3.5). Also, any Lord that does March must end up closer to his Leading City (though he does not have to arrive there). See the Call to Arms example below.

Commander to Arms. Next there is an opportunity to Muster the side's Commander—the Podestà of Firenze or of Siena, who will lead an army of several Lords on March (4.3.1)—at the Leading City (3.5.2). If he is already on the map, he may first Disband (3.3.2) as a handy way to get him back into his City. The player will have to consider that the Commander might already be in a useful place on the map and that Disbanding would give up any already added Vassal Forces, Assets, and Capability cards.

Either way, the Commander may then immediately Muster there by the usual rules (3.4.1)—except that his cylinder may be in any Calendar box.

- "By the usual rules" means that it will not be possible for him to Muster if his Leading City is Enemy aligned. Per the usual Podestà exceptions (3.4.1 Urban Army), as his Leading City is also his Main Seat, he may Muster under Siege (if there is room, 4.3.4 WITHDRAW).

Comune. Next, if the Commander is now on the map at his Leading City (however he got there), the player may mobilize up to all the republic's militias for the war, in what the game calls the "Comune" (1.5.1, 3.5.3). The Comune adds a second Firenze or Siena cylinder stacked beneath the Commander on the map and adds a second mat to hold Special Vassal Forces—but for purposes outside of Siege and combat (such as March, 4.3, or Feed, 4.8.1), the two together still act as a single Lord. The Comune will stay with the Commander until he Disbands or is removed by combat or until the Comune loses all its units (3.3, 4.4.5, 1.6).

This step of Call to Arms is the only way in the game that a Comune gets into play. **NOTE:** *Later Muster can add more of its Special Vassals if some remain Ready and the Commander is still or once again at his Leading City (3.4.1 SESTIERI/TERZI.)*

- Mustering the Comune, like each of the four steps of a Call to Arms, is voluntary. And you don't have to Muster all its Special Vassals (though often players will do so). However, if you do Muster the Comune, you are required to Muster at least its "Carroccio" and one other (a "Sestiere" if Firenze or "Terzo" if Siena, with a die roll).
- As with the Commander, there must be room in the Leading City for the Comune cylinder in the special case of Muster "Urban Army" into Siege.



Firenze's mighty communal army—Podestà Commander and his Comune just after Muster of each.

Allies. Finally, the side may have one of its Lords on the map (it could be the Commander) who can use his Lordship to carry out that number of Levy actions by the usual rules (3.4)—including rolling other Lords' Fealty to Muster them. Alternatively, the side can Muster any one of its Lords by the usual rules (3.4.1, including needing to be Ready on the Calendar) with automatic Fealty success.

EXAMPLE: Let's continue the situation from the Muster example. The Guelphs Muster Lucca at Altopascio, leaving Firenze on the Calendar. Let's say they were able to declare a Call to Arms and did so.

Guelph Call to Arms is first. For the Gather step (3.5.1), options with the Lords shown are as follows:

- Guido Guerra cannot March: he is already as close to the Guelph Leading City as he can get—he's inside—and is anyway Besieged (prohibiting any March, 4.3).

- The Podestà of Arezzo similarly is stuck in place: already adjacent to Firenze, the only way to get closer would be to enter, but the Ghibelline Lords there prevent that under the restrictions of Gather.
- Lucca's army at Altopascio could March to Montecatini and/or on to Prato. But the player decides instead to move a little south at a safer distance: Lucca Marches via San Miniato to Empoli. Lucca could not have stopped at San Miniato because such a March would have failed to end closer to Firenze.

For Commander to Arms (3.5.2), there is no Disband option, as the Commander remains on the Calendar. (The player knew Call to Arms was coming, so did not use up Lordship to Muster him.) Regardless of whether the Unmustered Commander is Ready (3.4.1), he may now Muster at Firenze. Since Firenze is his Main Seat, he can Muster Besieged (as an Urban Army). The Guelph player decides to do so, setting up the Firenze Podestà mat and



placing the cylinder in Firenze and Service marker on the Calendar in box 12.

For the Comune step (3.5.3), the Commander is now in his Leading City and there is room (just barely, as the Comune will be the third cylinder inside the Size-3 City). The player decides to Muster the Comune, putting that cylinder under the Firenze Commander cylinder at Firenze (similar to the Lower Lord under a Lieutenant) and setting up the Firenze Comune mat with its Carroccio and at least one Sestiere marker and their units in the Forces area plus the Assets indicated. The player may now automatically Muster as many of the remaining five Sestieri as desired and decides to Muster all of them, adding those markers and units also to the Comune mat's forces.

Lastly, the Allies step of Call to Arms enables the Guelphs to Muster yet more fighting strength. Firenze (as an Urban Army), Arezzo, or Lucca could now use their Lordship to Levy Lords, Carts, Vassals, and/or Capability cards, for example, and Firenze could do so to add cards to either of its mats. Guido Guerra, who is Besieged and does not qualify as an Urban Army, could not be chosen to use Levy actions. As a side note, Lucca could not Muster its Obizzi Vassal because that Vassal's Seat—the blue-and-white striped Coat of Arms at the City of Lucca—is currently Enemy (3.4.2).

The Ghibelline player would now get to carry out the same series of steps, perhaps Marching Lords south from the Siege of Firenze south toward Siena—or not—and perhaps Disbanding Siena's Commander to re-Muster him at his home City—or not—and so on.

March

Once on Campaign, your armies will want to move across the map—March (4.3). Having stacked various Lords' Command cards into a Plan (4.1), you will flip up a Lord's card to give him the number of Command actions shown (4.2.1, per his Command Rating, 1.5.3). A single action to March, in general, moves a Lord from his Locale to an adjacent Locale, crossing one Way (Road or Track). If the Lord is a Commander, or if during Planning you have made him a Lieutenant leading a second Lord (4.1.3), he can (or, if the latter, must) move Lords in a group (4.3.1).

That's all simple enough. The tricky bits that you have to check for as you March a Lord are these:

- **Laden?** Provender and Loot Assets on a Lord's mat can slow him down. If he has no Loot and no more Provender than Carts—or up to twice as much Provender as Carts along a Road only—he is “Unladen” (4.3.2). If he has Loot—and/or up to twice as much Provender as Carts along Track—can still March, but he is “Laden”. If he has over twice as much Provender as Carts, he can't March at all—even on Road—unless he dumps some (allowed when an aid to March, 1.7.2 Greed).
- **Speed?** If a Lord is able to March, there are two exceptions to using one action per Way (per adjacent Locale). The first March action on any Command card is free—zero actions—if Unladen and completely along Road (4.3.3). That means even a Lord with twice the Provender as Carts can March free along a Roadway, once per card—Tuscany has good roads, by medieval standards. Laden March, in contrast, always costs two actions

to move a single way—and a Lord often will have only two Command actions per card!

Lords moving together Share their Carts to help the whole group along (1.5.2). So with a Commander or a Lieutenant, just consider all their Loot, Provender, and Carts in total.

The handy reference for all this is the Commands page of the foldout. The March line near the top summarizes the entire March Command rules section, and the brown line near the bottom tells how to determine if a Lord is Laden.

Approach. The other potential complication of Marching a Lord is, what happens if he enters a Locale with an Enemy, either an Enemy Lord or Stronghold or both? Enemy Lords have an immediate decision to make: do they Avoid Battle by immediately moving to an adjacent Locale (with some restrictions, see rule 4.3.4 AVOID BATTLE), Withdraw into their Stronghold at that Locale (if they have one), or stand and fight?

- Avoiding away will force the Enemy Lords to leave behind anything they can't carry Unladen and to Feed at the end of the Command card, while Withdrawing into a Stronghold can trap them in a Siege—so the choice may not be easy.

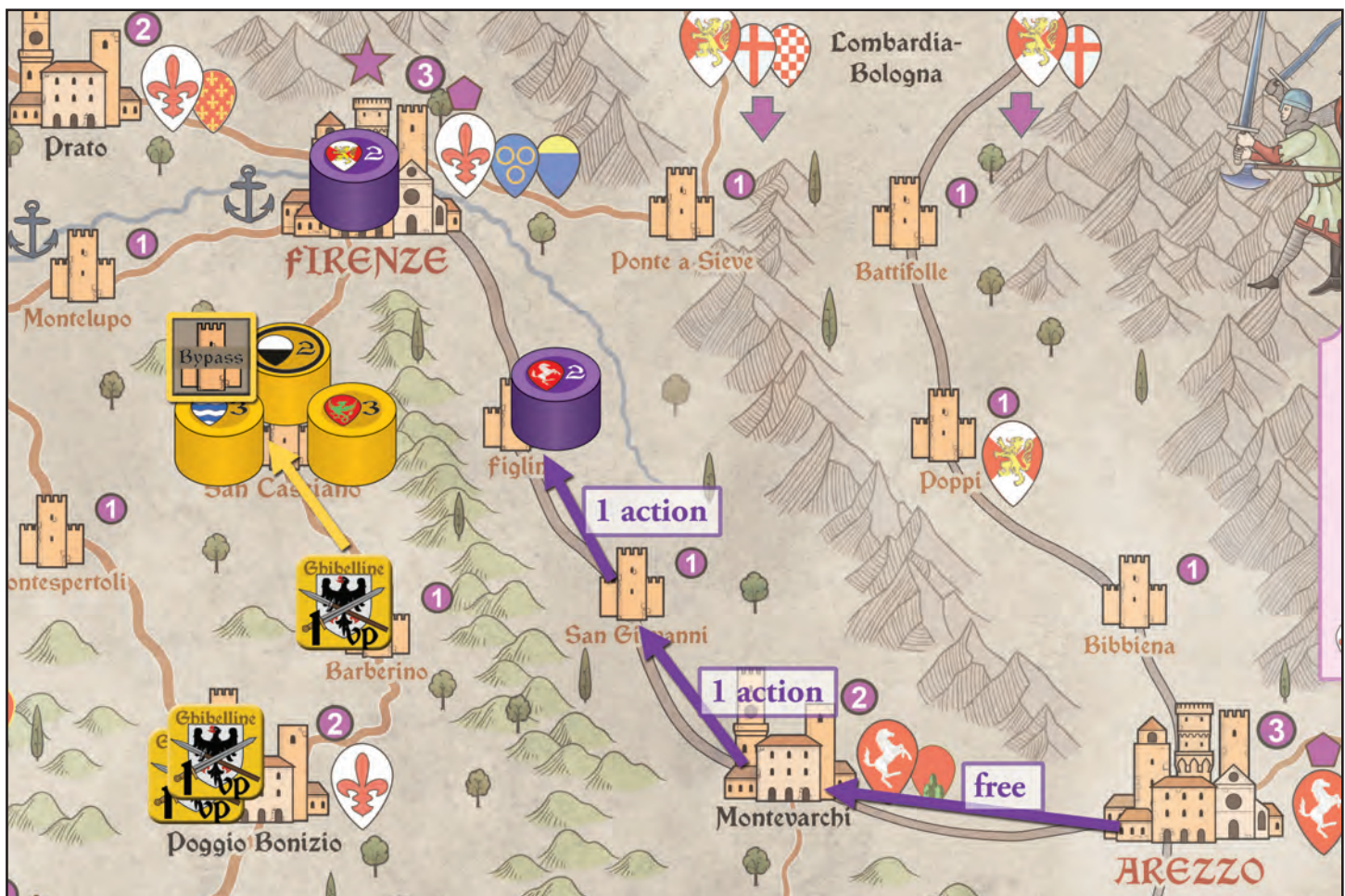
Besiege or Bypass? Once your Marching Lord is outside an Enemy Stronghold and, by whatever circumstances, there are no Enemy Lords outside it there, you have a choice of either Besieging or Bypassing it (4.3.5). Besieging it gives you an immediate Siege marker, free! Bypassing just marks your Lord with a Bypass marker without starting a Siege. Either way, you have to stop Marching for that card.

- So why ever Bypass instead of Besieging? Siege (like Battle and Storm) ends that Command card even if actions remain unused. Bypass—while ending the March—still allows remaining actions in place, often Supply, Forage, or Ravage (see the next explanation section).

Feed. As your Lords March, remember that they will have to Feed—consume Provender or Loot or suffer an adverse Service shift on the Calendar—at the end of the card (4.3 MOVED/FOUGHT, 4.8.1). You don't actually have to mark Marching Lords with the blue “Moved/Fought” markers, once you are in the habit of Feeding them after their actions on that card are done. See the Sequence of Play page of the foldout, “Feed/Pay/Disband” under “Campaign” and the “Feed” tonebox to the right.

EXAMPLE: Let's see how March works in practice. Look again at the movement of Lucca's army from Altopascio to Empoli in the previous illustration. It was a part of Gathering (3.5.1), a move as if each Lord used an entire Command card to March. Lucca just Mustered (3.4.1); as you may have noticed, Lord mats always start with enough Carts to carry any Provender they have, and none start with Loot. So Lucca is Unladen (4.3.2). With two Command actions, Lucca can March two adjacent Locales. The bit of Road along the way does not increase Speed (does not enable a first March for zero actions) because the Way from Altopascio to San Miniato is partly Track (4.3.3).

Let's rewind our situation a bit to see how Arezzo got its army to Figline Castle, nearer to the apparent crisis at Firenze. The Podestà of Arezzo had Mustered at his City and stocked up some



Provender with Supply actions, looking to press south into Ghibelline territory. But now the enemy is threatening Firenze, and Arezzo will March to that City's aid. Arezzo's Lord can March with up to two times as much Provender as he has Carts (4.3.2 Laden); for example, with his mat's starting complement of "Cart x2", he could take along "Prov x4". If he overdid the Supply and has more Provender than that, he could discard the excess upon Marching (1.7.2).

The good news is that the way from Arezzo to Firenze is all well-maintained Roadway. So, even with Provender equal to double his Carts, he will March Unladen. And, along that Road, his first March to Montevarchi—as he is Unladen—will cost none of his two available Command actions (4.3.3). Using his two Commands to March toward Firenze (with nothing Enemy in the way) gets him three Locales closer.

The Ghibelline army nearing Firenze through hostile territory has it a bit harder—and not only because they are Marching along poorer Trackway. On their route north, they passed through the Friendly Town of Poggio Bonizio to Besiege but then suffered the delay of a Siege to gain Barberino Castle. Siena's Commander now Marches his group (4.3.1) Unladen to the next Enemy Stronghold, San Casciano. There he chooses to Bypass rather than Besiege the Stronghold: he stops with an action left—perhaps to bring up Supply from Siena or to Ravage the Enemy Locale. The army doesn't care about Besieging the Castle, as it intends a rapid (and rather wanton) advance on Firenze. On the next Ghibelline

card, the active Lord (or group, if Siena) can March on to Firenze, where Guido Guerra will have to decide whether to back away, hide inside the walls, or fight (4.3.4). Note that a Ghibelline Lord left behind Bypassing San Casciano would give their Lords at Firenze a Supply Route south to Siena (4.6.1).

Supply, forage, and Ravage

Lords in *Levy & Campaign* must sustain their armies with Proviender as they move and fight (4.8). OK, you can just pay Coin instead (4.8.2)—but Coin is harder to come by and is useful for many other things, such as Treachery (4.7.5-4.7.6).

Supply. The most reliable way to replenish Provender is by Supply Commands (4.6). The Provender comes from the active Lord's own un-Ruined Seats ("Sources", 4.6.1). Medieval Tuscany supplies abundant food and other military consumables: each Seat can yield a number of Provender per Supply action equal to its Size, or one if an Outpost (1.3.1 LOCALES). You can see that, at or near their home, an army can Supply itself with a pile of Provender rather quickly (to a limit of "Prov" x16, 1.7.3).

But to Supply his army further afield, a Lord will need to bring Supply to it—one purpose of Carts (the other being to haul Provender along as he Marches, 4.3.2). For each point of Provender along each Way segment from a Lord's cylinder on the map back to a Source (a "Supply Route", 4.6.1), that Lord must have (or Share, 1.5.2) one Cart (4.6.1 TRANSPORT). Often, it is this Transport limit that determines how many Provender each Sup-

ply action adds, rather than the Source limit. See the Supply example below.

Enemies can interfere with Supplies moving along a Route, so take care that your hungry army is not cut off from home by Enemy Lords or Strongholds! And if you become Besieged—cut off from your farming land—you'll need a STORES & WELL WATER card (1.9.1) to Supply at all.

There is another Source of Supply: Pisa alone, a great naval power, can obtain and move Provender by Ship, via Ports (4.6.1-.2)—all the way up the Arno River to its foe, Firenze! (See also Sail, 4.7.3.)

Forage. What if you are too far from home to bring up Supply? Then you can try to live off the land. Forage Commands yield just a single Provender per action, and not always guaranteed (4.7.1). A Ravaged Locale yields no Forage, nor does a Stronghold that is Besieged by enough Enemy Lords. Finally, the Season matters: Summer Forage is automatic, while Forage during Spring or Autumn yields Forage only on a 50-50 die; in Winter the harvest is in and has been stored and not yet eaten, so Forage is reliable but only at Friendly Strongholds.

Ravage. A final option to Feed your army is to live off the land *with severity*. You can Ravage enemy ground (4.7.2), including at a Stronghold in your own territory that is rebelling against you (bears Enemy Allegiance markers, 1.3.1). Often, you will Ravage for other reasons anyway—to score VP by punishing the other side (5.1) or to encourage Surrender of a Besieged Stronghold (4.5.1). In that case, the Provender that you obtain is gravy!

There is more to steal at larger population centers, which takes time to gather up and also faces more resistance by local guards. So, Ravage costs two Command actions at Towns and Cities, just one at a Castle. But at a Town or City, you get not just a Provender but also Loot (1.7). The Loot will slow down your March (4.3.2-.3), but your army either can eat it as if Provender or—if you get it to Friendly ground where your troops can stow it—it will extend their Service (3.2.2 Pay with Loot).

Italian Berrovieri troops are masters at Ravage: if your active Lord has any of these units (1.6), double the take to Prov x2 plus, at a Town or City, Loot x2 (4.7.2). There are also various Arts of War cards to sharpen rapacity: see F18/S18 LA CAVALLATA, F19/S19 GUALDANA, and F20/S20 MASNADIERI.

Ravage adds a ½VP marker to the map, a maximum of one at a Locale. Ravage markers, in addition to their effect on the Victory score, aid Siege by adding to the die-roll range needed for Surrender (4.5.1 Siege SURRENDER). Be aware though:

- The Ravage markers you place—and so who gets the ½VP—is always opposite to the Locale's printed Allegiance (4.7.2, 1.3.1). If you Ravage rebel holdings, it still hurts your side's economy!
- Ravage markers will block any Forage there.
- Half of the Ravage markers you place (along with their VP) will disappear periodically, as the fertility and productivity of Tuscany heal the land (4.9.1 Grow).



EXAMPLE: After Lucca Sacked some Castles in Pisa's environs to Ruins, the Pisan army backed by the Count of Santa Fiora seek revenge. The Ghibellines Besiege Lucca's army inside its City. Count Giordano is on the way to reinforced them.

Santa Fiora on his Command card cannot achieve anything yet by Siege—there are too few Besieging Lords to add Siege markers, and Lucca will not Surrender with a Lord inside (4.5.1). So the Count chooses instead to build up the Besiegers' stores. Supply would require an unblocked Route to his distant Seat in the region's south and Carts for each Provender all along the way. It's Summer, so his two Command actions could Forage twice for a guaranteed Prov x2 (4.7.1). Instead, greedy for more and looking ahead to forcing Lucca's Surrender, he Ravages. His two actions (at a City) place a Ravage marker that adds ½VP to the Ghibelline score. He thereby takes advantage of his Berrovieri Forces, doubling the usual take at the City to Prov x2 plus Loot x2 (4.7.2). Now Ravaged, the Locale will offer no more Forage to the (not yet fully blockaded) Luccans—nor to the Besiegers, though.

The next Ghibelline Command card is Pisa's. The player wants to continue to build up the army's Provender: Pisa will Supply.



Pisa has two nearby Seats—Pisa City and Pontedera (a third Pisan Seat lies far to the south). Pontedera is not a Stronghold anymore but Ruins, so it cannot serve as a Supply Source. That's a pity, because Pontedera is just two Ways away via San Miniato: Giordano's Bypass of that Enemy Stronghold would hold the Supply Route open (4.6.1 Sources and Routes).

Fortunately, the City of Pisa alone can Supply up to three Provender per action. The Route via Vecliano is blocked—that Castle is Enemy. However, that by Friendly Vicopisano will do: Ruins along a Route don't block Supply.

In addition, Pisa has Ships, and there are Ports nearby. San Miniato is a Port and even closer to the active Lord than is his Pisa Seat. A Port, as part of the Supply Route, must be Friendly, Besieged, or Bypassed (Ruins again do not matter)—Giordano can secure the river landings outside the walled Guelph Town!

With the Seat at the Size-3 City of Pisa plus the three Ships on Pisa's mat, a single Supply action draws a potential maximum of Provender x6. Pisa's Carts must get them to the Lord, however.

The distance of two Ways to Pisa City calls for two Carts for each Provender brought up (4.6.1 TRANSPORT), while the distance of one to San Miniato's Port requires just one Cart per Prov. The Pisa and Santa Fiora Lords are together at the same Locale, so Santa Fiora Shares his two Carts with Pisa (1.5.2) for a total of 6x Carts. Six Carts could bring all three Provender the two Ways from Pisa City. Alternatively, three of the Carts can bring all three Provender (for 3x Ship) from San Miniato, leaving enough—two of the remaining Carts x3—to bring just one more Provender from the City. Each Supply action by Pisa's Podesta thus adds Prov x4 to his mat, to a maximum of 16.

What about Provender for the Guelphs here? We noted earlier that—until Size-3 Lucca City comes under Siege by three Enemy Lords—the Podesta inside could Forage (4.6.1). But Santa Fiora's Ravage has put an end to that. Can Besieged Lucca draw Supply?

Supply 	Must have Route to Source(s).
Forage 	Besieged if STORES & WELL WATER.
Ravage 	Not at Ravaged.
	Besieged only if by fewer Lords than Stronghold Size.
	Enemy Locale.
	Not at Ravaged.
	2 actions if Town/City. x2

Generally, no, you can't use Supply Commands if Besieged. Note the light-toned boxes on the Commands page of the foldout: they point to the options for a Besieged Lord. There is such an exception for Besieged Supply: STORES & WELL WATER on Arts of War card F1 (1.9.1). If the Guelphs have or Levy that Capability, the Lord of Lucca would be able to Supply (from Lucca alone, not Altopascio) for Prov x4 per action, even Besieged!



Siege and Storm

The main way to get Victory Points in *Inferno* is to change the Allegiance of Strongholds, Ruin them, and Ravage their Locales (1.3.1 VP MARKERS). A key way to achieve the first two is to Besiege a Stronghold in order to obtain a Surrender to your side or to prepare for a successful Storm to Ruin it.

Siege. A Siege can commence whenever a Lord (or group of them) Approaches an Enemy Stronghold (Marches into its Locale, 4.3.4-4.3.5). The Besiegers get the first Siege marker for free, as part of their March. Then, typically, they will use Siege actions to add Siege markers, to a maximum of four, to increase the chances

of Surrender, lay the groundwork for Storming the Enemy's walls, and/or—if any Enemy Lord is inside—to starve him out.

Siegecraft takes time: a Siege action (4.5.1) uses up an entire Command card of any one of the Besieging Lords—which usually provides several actions equal to that Lord's Command Rating, usually “2” or “3” (4.2.1).

- There is another requirement too: Besiegers only get to add a marker if they have at least as many Lord cylinders there (counting any Comune) as the Size of the Stronghold (1.3.1 Strongholds, 4.5.1 SIEGEWORKS). In effect, the Besiegers need more manpower to blockade a bigger place.

Would Besiegers ever use a Siege action with fewer Lords there than Stronghold Size? Yes, they might:

- If there is no Enemy Lord inside the Besieged Stronghold (only its Garrison is defending it, 4.5.2 STRONGHOLD EFFECTS), Siege actions before adding any marker cause a Surrender roll regardless of the number of Besieging Lords. Roll a number of dice equal to the Stronghold's Size: if each die rolls equal to or less than the number of Siege plus Ravage markers (4.7.2) there, the Stronghold Surrenders and joins the Besiegers' side (4.5.1 SURRENDER?). See the next example.
- If there are any Enemy Lords inside, there will be no Surrender yet. However, each Siege action causes all Lords at the Locale (Besiegers and Besieged) to Feed—either using up Provender and Loot or shortening Service to bring on Disband (4.5.1 MOVED/FOUGHT, 4.8.1 UNFED). In this way, if the army outside the Stronghold has a better source of Provender than that inside, the Besiegers can hope to use Siege to starve the Enemy into a Surrender once any Besieged Lords Disband.

Storm. Attacking the walls directly can be quicker than just Sieging and even more lucrative than granting terms in a Surrender. But such a Storm can be risky, bloody even if successful, and Ruins rather than converts the Stronghold (one Ruins marker for ½VP regardless of Size, 1.3.1).

Storm is full-fledged combat, like Battle in the field. So you will need to take in the Battle procedure (4.4) as well as how Storm alters it (4.5.2). The best way is to refer to the “Battle & Storm” page of the foldout and follow down the “Storm Procedure” column on the right.

A key to successful Storm is preparing adequate Siegeworks. Defenders will benefit from defensive Walls, typically cancelling Hits on rolls of 1-4. But the Attackers similarly get to cancel Hits on rolls equal to less than their number of Siege markers (4.5.2 SIEGEWORKS). So, four Siege markers (the maximum) are equally effective as Walls 1-4, for example. The Besiegers have done the spadework to provide trenches or covering engines to approach the walls, undermined them, and otherwise evened out the ground for the big assault.

Larger Strongholds Defend against Storm with larger Garrisons—see the Strongholds table on the foldout. Some other tricky aspects:

- Each side gets to start with only one Lord on the Attack (it could be a Commander or his Comune, but not both, 1.5.1 COMUNI)—the rest start in Reserve. The fight is occurring

on just a section of the walls where the assault has been prepared. Each side can then add a single Lord to the Front each Round, but only to a maximum of Lords equal to Stronghold size of ❶, ❷, or ❸ (4.5.2 ARRAY and REPOSITION). This restriction will almost always benefit the Defender, because it is the Attacker who will have more Lords at the fight, very often facing just a Garrison.

- Attackers may not get many Rounds to overcome the defense: a Storm may last only as many Rounds as there are Siege markers there—another representation of the need to prepare an assault with Siege activity (4.5.2 ENDING THE STORM).
- There is a limit on how many swords and spears the attacker can bring to bear on the ramparts at any moment: each Attacking Lord in Melee causes a maximum of six Hits (4.5.2 STRONGHOLD EFFECTS). (Archery is not thus limited.) A handy way to remember that rule when you have a really beefy Lord at the walls is that the Melee Hit limit for Storm Attackers equals the number of dice that come with the game.
- Assaulting medieval fortifications is bloody business only for the toughest troops. Attackers in Storm must take hits on Armored units first. And after the Storm, any Routed Attackers will recover only on rolls of “1” (4.5.2 ENDING THE STORM), instead of the usual roll against their Armor.

Arts of War card effects (1.9.1) tend to have a heavy impact on combat, so pay careful attention to any cards present. We illustrate that with a sampling in the Storm example below.

Sack, Ruin, and Revolt. One advantage that the Attacking side has in Storm is that it can give up the fight after any Round, while the Defender must fight to the end. If the Attackers do win (by Routing all of the Garrison units first and then all Defending Lords, if any), they Sack and Ruin the Stronghold (4.5.2 SACK). Remove any Allegiance markers there and place a ½VP Ruins marker in the opposite color of printed Allegiance (1.3.1 Ruins).

This means that Sack may be worth less for Victory than Surrender. If you are Storming a rebellious Town in your territory, for example, the Ruins marker that replaces Enemy Allegiance markers will also be in the Enemy's color! However, you can later remove the Ruins by using the COSTRUTTORI Capability card to rebuild your Stronghold (1.9.1).

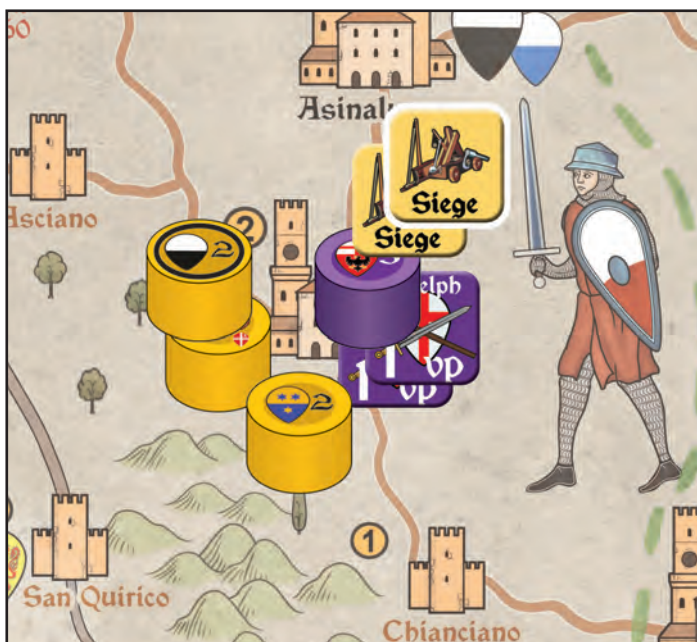
The good news for those Sacking a Stronghold is that they get Spoils that the Terms of a Surrender do not allow (4.5.2 SACK, 4.5.1 Terms). Check the Strongholds table for the goodies to award your Lords—the bigger the Stronghold, the more Assets they collect.

When a Stronghold falls by either Sack or Surrender, there can be political fallout: the conquerors will get to add Treachery cards to their Command deck and to roll for Revolts to their side elsewhere on the map (1.4, 4.5.1 REVOLT AND TREACHERY, 4.5.2 Revolt and Treachery). See the “Revolt & Treachery Summary” sheet and the explanation of Treachery, Revolt, and Bribe starting on page 17 below.

- Players, be sure to claim these rewards as you seize your opponent's Stronghold!

EXAMPLE: Now let's look at Siege and Storm in a new situation. Siena's Podestà, Comune, and Capitaneus—Provenzano Salvani—March to crush the rebels of Montepulciano (4.3.1 Group March). Intent on Storming the Town, the Ghibellines bring cross-bows, pavise shields, and siege equipment (the Arts of War cards shown at their mats (1.9.1, 3.4.4). But the Guelph papal army of Orvieto arrives first and enters the gates (4.3.4 WITHDRAW) before the Sienese encamp to blockade the town (placing one Siege marker; 4.3.5 Besiege). It will be a tough fight!

On their next opportunity—it could be either a Siena or Provenzano Command action card—the Ghibellines Siege at Montepulciano (4.5.1). An enemy Lord is there, so there is no Surrender roll. (Were there no Guelph Lord inside, the player would roll two dice for the Size 2 Town and take the Town only if each die rolled "1" for just one Siege marker there, 4.5.1 SURRENDER?) The Besiegers have at least as many Lord cylinders as Stronghold Size—Orvieto's cylinder there does not matter: the Ghibellines add a second gold Siege marker (4.5.1 SIEGEWORKS). Siena, Provenzano, and Orvieto participated in Siege—there is low-level fighting going on—so all must Feed afterward (4.5.1 MOVED/FOUGHT, 4.8.1).



Next Command card, the Lords' situation on the Calendar is as follows: all three at Montepulciano are worn out to within 60 days of going home (3.3.2). Out of food, the Ghibellines use all their remaining actions save one to Supply, Forage, or Ravage for Provender or Loot so as not to have to pay precious Coin or otherwise immediately Disband, should they continue to work on their Siegeworks. Orvieto's army—trapped inside the Stronghold—can do none of those and is now out of Provender. Without a full Ghibelline Command card left, Siege is not an option, but a quick Storm of the Town with that final action will shock the Orvietani into seeking terms (they will have to Feed) and—with some really good combat luck—perhaps even Sack the place.



The players could set up the Storm Array on the Battle mat with just the Lord cylinders, Garrison units, and Siege markers there (4.4.1, 4.5.2 ARRAY). But they have the table room to Array the Lord mats themselves and do so as shown here. The active Lord is Siena, so either Siena's Podesta or Comune mat, and only one, must start Front Center. The player chooses the Comune in order to put the sturdy and hard-hitting communal PALVESARI-BALESTRIERI teams into action at once.



The Ghibellines put their two Siege markers in front of their center Lord as a reminder that they will get that Protection (4.5.2 STRONGHOLD EFFECTS). The Strongholds table reminds that this Town—like all Strongholds in Inferno—gives the Defenders Walls 1-4. The table also shows the Garrison units that the Guelph player deploys in front of the Defending mat—Garrison will absorb Hits first until Routed (4.5.2 GARRISON FORCES).

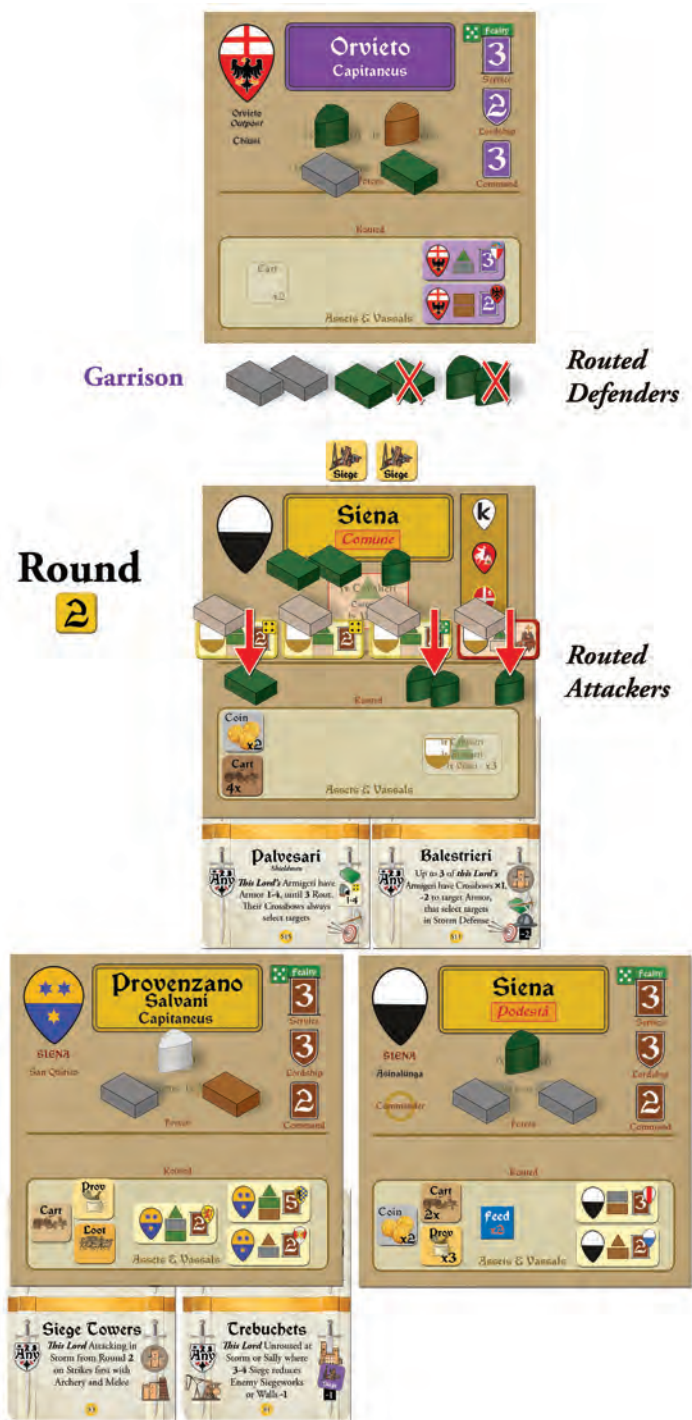


“Battle & Storm” on the foldout notes that sides would now commit any Events affecting the Storm (4.4.1), but neither has any. Round 1 is on! Players place a number marker as a reminder—there will be at most two Rounds, for two Siege markers (4.5.2 ENDING).

As Battle & Storm shows, the sides will alternate Archery and then Melee Strikes by their Front Lords and the Garrison (4.4.1 STRIKE Initiative, 4.5.2 STRONGHOLD EFFECTS). We won’t play out all the Hits and Protection rolls in this example, but here are some special aspects of this Storm situation:

- The Attacking Siennese will need to absorb Hits with their Armored units first—so no forcing the poor Villici laborers to climb those scaling ladders first!
- The Garrison Foot units per Battle & Storm all have Crossbow Archery that is very effective against Armor and that will enable the Defending side to select which Attacking Armored units get Hit (4.4.2 ASSIGN HITS—Select Target). For example, they could focus their Crossbow bolts on the Attacking Crossbowmen (the Armigeri units using the BALESTRIERI card).
- Fortunately for the Attackers, those Armigeri Crossbowmen have PALVESARI. The Garrison’s Archery shots must first get past the Walls Protection of the Siegeworks (cancelling each Hit on a roll of “1” or “2”). Then the Crossbow Hits will subtract from the PALVESARI card’s tough “Armor 1-4”, so those Armigeri will still hold on rolls of 1-2 (4.4.2 ROLL BY HIT). That enhanced Armor applies only until three of that Lord’s Armigeri have routed; but Siena’s Comune has only three, so that is not an issue here.
- Moreover, once the Attacking BALESTRIERI get their turn to shoot back, the PALVESARI enable them also to Select their Targets among Garrison units, so they can similarly attempt to suppress the Defending Crossbowmen first.
- Finally, Provenzano’s TREBUCHETS will help the Attackers even while that Lord is still in Reserve by reducing the Town Walls from “1-4” to “1-3”, making the Garrison units easier to Hit. His SIEGE TOWERS, in contrast, will not come into play unless and until he Repositions to the Front.

Below are the results of the fighting along the ramparts after roughly average Round 1 Strikes.



Both sides have Unrouted Forces, so the Storm proceeds to Round 2. The Attackers may Concede. If they don’t, both sides could Reposition, in this case enabling the Attackers to bring a second Lord mat to the Front—one may advance each Round, up to the Stronghold’s Size, here, 2 (4.5.2 CONCEDE? and REPOSITION).

The Siennese decide that their work is done, so they Concede. ending the Storm immediately. The Attackers lost, so there is no Sack. Both sides roll for recovery of their Routed units back to the Forces sections of their mats or Loss to the pool. Garrison units simply

return to the pool. But the Storm Attackers have four Routed units that each become Losses on any roll but a “1” (instead of the normal Armor roll). There is no Knights’ Quarter given, as this was a Storm without a Sack (4.5.2 ENDING THE STORM and SACK).

Siena’s Command card ends—Feed/Pay/Disband is next (4.8). The three Lords at Montepulciano all Fought, but only the Ghibellines can Feed or Pay their Lords. Orvieto’s Service marker slides one box left into the current Campaigns box, and Orvieto Disbands at Service Limit (3.3.2), its cylinder to the Calendar three boxes ahead (to box 12) and its mat set aside, units into the pool. Being under Siege does not affect Orvieto’s Disband. Montepulciano’s Garrison now stands alone!

Knights’ Quarter and Ransom

A new wrinkle to Battle and Storm in *Inferno* is that socially elite Horsemen may end up as Captives hoping to get Ransomed. Capture and ransom were common practice in medieval warfare and, with all the gold florins around, big business in Guelph and Ghibelline Tuscany.

Knights’ Quarter. Captives can come into play upon the end of a Battle (4.4.4 Losses). In *Inferno*, you have to pay attention to the exact die rolls whenever rolling for Battle Losses of two unit types: Cavalieri (green wedges) and Ritter (silver wedges). If and only if a unit fails their roll to recover *and* the roll was a “3” or higher, put that unit into its own sides Captured Knights box on the board instead of returning it to the pool.

In Storm, such Knights’ Quarter only applies to the Defenders and only when they lose (4.5.2 SACK)—the only moment in a Siege situation that either side can really get at the other enough to take prisoners. (Surrender represents agreed terms including safe parole of any elite troops inside.)

As you don’t roll Losses in a Sack, *all* Cavalieri and Ritter of the Losing side go into their Captured box. Typically, this means the one to three Cavalieri that formed part of the Garrison (see the Strongholds table).

- Remember to put the right number of Cavalieri into the Captured box after the Sack, including those units that may have been removed in an earlier Storm Round. It will always be the same number of as the Size of the Stronghold (plus, less likely, any from Lords who Defending inside).

Ransom. Upon each Campaign’s End Phase, check the Captured Knights boxes for any units there. Each side gets a choice of paying Coin (from any Lords) to free all units in its box *or* let them Languish (4.9.2). The first option restores half (rounded up) of those units to *any* Lords and returns the rest to the pool. The second option leaves them there and grants the other side a Revolt Table roll or Treachery card (1.4.2-1.4.3)—the political effect of abandoning your knights.

- Ransom and Languish, like the Grow step’s removal of Ravaged markers (4.9.1), occur before Game End (4.9.3)—so failure to pay could trigger a Revolt that alters the final score!

EXAMPLE: After a major defeat in Battle, the Guelphs have seven Cavalieri in their Captured Knights box. Upon the Ransom end step (4.9.2), they can pay two Coin total for their Lords—one Coin per six Captured Knights, rounded up—to place four of the

Cavalieri units on any mats of their on-map Lords and return the other three Cavalieri to the units pool. If they don’t have the two Coin or choose not to pay, Languish will enable the Ghibellines to choose between two Revolt Table rolls (1.4.2), adding two Treachery cards (1.4.3), or one of each of those. Paying just one Guelph Coin is not an option. Languish would leave those Cavalieri in the box, and the Guelphs would face the same choice again after the next Campaign (barring Ghibelline play of S13 GENTLE USILIA).

Treachery, Revolt, and Bribe

Revolt and Treachery are the heftiest new elements in this volume of *Levy & Campaign*. They help represent the deeply internecine nature of the Guelph-Ghibelline conflict, the fact that it derived more from pure political interest than any ethnic or cultural divide, and so individual communities swayed back and forth in allegiance.

The best way to take in how Revolt and Treachery can occur is to read through section 1.4 on page 6 of the Rules. Then scan over the yellow Revolt & Treachery Summary aid sheet: the top left and right boxes list how Treachery cards can enter a side’s Command deck (1.4.3) and when to roll on a Revolt Table (1.4.2), respectively. The remaining boxes cover how to go about them.



Then, as you refer during play to the foldout aid sheet, look for the yellow tone boxes that cue such addition of Treachery cards and/or Revolt rolls. Finally, the following guidelines may help during play.

Acquisition of Treachery cards and rolls on a Revolt Table reward your accomplishments such as Disband Beyond Service or removal in combat of an Enemy Lord (3.3.1, 4.4.5), Surrender or Sack of an Enemy Stronghold (4.5.1-2), Languish of Enemy Captured Knights (4.9.2), or fulfilling conditions on an Event card (1.9.1).

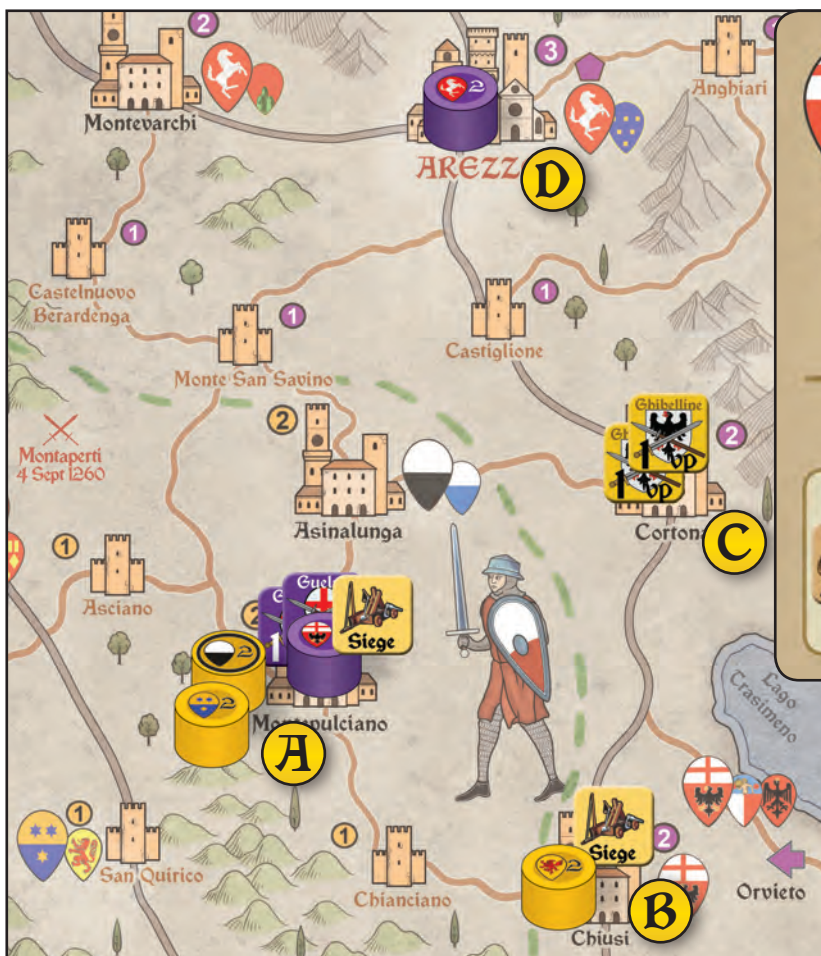
Treachery cards are Command cards (1.9.2). Once you obtain them, you can add them to a Campaign Plan just like regular Command action cards (4.1.1-2). When they flip up, they activate that Lord wherever he is to target an Enemy for either Revolt or Bribe (4.2.3, 4.7.5, 4.7.6). Either use costs Coin. You have to have that Lord already in position with the money in hand as you reveal the Treachery card!

An effective range of one adjacent Locale governs Revolt and Bribe:

- Strongholds’ eligibility for Revolt (1.4.1, whether by Revolt Table roll, 1.4.2, or Treachery, 4.7.5) and vulnerability to Revolt Table rolls hang on whether or not Lords of either side and/or a side’s Allegiance markers are there or adjacent.
- Bribe can target Vassals whose Lords or Vassal Seats are at the same Locale as or adjacent to the Lord using the Treachery card (4.7.6).

Whenever a Stronghold does Revolt to a side, its Exiles spur the *other* side’s military effort with a beneficial shift of Service and/or Lord cylinder on the Calendar by one box per Allegiance marker that the Revolt placed or removed (1.4.4).

- So, don’t forget to collect your Exiles consolation prize whenever a Stronghold Revolts on you!

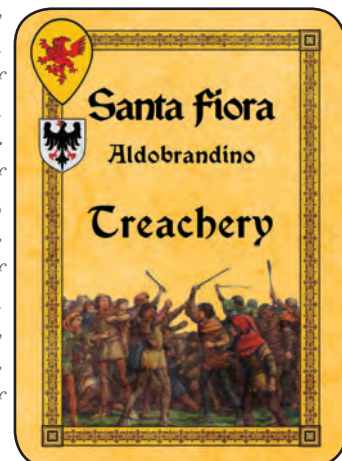


eligible Revolt targets (1.4.1) but could attempt to Bribe a Mustered Vassal away from either Siena or Provenzano or Siena's Asinalunga Vassal even if Unmustered, since that Vassal Seat is adjacent to the north (4.7.6).

Siena or Provenzano (A) similarly could attempt to Bribe Orvieto's Mustered Vassal, Sinibaldo Rubini (4.7.6). If either of the two Lords had Coin on hand (they could Share, 1.5.2), they could target that Vassal. Success on a roll of 4-6 (higher than that Vassal's Service Rating of "3") would move that Vassal marker; one Cavalieri, and one Men-at-Arms unit from Orvieto's mat to that of the Ghibelline Lord shown on the Treachery card.

Santa Fiora (B) would have two Treachery options:

- He could attempt to Bribe Orvieto's Unmustered Vassal, the Orvietani & Perugini Reserve, as that Vassal Seat is adjacent at Orvieto's Outpost to the northeast. Success on a roll of 3-6 and for Coin x1 would add that Vassal marker from Orvieto's mat and two Militia from the pool to Santa Fiora (4.7.6).
- Or, he could use his Treachery card activation to attempt to gain Chiusi's Allegiance by Revolt (4.7.5). The Ghibelline player would state how many Coin Santa Fiora will commit from his mat. If both of two dice (for the Size of Chiusi, a Town) rolled equal or less than that that number of Coin, Chiusi would Revolt to the Ghibellines (ending the Siege, 1.4.4). The Revolt of Chiusi would immediately enable the Guelphs to shift any of their own Lords or Service on the Calendar by a total of two boxes (1.4.4 EXILES).

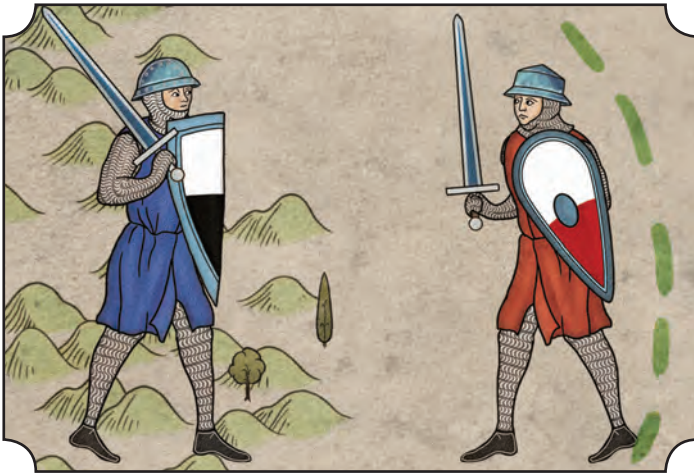


EXAMPLE: Returning to the Sienese Siege of Montepulciano from the Siege and Storm example above, let's say that Santa Fiora has joined the fray and Besieged the Town of Chiusi, while Arezzo's army lurks at its City to the north.

What Strongholds here on each side a Revolt Table roll affect? For Revolt against the Ghibellines, the heavy military presence in this area of Tuscany protects almost everything shown. The Guelph Allegiance markers at Montepulciano (A) and Orvieto's army there (either alone would be sufficient) would create the possibility of Revolt at adjacent Ghibelline Locales (1.4.2), but Siena's army just outside the gates block any such eligibility (1.4.1). A "SUBMISSION?" result could not remove Ghibelline Allegiance from Cortona (C) because no Guelph Lord is adjacent (1.4.2).

For Revolt against the Guelphs, Orvieto's Lord prevents the Submission of Montepulciano, and Arezzo's Lord (D) blocks any spread of Revolt from Cortona (C) to Castiglione Castle in between the two (1.4.1-2). However, Cortona's Allegiance markers and Santa Fiora's cylinder (or other alone) would result in Chiusi (B) going over to the Ghibellines on a Revolt Table roll naming "Chiusi" (a Ghibelline roll of purple "5" and gold "6"). It does not matter that Orvieto's cylinder is under Siege, only that it is too far away to dissuade Chiusi.

What are the possibilities if a side were to flip a Treachery card at this moment (4.2.3)? Arezzo (D) would have none: it has neither Revolt nor Bribe targets in range. Besieged Orvieto (A) has no el-



Battle Minigame

Recreating Montaperti

Here is a brief competitive game—for either two players or one person playing both sides—a great way to see how an Inferno Battle goes before risking combat in a full scenario!

(For a detailed simulation of the Battle of Montaperti plus two subsequent 13th-Century Italian battles, try Guelphs and Ghibellines—Three Historical Battles in Medieval Italy by Piergennaro Federico, Europa Simulazioni, 2009.)

Lords, Vassals, and Capabilities. The Guelph side takes all seven of its Lord mats (six Lords plus Comune); the Ghibellines take all but Pisa (six total). Array the mats per rule 4.4.1. If two players, do so behind screens. The Guelphs will have three in front and four in reserve, the Ghibellines three and three (any mat may be Front center). Muster all Vassals except the Altopascio Special Vassal their units to the Forces sections of the Lord mats (3.4.2). No need to place Assets.

Find and assign **“This Lord”** Capabilities as listed below and assign them as desired to Lord mats, no more than two Cards per mat:

- Guelphs get all FEDITORI, BALESTRIERI, and PALVESARI (F6 & F7, F9-F11, F13-F15) plus card F17 ARCIERI (only).
- Ghibellines get S6 FEDITORI, S7 LUCERIA, and all BALESTRIERI and PALVESARI (S9-S11, S13-S15).

Give both sides the ARMY RESERVE Capability: place cards F12 and S12 behind the Guelph and Ghibelline Arrays, respectively.

Then remove the screens. The Ghibelline player receives and tucks the Event BOCCA DEGLI ABATI (card S16) under the top of any one Guelph Front mat and SUDDEN CLASH (card S4) under the top of any one Ghibelline Front mat.

Where are the Pisans? Players decide by consent whether or not the Pisans join the Ghibelline army. If players cannot agree, instead roll a die: the Pisans join on a roll of 1-3.

- If the **Pisans join** (only), add Pisa’s mat with its starting and Vassal Forces to the Ghibelline Reserve. As desired, the Ghibelline player may shift up to two **“This Lord”** cards to Pisa’s mat.

Who Attacks? If the **Pisans have not joined**, the Guelphs will Attack and the Ghibellines Defend.

If the **Pisans have joined**, players decide by consent who will Attack or—if they cannot agree—roll a die to determine who Attacks: The Guelphs Attack on a 1-3, the Ghibellines Attack on 4-6.

- If the Pisans have joined *and* the Guelphs Attack, the Guelph player selects and adds either A BLOODY RED STREAM Event (card F16) *or* the DISTRINGITORES Capability (card F21).
- If the **Ghibellines Attack**, (with Pisa) remove the two Guelph FEDITORI Capabilities (cards F6 & F7) from Guelph mats and ARMY RESERVE (card F12) from the Guelph Array.

Fighting the Battle. Give each player a foldout and refer to its Battle and Storm page and the Forces table during play. Open the Rules of Play to section 4.4 Battle.

The Lords are Arrayed and Battle Events played. Begin by carrying out the Event text of BOCCA DEGLI ABATI. Then proceed with 4.4.2 Rounds and on through the Battle sequence along the left half of the Battle and Storm play aid, checking the Forces table and Rules section 4.4 as needed.

Do not Concede the Field: whoever wins the Battle by Routing all Enemy Lords first wins the game.

Campaign History

Here we relate in political context the military campaigns depicted in Inferno. Maps show major movements. Section titles quote the great poet, born in and exiled from Firenze in an age when Montaperti still haunted living memory.

Poca favilla

Poca favilla gran fiamma seconda...

“A mighty flame follows a tiny spark...”

[Dante Alighieri – *Paradiso* I 34]

Mid-1200s—Origins. Northern Italian and Tuscan politics by the 13th Century had crystalized into two contending parties, each seeking outside support against its local rival. The mostly German Emperors who claimed rule over much of Italy backed the *Ghibellini* (from Waiblingen or Wibellingen, the castle seat of the Hohenstaufen dynasty with the tightest hold on the Imperial throne). The Emperor’s main political opponent in Italy since the 11th-Century Investiture controversy, the Pope, backed the *Guelfi* (from Welf or Wolf, a family name of frequent Imperial contenders challenging the Hohenstaufen).

Generally, the Ghibellines stood for law and order, virtues associated with loyalty to Imperial rule, while the Guelphs promoted the independence and liberty that the Italian towns’ burgeoning prosperity afforded. But it was regional commercial rivalry rather than any ideology that drove conflict. Tuscan Guelphs rallied around the great clothmaking, trade, and banking center of Florence (*Firenze*), which would begin striking its famous gold florins in 1252. Ghibellines in turn looked to Firenze’s main inland competitor Siena for leadership. Popular Revolts and factional jockeying overlapped in near continuous fighting from the 1240 on.

Upon the death in 1250 of Emperor Friederich II, Firenze retook lands that he had confiscated. Siena, however, not only recognized Imperial authority but also moved against enemies of the Empire. In 1251, it imposed its rule over Grosseto and subjugated numerous castles to its south. The towns of Montalcino and Montepulciano near Siena, chafing at the domination, took Firenze's protection and drew Sienese ravaging of their countryside and a siege by Siena and Firenze's other main commercial rival Pisa.



Illustration of a Florentine army in the chronicle of Giovanni Villani, early 1300s

Firenze in turn sought to impose military control over any disloyal communities across Tuscany's north and between it and Siena, such as at the town of Poggio Bonizio (now Poggibonsi). The campaigns widened the internal split between Firenze's own Guelph and Ghibelline citizens, who at that time adopted distinct banners—red lily or cross on white for Guelphs, and white on red for Ghibellines.

When the death in 1254 of Conrad, King of the Germans, Romans, and Italians, began an Imperial interregnum that at first denied the Ghibellines German military aid, Siena submitted to a peace, recognizing the independence of Montalcino and Montepulciano and promising not to harbor any Florentine Ghibellines.



Coronation of Manfredi at Palermo (from Villani)

But Imperial support would soon return. Conrad's Hohenstaufen half-brother Manfredi exercised regency in the south in ostensible defense of the Italian claims of Conrad's young heir Conrad—but actually in a bid to establish Manfredi's own reign and expand it into Tuscany. Siena and Manfredi begin negotiations for an alliance. Pope Alexander IV excommunicated Manfredi. But,

in 1258, Manfredi had himself crowned King of Sicily (a realm that included southern Italy), usurping Conradin. While the Ghibellines gained a potent new champion, the shaky Hohenstaufen legitimacy would hardly douse the fire of Guelph rebellion.

Quanto Sangue

Non vi si pensa quanto sangue costa ...

"There is no thought among you of the blood it costs ..."

[Paradiso XXIX 91]

1258—Conspiracy. In the intimate geography of Tuscany, maneuvers against individual rebellions were destined sooner or later to knit together into general war. If Siena was to aid rebels against Guelph Arezzo, it would have to overcome its own who stood in the way at Montepulciano, who first would call for help from the papal states to its southeast. If Firenze was to ease pressure on Montepulciano by marching south to the aid Montalcino, it first would have either to bypass or to defeat the Sienese in the field. And that would call for assembly of a very great host indeed.

A Ghibelline conspiracy within Firenze in 1258 provided the spark for full-out war between the two camps. The Florentines had discovered the plot and arrested and executed several conspirators. The Uberti family that hatched it and all prominent Ghibellines who remained in Firenze fled (or so it appeared). These exiles found refuge in Siena, despite the latter's treaty commitment not to welcome them. These exiles would at once add to Guelph *casus belli* against Siena and stir their Sienese and Hohenstaufen hosts to war against the Guelphs.

That year, Guelph Arezzo's Bishop Guglielmino degli Ubertini next turned on and declared the people of Firenze excommunicated, eventually finding his castle raided by Firenze's Milanese *Podestà* Danese Crivelli and his person a refugee alongside the Ghibelline exiles in Siena.

The reckoning between the leading cities that would lead to Montaperti was at hand. Hohenstaufen intervention and offensives in 1259 would draw that massive and catastrophic Guelph response in 1260. It would take months' more fighting into 1261 finally to chase the wretched remainder of one party over the mountains and yield to the other an all-too-brief sway over the whole of Tuscany.

Dolenti Note

Or incomincian le dolenti note

a farmisi sentire; or son venuto

là dove molto pianto mi percuote.

*"Now I begin to hear the notes
of agony. Now I have come
where a great wailing beats upon me."*

[Inferno V 25-27]

Spring 1259—Cortona's War. The *comuni* of both Arezzo and Firenze coveted the territory of the town of Cortona, which responded by sealing a lasting and trusted "friendship" with the city of Siena. The Aretine Guelphs occupied Cortona in 1258 but in February 1259 suffered a rebellion by the town, which claimed in-

dependence. Arezzo in March mustered a large force and marched on Cortona:

“In the Christ year 1259, being Podestà of Arezzo, messer Stoldo Giacoppi de’ Rossi of Firenze, with his mind and courage he guided the Aretini, and at night with stairs they entered Cortona, which was very strong, but for bad watching lost for the Cortonesi, and the Aretini destroyed the walls and fortress, and made them their vassals....” [GV §66]

The leading citizens of Cortona fled to the shore of Trasimeno and, seeking but refused refuge from the populace there, living for some time under tents. (The escaped Ghibellines would finally retake their town with Siennese help in 1261. See Ghibelline Event S18 CORTONA.)

The issues of Ghibelline exiles in Siena in violation of peace terms and the rebellions at Montepulciano and Montalcino remained hot. On April 1st, 1259, word reached the General Council of Siena that Firenze was organizing its militia companies and distributing ensigns. As Siena prepared a campaign against Montalcino, messengers from Manfredi arrived April 15th and requested that the city swear allegiance. On May 16th, the Council swore, in the name of Siena’s *comune*, loyalty and obedience to the King and would-be future Emperor, provided that the Siennese should not for such loyalty oppose the Roman Church, as did the Florentine exiles. Manfredi in turn annulled his treaty with Firenze and dispatched a detachment of German and southern-Italian horse to Siena.

Florentine Farinata degli Uberti now acted as chief organizer of the exiled Ghibellines inside the city. Firenze demanded that Siena observe its treaty and forbid such hostile Ghibelline meetings within its walls. The Siennese, who had just agreed (albeit not yet signed) to the alliance with Manfredi, ignored the threats of Firenze’s ambassadors.



15th-Century rendering of Florentine Ghibelline leader Farinata degli Uberti

The fortified towns of Montalcino and Montepulciano, who would soon be under Siennese siege, enjoyed Firenze’s protection. But those towns lay too far from Firenze to the other side of the city of Siena for the Florentines to risk the danger of a move toward direct military relief of the rebels—at least not in 1259.

In far Vendetta

Ché bell’onor s’acquista in far vendetta.

“For great honor is gained in taking revenge.”

[Rime CIII]

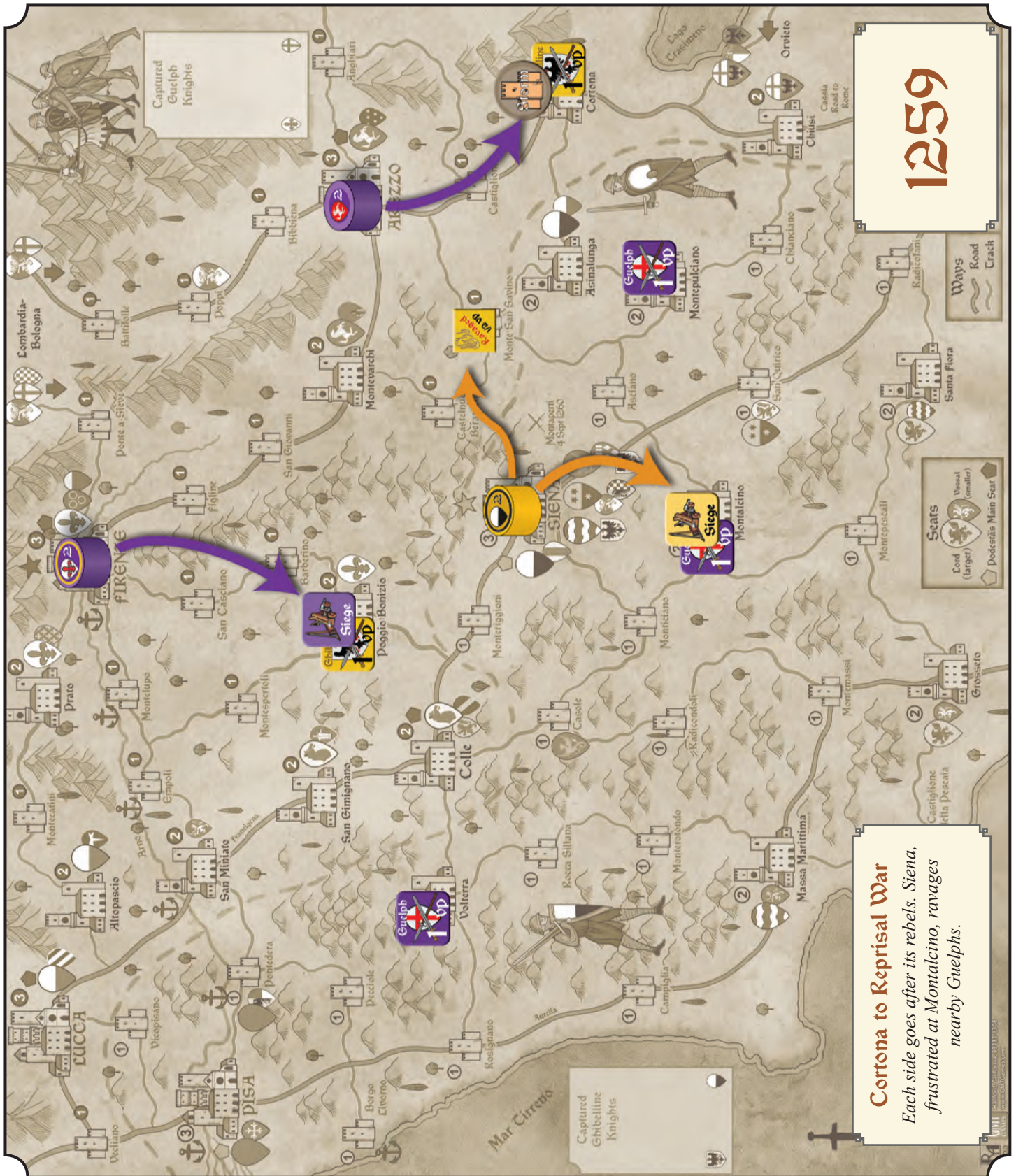
Summer-Autumn 1259—Reprisal War. Just to the south and southwest of Montalcino and Montepulciano lay the Maremma region of Tuscany, its northern reaches the domain of the Aldobrandeschi. This family of powerful nobles found itself on either side of the Guelph-Ghibelline struggle. In July 1259, however, Siena succeeded in resolving its disputes with them sufficiently to gain the allegiance of Aldobrandino Aldobrandeschi, Count of Santa Fiora. Of even greater consequence, Siena in August 1259 signed its Treaty of Alliance with the Hohenstaufen King.

Perhaps frustrated in the lack of immediate results against Montalcino and Montepulciano despite the power of their growing coalition, the Siennese lashed out against easier targets of their enemies. Ghibelline raids took and burned many smaller Guelph castles and fortified villages after short sieges and as well set on fire defenseless settlements and isolated houses. It was the “Reprisal War”.



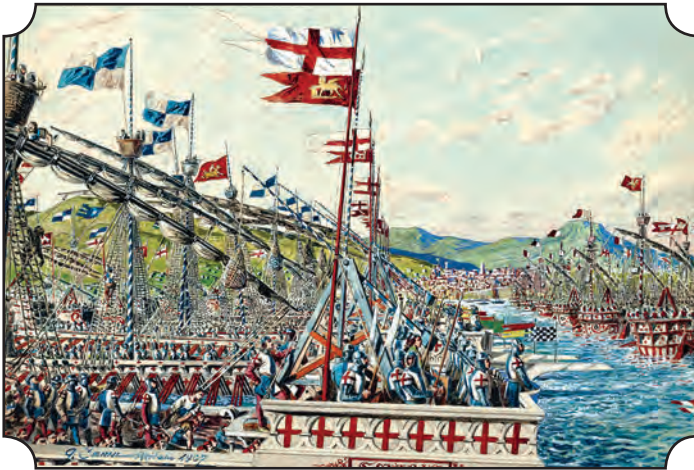
16th-Century depiction of Ezzelino da Romano with the Imperial crest, black eagle on gold

In Italy’s north, however, affairs turned sharply against the Ghibelline and Imperial cause. In October 1259, that region’s forceful Imperial champion Ezzelino III da Romano suffered defeat in battle and death in captivity. Ghibelline collapse followed across the north, opening the way to military aid to Firenze from the Lombardia and Romagna regions.



The collapse of the northern Italian Ghibellines had another indirect effect on the contest for Tuscany. It agitated the dynastic struggle between the natural Imperial heir, the Swabian Conrad, and the Italian usurper, Manfredi. Pisa had kept a Ghibelline stance against its main rivals, Firenze and Genova, who were Guelph. But Pisa now was torn over which potential emperor to follow—inhibiting its participation in Siena's coalition with the King of Sicily. (See also Guelph Events F9 GENOVA, and F19 VOLTERRA.)

That distancing of Pisa was no small military matter. Its *comune* could muster some 2,700 elite infantry and 300 knights. What is more, Pisa was one of the greatest maritime powers of the time. It owned more than 200 galleys that could reach up the Arno River all the way to Firenze.



A medieval Italian galley fleet, as painted 1907

Meanwhile, Guelphs in October 1259 rebuilt the walls of Cortona to hold it against a Ghibelline counterattack that they surely expected. In an apparent natural affirmation of the political times, that November saw severe storms across Tuscany.

Santafior Oscura

*Vien, crudel, vieni, e vedi la pressura
d'i tuoi gentili, e cura lor magagne;
e vedrai Santafior com'è oscura!*

*"Come, cruel one, come and see the tribulation
your nobles suffer and heal their hurts;
Then you shall see how dark is Santa Fiora!"*

[Purgatorio VI 109-111]

Early 1260—Grosseto's War. Under Manfredi's fresh treaty of alliance with Siena, the King sent some companies of knights and the Royal Ensign with his captain and second cousin, Count Giordano of Agliano (or Anglano), Earl of San Severino. Shortly after the arrival of Count Giordano at Siena in December 1259, the town of Grosseto—which Manfredi had declared under his protection—rebelled against Manfredi and Siena, joined by other holdings in the Maremma region, Montemassi and Monteano (just off the south edge of the *Inferno* gameboard).

So began Siena's Maremma War. The city's *Podestà* Francesco Troghisio determined that Giordano would command the Grosseto campaign. And Giordano proceeded personally to promote the subjugation of the Maremma, mainly with Siena's city militias (*terzi*), who served no more than 30 days, rather than the few ranks of Germans he had led north with him.



Imperialist troops

The Count moved against Grosseto in early January, and the town itself surrendered the next month. Having regained the loyalty of Grosseto in February, preparations began March for the reconquest of Montemassi and Monteano.

The rebellions put the Aldobrandeschi family, who had close ties in the Maremma, in a difficult position. Castle Montemassi was their property but had now invoked the protection that the Guelph *Colligiani* (citizens of Colle) had extended it since back in 1206. Count Aldobrandino of Santa Fiora had immediately sued for peace with Siena on behalf of Grosseto. Later, he found himself inside Montemassi as the Siennese besieged it.

Firenze, naturally, helped the rebels as best it could. It had helped fortify Montalcino as a thorn in Siena's flank. Now Florentines made up a part Montemassi's garrison. Count Giordano soon received orders to send his knights along the frontier to stop Florentine supplies reaching south. But with most of Siena's troops bogged down against Maremma rebels into May, Firenze began drew ever more castles and municipalities into its hegemonic project.

Entreaties from both sides outside Tuscany continued apace. On March 17th, Siena and Giordano together sent an embassy to appeal for yet more help from Manfredi, with its captain Provenzano Salvani among the ambassadors (see Guelph Event F14 PROVENZANO). Firenze later that spring would for its part engage soldiers from Milano, Bologna, Modena, and their environs in Italy's north.

Di Sangue t'Empio

Sangue sitisti, e io di sangue t'empio.

"You thirsted for blood, now drink your fill."

[*Purgatorio* XII 57]

Spring 1260—Firenze Strikes. By April, the Florentines were ready for war with Siena, in what would turn out to be a dry run for Montaperti.

Cavalry in Firenze served four months "at their risk and fate," and were to bring good horses worth at least 30 *lire*, without any insurance for harm to people, horses, or material. They drew pay of 9 *lire* monthly, the first two months paid at time of muster. Firenze's urban knights (*cavallate*) formed in companies distributed among the city's six wards (*sestieri*). Each *sestiere* had its banner and coat of arms. That of Porta San Piero since the most ancient times had fielded the "best cavalry and men-at-arms," per chronicler Giovanni Villani.

The army marched out on April 19th, preceded out the city by their sacred *carroccio* oxcart and *martinella* (bell), led by Firenze's *Podestà* Iacopino Rangoni (from Modena) as the supreme army commander and by 12 city captains, two elected for each *sestiere*. Knights, judges, and elders represented the lordship of Firenze. A *gonfaloniere* (flag bearer) led each *sestiere*. Giannozzo Giandonati commanded a *carroccio* guard of knights.

The Florentines arrayed against Siena in a first rank of archers and crossbowmen from the city; a second rank of knights from the *sestieri* Oltrarno, Borgo, and San Pancrazio plus riders from the town of Prato; a third rank of foot from those *sestieri*; fourth and fifth ranks of knights and foot from the *sestieri* Porta San Piero, San Piero Scheraggio, and Porta del Duomo, plus some troops from Lucca; and two final ranks of allied Guelph horse and foot. With allies, the army totaled as many as 30,000 fit to arms, aged 15 to 70.



Florentines and Siennese clash, martinella tower and red carroccio cart nearby (illustration from Villani).

As the army advanced south to seize Casole and some other small castles, the Siennese briefly lifted their siege of Montemassi to march to the defense (see Guelph Event F15 CASOLE). Outmaneuvering the Siennese, the Florentines arrived within sight of Siena and encamped. On May 17th, they skirmished with and chased off Siennese forces and about 100 German knights urged into a premature sally by Ghibelline exiles in the city—the Guelphs capturing a royal banner. On the 18th, the Florentines advanced toward the walls, to the ville of Santa Petronilla. This time, Count Giordano led a sudden sally out the Porta Camollia and drew enough blood to convince the Guelph army to retreat (See Ghibelline Event S4 SUDDEN CLASH).

News of the minor but surprising Ghibelline victory convinced Montemassi to capitulate and Poggio Bonizio—along the main route between the Firenze and Siena—again to side with Siena.

A l'Altra Riva

*I' vegno per menarvi a l'altra riva
ne le tenebre etterne, in caldo e 'n gelo.*

*"I come to take you to the other shore,
into eternal darkness, into heat and chill."*

[*Inferno* III 86-87]

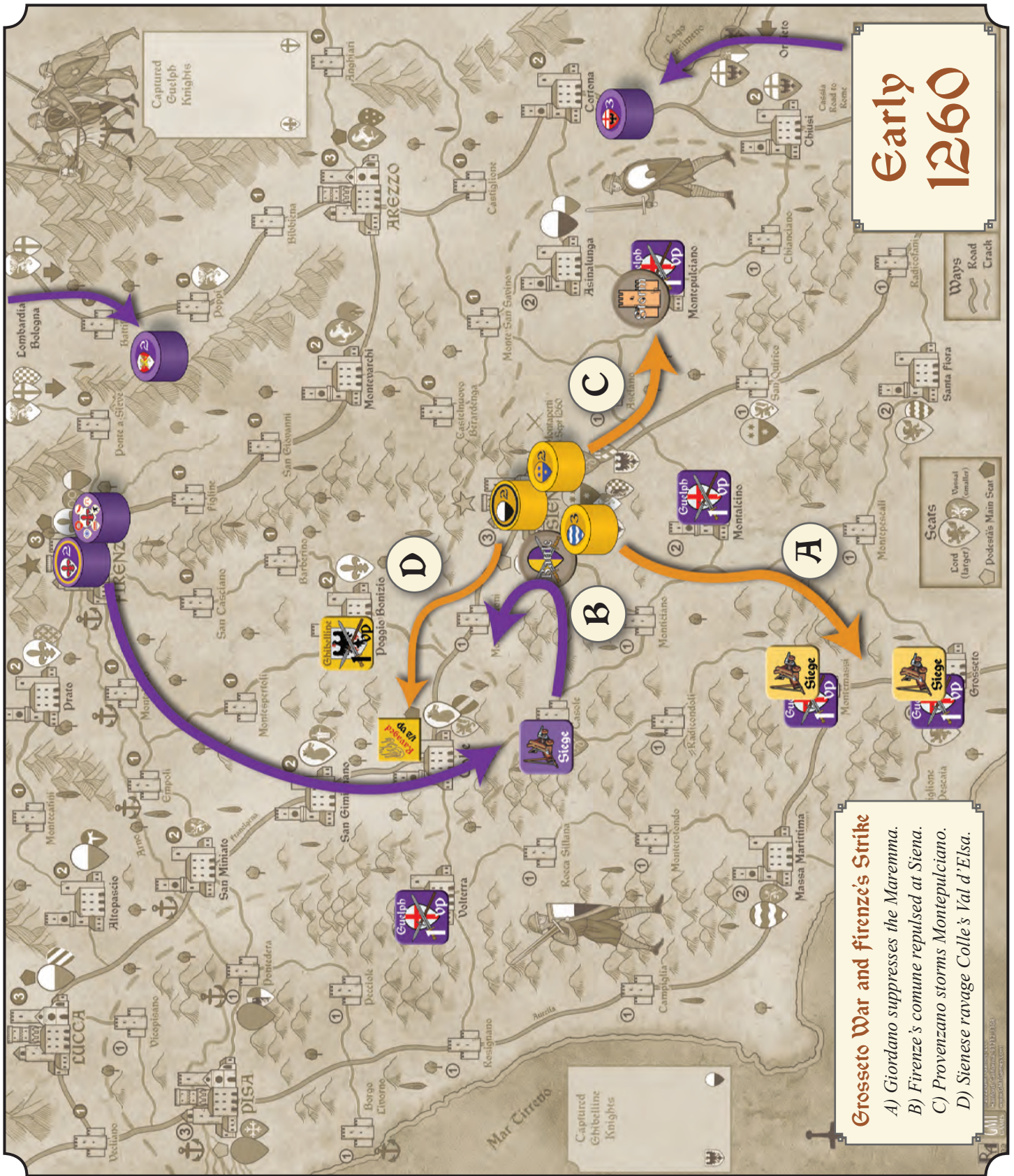
Summer 1260—To the Great Battle. If the sudden conclusion to the Guelph's first expedition to Siena betrayed any lack of appetite for bloodshed, both sides would find it over the coming months.

After the clash at Santa Petronilla, Siena received its answer to Provenzano's embassy to Manfredi in the arrival of more German knights along with Muslims from Lucera (Capability S7 LUCERIA) and other southern Italian troops from late May to August. June to July, the municipality collected 20,000 florins for war, and a call to Tuscan Ghibellines to join the host in encampments in and around Siena must have gone out in these months.

On June 2nd, Siena named Provenzano chief of an army that would that summer drive eastwards and storm and subdue Montepulciano, opening the route to Cortona (Event S26 MONTEPULCIANO). Forces would include the German horsemen, the *Terzi* of San Martino and Camollia, troops drawn off of the Montalcino siege, and levies from the countryside—including for the provision of hay sickles.

Firenze for its part decided in early June to prepare a mission for the relief of Montalcino (Event F26 MONTALCINO). Its army would gather grain from its environs and escort the supplies to the town's relief. The gathering of the provisions proceeded slowly, however. Meanwhile, Montepulciano's inhabitants called urgently for aid from the papal town of Orvieto (Event F17 FOREIGN HELP). But before any such reinforcement could intervene, Montepulciano submitted its allegiance to Siena. The Orvetani would instead join the great Guelph army assembling behind Firenze.

The Siennese moved first, entering and ravaging the nearby lands of Guelph Colle at the end of June. Firenze sent its army to Colle's defense, but after some maneuver and pursuit, the Siennese backed away first, and the two armies avoided any battle.



Back in Siena, the exile Farinata—noting that the German knights would depart after three months’ service and lacking the money to pay them beyond that—feared that the Ghibellines’ chance to strike a decisive blow would pass if the Florentines were not made bolder. In July, he devised a ruse to trick them into advancing on Siena with the invented notion that discontent there would grant them easy entry into the gates (Event S14 FRIARS.) The Florentines took the bait and in August finally launched their expedition toward Montalcino.

The Guelph host once again under command of Firenze’s *Podestà* Iacopino Rangoni had gathered 1,000 crossbowmen (almost all Florentines), 800 knights, and 500 mercenary horsemen—plus contingents from Lucca, Prato, Volterra, San Miniato, San Gimignano, Colle, Bologna, Orvieto, and Perugia. Arezzo joined with their Guelph Bishop Donatello Tarlati. And the Guelph Aldobrandeschi Count of Pitigliano, Aldobrandino Rosso, sent knights as well. The honor of guarding Firenze’s carroccio went to Firenze’s *gonfaloniere* Jacopo dei Pazzi.

The Sienese to stand against that grand army had numerous allies of their own beyond Manfredi’s *Ritter*. Cortona’s and Arezzo’s Ghibellines joined, the latter formed under their exiled Bishop Guglielmino degli Ubertini a man of great wealth and a Prince of the Empire in addition to serving as a bishop. Some accounts say Pisa sent 3,000 troops; however, its alignment with Manfredi’s rival Conradin suggests that Pisans stayed home so as not to fight shoulder to shoulder with the Hohenstaufen usurper. All told, the Ghibelline-Sienese army numbered some 18,000 men, including at least 800 German knights.

The Guelph army departed Firenze in late August. The column of knights and *berrovieri* Italian light horse; archers, crossbowmen, and spearmen; plus ox carts, wagons, pack donkeys, and mules carrying the oversized shields of *palvesari* made its way south, past an occupied Poggio Bonizio and passing purposely nearby Siena. Just southeast of Siena on September 2nd it halted to send heralds to present the Sienese harsh terms for the latter’s submission, including the dismantling of the city’s walls.

The Sienese, after a formality of debate, marched their Terzi and *carroccio* out the gates the next day, keeping to the opposite bank of the River Arbia from the Guelph enemy. Provenzano Salvani of Siena, Aldobrandino Aldobrandeschi of Santa Fiora, and Gerdano of Agliano all held high command roles. A Ghibelline army reserve under Niccolò da Bigozzi guarded the *carroccio*.

The Guelphs, at first stunned to see their outnumbered foes daring to meet them, advanced that night against the enemy down into the Arbia valley and arrayed along the slope, horsemen in front. The Ghibelline forces crossed the Arbia itself and lined up on the plain to face them. The moment of reckoning had come, near the small castle and village of Montaperti.

Arbia Colorata in Rosso

*“E se tu mai nel dolce mondo regge,
dimmi: perché quel popolo è sì empio
incontr’ a’ miei in ciascuna sua legge?”
Ond’ io a lui: “Lo strazio e ‘l grande scempio
che fece l’Arbia colorata in rosso,
tal orazion fa far nel nostro tempio.”*

*“And so may you return to the sweet world,
tell me: why are those citizens so cruel
against my kin in all of their decrees?”
To which I said: ‘The carnage, the great bloodshed
that dyed the Arbia red
led them to such prayers in our temple.’”*

[Farinata and Dante converse in Hell – *Inferno* X 82-87]

4 September 1260—Montaperti. That morning, all Tuscany stood on a single field, hot for a great battle that would seek but fail to resolve its civil war. Tradition has Walther von Astimberg as the first to charge, besting a captain of the Lucchese and several other *cavalieri*. The two sides’ knights battled first, with the lines of foot then joining against one another as well. Numbers told: the Guelph horse stood its own, as the Guelph foot repelled the Ghibelline. But Bigozzi commanded his reserve forward against the Guelph horse (despite his charge of defending the *carroccio*), steadying the formations of Ghibelline knights.

Back in Siena, a lookout on a high tower could observe the distant battlefield. Cerreto Ceccolini would have seen Siena’s white-above-black banners move as the fighting swayed back and forth into the afternoon and signaled or called out the advances and retreats to the citizens below. At some point, two dramatic events would set the day’s outcome.

First, a Florentine nobleman fighting with the Guelphs, Bocca degli Abati, suddenly revealed his true sympathies as Ghibelline (Event S16 BOCCA DEGLI ABATI). Approaching Firenze’s flag-bearer Iacopo Pazzi within the Guelph mass, as legend has it, Bocca degli Abati sudden cut Jacopo Pazzi’s hand off his arm, dropping the Florentine banner to the ground. The apparent loss of the banner confused the mass of Guelph knights and soldiers. As well, it probably was the signal for some hundreds of secret Ghibellines amongst them to attack, and a melee ensued within the Guelph lines.



Berchtold von Arras in the game.

Second, probably on signal from the Ghibelline lines, a flying column under Berchtold, Count of Arras, of Hohenstaufen contingent launched a sudden attack on the Guelph rear (Event S4 SUDDEN CLASH). Berchtold that morning had ridden a detachment wide around the Guelph flank toward the village of Montselvoli along the road to Montalcino. According to tradition, Berchtold in the attack personally slew Firenze’s *Podestà* Rangoni.



Lords and forces arrayed at Montaperti [Enrico Acerbi].

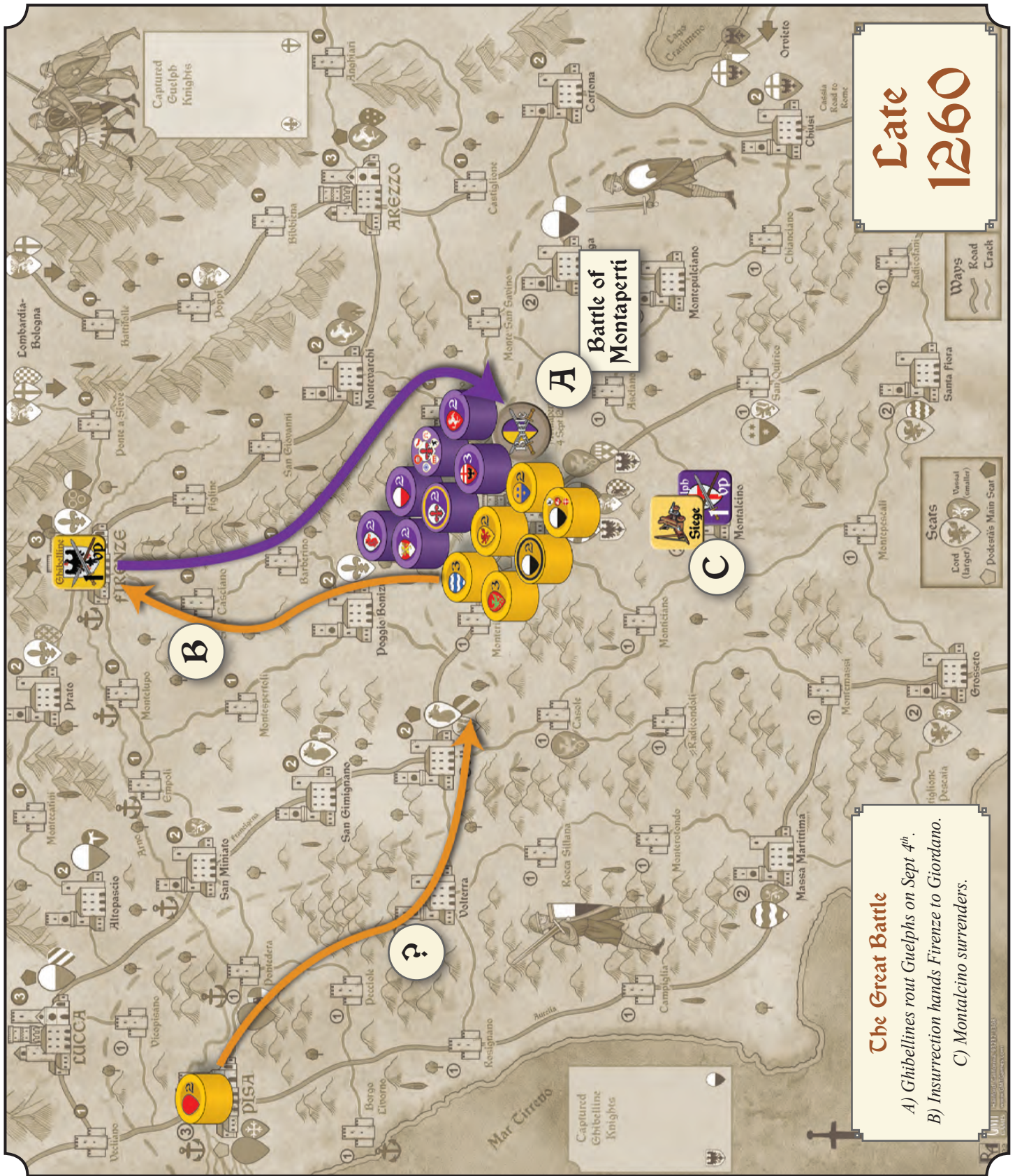
The unexpected twin counterattacks panicked the Guelph foot—so reliant for tactical effectiveness against the charge of knights on its tightly disciplined shield-and-crossbow teams—which broke formation. A great rout was on.

There would be no orderly concession of the field by the beaten army. Horsemen and foot soldiers alike scattered across the farm fields. Many of them, presumably, sought to splash across the Arbia toward Guelph lands to the north.

The Ghibelline pursuit was at first bent on blood rather than booty. By tradition, a great killing spree ensued, before passions calmed enough toward evening to begin the more usual and lucrative practice of gathering prisoners for eventual ransom. According

to legend, a woman, who had been travelling with the Guelph army to sell its provisions, on her own gathered up and arranged such ransom of three dozen Florentines—a story symbolic of the utterly beaten state of the Guelph knights and notables (Event S13 GENTLE USILIA).

A group of Lucchese and other Guelphs seeking safety found their way to the small Montaperti castle that overlooked the battlefield. Ghibellines soon surrounded the place and before long took it by force. Depending on what report is to be believed, they either accepted its occupant fugitives into captivity or literally cut them to pieces.



It is hard the number the dead of a battle. The winners always exaggerate, and the losers hide the truth. Florentine writers reported only 2,500 dead and 1,500 prisoners. but the number must have been greater, however less than the exaggeration of the Ghibellines historians. Other estimates cite 10,000 Guelph dead on the field, 4,000 missing, and 15,000 prisoners taken by the Sienese and their allies—along with Firenze's *carroccio*. Perhaps the Florentine numbers were just that city's portion of those total losses of the Guelph alliance. The Ghibellines in contrast reportedly suffered a mere 600 dead and 400 wounded. For that, they also seized from the Guelph camp almost 18,000 pack animals, oxen, horses, and other livestock.

Citizens back in Siena had received the news of their victory immediately, as their lookout beat a drum to announce the red lily banners' fall. They celebrated the victory with solemnity. They pulled the captured *Carroccio dei Fiorentini* into their walls backwards, as a sign of contempt. The city adopted the title of Holy Virgin's City, in devout acknowledgment of Heaven's role in the success.

By the next day, Firenze too had gotten word. News of the Ghibelline triumph lit off an insurrection in the city that within a week would force the city's Guelphs to flee, mostly to Lucca and some out of Tuscany to Bologna. Count Giordano quickly led his Germans and the Florentine Ghibellines who had fought at Montaperti north from Siena. They entered a now friendly Firenze September 12th.

In the intervening days, the inhabitants of Montalcino pled the Sienese for mercy and forgiveness for having been unfaithful. They obtained it September 8th, on the condition that they would keep themselves subject to the Sienese in perpetuity. Volterra would pledge its obedience to Manfredi in the next month.

By late September, the remaining Ghibelline exiles returned to Firenze as rulers. They razed the towers and houses of Guelph Florentines to the ground, as Guelphs had done against them in 1258. They made the citizens swear allegiance to the King. And at the end of the month, they convened a diet of the Ghibelline cities and lords of Tuscany.

This Council of Empoli was a sort of "Ghibelline parliament" that was to settle the political and economic arrangement of the region, particularly, how to consolidate royal authority and Ghibelline dominance. Representatives from Siena and Pisa proposed for that end the destruction of Florence itself. But Farinata, the leader of the Florentine Ghibellines, rose against the notion. He held sway and so saved the great city from further destruction.



Gold florins in the game.

The Ghibellines in October concerned themselves with collection of great ransoms for the prisoners from Montaperti: 5,000 golden florins for Lucca's Guelphs, the same sum for those from Arezzo, 3,500 for those from Orvieto. The Guelph Aldobrandeschi Count of Pitigliano had to pay 10,000 golden florins just for himself. Captors put Uliviero di Gherardino of Firenze's noble Cerchi

family bodily on a scale with all the weapons he had had on him and made him pay that equivalent weight in Sienese coin.

With the florins and Firenze in hand, the victors now had the means to crush any Tuscan Guelphs remaining in arms.

Casciate Ogne Speranza

Lasciate ogne speranza, voi ch'intrate.

"Abandon all hope, you who enter here."

[*Inferno* III 9]

1261—Aftermath. The apparent decision of Montaperti and Empoli might have doused Tuscan conflagration for a time. But now it was the turn of Guelph exiles to fan the flames. After the great battlefield defeat, the Guelphs of other cities participating in Firenze's defeated league also had taken refuge in Lucca. As the Sienese advanced into Florentine territory, conquering castles, the exiles mobilized. On September 20th, exiled Florentines disguised as pilgrims and aided by citizens of Lucca attempted to storm some Florentine castles. Arezzo as well remained defiant.

In November, Pope Alexander excommunicated all supporters within Tuscany of the King of Sicily. The act would harm Siena's commerce, as Italian Guelphs and foreigners too would take it as a pretext to set aside their debts to Sienese merchants and bankers. But in the shorter term, it only strengthened Ghibelline unity and would extend the alliance against Tuscan Guelphs into the spring.

In late November, Count Guido Novello Guidi, as the new Ghibelline *Podestà* of Florence, signed a treaty peace and friendship with Siena. The deal established municipal obligations across the region to hire and supply a mercenary army of allies called the *Taglia*, with Count Giordano as its commander (Ghibelline Event S23 TAGLIA).

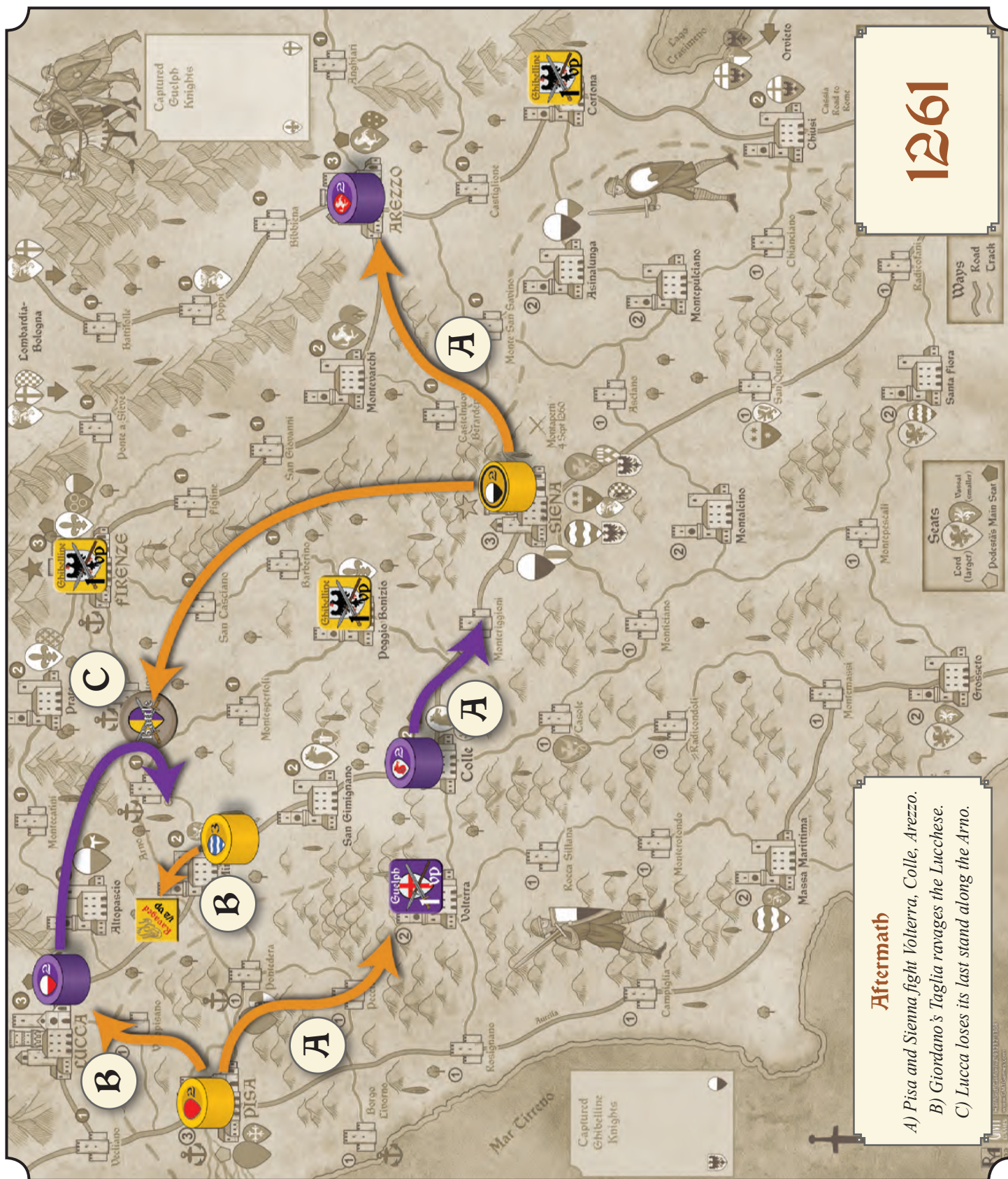
As the Ghibellines pressed their advantage into the winter—the Sienese seizing and ruining key border castles—Poggio Bonizio, Cortona, and Pistoia submitted or were overcome. By the end of January 1261, only Lucca and Arezzo still resisted.

Lucca as the new center of Guelph resistance, however, was enough to bring Volterra back in on its side against their mutual rival Pisa, and they fought the Pisans during February, wrecking some small castles. Siena, meanwhile, campaigned against Arezzo's forces and a renewed Guelph muster of Colle.

The Pisans in March claimed for themselves various castles that the Lucchesi had usurped in an earlier war with the Florentines. Then Giordano marched his *Taglia* army on Lucca and its Guelph exiles, ravaging its lands. Outnumbered by the Ghibelline League, the Lucchesi and the exile forces from across Tuscany in their despair resisted vigorously.

By April, after the Sienese-led offensive on Arezzo, Lucca stood alone within Tuscany. Lucchesi castles fell not only Pisa but also to Guido Novello on behalf of Ghibelline Firenze. Guelph exiles collected at Fucecchio held out for a 30-day siege then succumbed.

With Ghibelline might apparently overwhelming, Count Giordano in May 1261 departed Tuscany. A new Ghibellines League formed May 23rd and, led by Manfredi's lieutenant Guido Novello, it included Siena, Firenze, Pisa, Pistoia, Prato, Volterra, and San



Miniato. Not content to leave the Guelphs a single refuge within Tuscany, this League sent out yet another army against Lucca.

That summer, the Guelph forces marched up the Arno in a desperate attempt to keep contact with Arezzo and bar the way from Firenze towards Lucca and Pisa. At a spot where the road along the lower Valdarno enters a defile between the hills, they arrayed in defense. But the inequality in forces was too great, and the Ghibelline host easily routed them.



Lucca today (photo by Myrabella).

The Ghibelline army marched on Lucca, reduced the city, and by September had its government in Ghibelline hands. The Pisans, eager to recover earlier losses, were now the most activist anti-Guelphs within the League, in defiance of the usual papal censures. The victors, however, did not require the Lucchese to exile their own Guelphs, only that every non-native Guelph be thrown out the gates.

The Tuscan civil war at last sputtered out. Montepulciano in late spring reared up in a renewed by brief defiance against Siena (see Ghibelline Event S22 CLOSED GATES). The Sienese promptly marched an army there and—when the town refused to open its gates—besieged it. It took only to the 5th of June for the citizens to surrender. For their temerity, they received Provenzano Salvani as their new *podestà*.

In August, the Guelphs of Arezzo seized power and expelled Ghibellines from the city. In a familiar sequence, the Aretine exiles again sought help their faction's adherents in other cities. Large numbers of armed groups arrived in Arezzo's countryside, in a matter of days stormed and took possession of the fortified places there, and left the city encircled.

After Lucca in September implemented its surrender terms, the region's new overseers compelled Tuscany's dispossessed Guelphs to depart on three days' notice for the rugged and roadless mountain barrier which separated them from Bologna, their nearest refuge. Old and young, women and children, made that terrible journey across the Apennines.

In October 1261, the Guelph wanderers reached Bologna in a most miserable state, most of them thenceforth utterly dependent for bread upon charity.

A Crescer La Vendetta

*Se tu non vieni a crescer la vendetta
di Montaperti, perché mi moleste?*

*“Unless you come to add to the revenge
for Montaperti, why do you molest me?”*

[Bocca, in Hell, to Dante – *Inferno* XXXII 80-81]

Late 1200s—Outcomes. Within a year of Montaperti, Manfredi's nemesis Pope Alexander IV died at his Viterbo fortress refuge. While the event would have seemed to seal the definitive victory of the Hohenstaufen cause and the Ghibelline party over the Guelph, it merely opened the next chapter. The new pope, Urban IV, called for help from Charles of Anjou, brother of the King of France. Charles would intervene militarily in Italy as a chief of the Guelphs, claim the Kingdom of Sicily, and March from Rome to southern Italy to destroy the Hohenstaufen presence once and for all.

At the Battle of Benevento in 1266, Anjou horse destroyed Manfredi's army and killed the King. Within days, Italy's Hohenstaufen vassals declared for Anjou. Manfredi's queen and her children died in Anjou prisons, condemned by a new pope, Clement IV. When the Swabian heir Conradin attempted to enforce his birthright, the Angevins in 1268 captured and—in their new of southern Italian capital of Naples—beheaded him. A few noble supporters fled to Barcelona, where Manfredi's daughter Constance Hohenstaufen was the wife of the heir to Aragón.



Charles of Anjou and his army (from Villani).

Guelphs soon regained their footing in Tuscany, defeating Siena at the Battle of Colle in 1269, at which Sienese commander Provenzano Salvani fell.

The Guelphs zealously consolidated their political power within Firenze and in Siena as well. With no foe remaining, Florentine Guelphs divided against one another, the moderate “Whites” under the Cerchi family versus the radical “Blacks” under the Donati. When the Blacks won the upper hand, naturally they drove their White rivals out the gates, among them Dante Alighieri, who would compose his *Divine Comedy* from permanent exile.



On Banners

We know that Latins were not accustomed to having fluttering banners; the Romans had *Vexilla* and *Insignia*, or vertical *Labari* (from which derived the medieval *Gonfaloni*). *Bandiera* (flag) is a high-medieval word, pertinent to those peoples who used to tie a rag to a pole, in order to signal the position on the battlefield. So some tell that *Bandiera* comes from the word *Band* (band, drape) which was actually a Gothic term (*Bhand*): band translated in something that is bound; *bhand* also known as the English “to bind”.

The Germans have two synonymous words: *Fahne* and *Flagge*. The word flag (*Fahne*) originally meant a fabric and comes from a Middle High German word *van(e)*, or the Old High German word *Fano*, in Goth *Fana*. These are all words that could derive from the Latin *pannus* and therefore from the Greek *pênê* (tissue).

Here, curiously, we are in presence of an Italian word, that comes from German, and a German word that comes from Latin. Incredible! *Fahne*, therefore, meaning a national or battle insignia, came to us by contracting an ancient High German word: *Gundfano*, which means combat-fabric (see also the Italian medieval term *Gonfalone*). The word *Flagge* comes from “sea”. This term (also the English “flag”) passed through the Lower-German language to the Higher-German, due to the contraction of the phrase *schlaff hängen* (hang a rag) or from a possible Old-Nordic (Gothic) word *flagra*, meaning a “fluttering thing”.

The German “*die Flagge streichen*” translates as the English “striking the colours”. Here, the use of the English term “colours” becomes interesting. Why colors? From around 1300, the word “colours” was the distinctive sign of identification (color which came from a coat-of-arms or a livery, obtained as a prize by a knight, for example.) Originally, the colors meant those of the family’s coat-of-arms. So, in medieval times, the coat-of-arms became the symbol of the power and the colors were the symbol of the people subordinate to that power.

Where feudal lords ruled, there were no national flags, but only coats of arms or banners. As German feudal lordships evolved from small fiefs to duchies, grand duchies, and so on, they created their own bi- or tricolor flags. Coats of arms remained the symbol of power and appear on war flags, while the “colours” were exhibited during festivals or special occasions, almost as if indicating an embryonic concept of nation.

Later, where a government was not the same as a noble house, national colors overrode coats of arms. On the battlefield, the emergence from the Renaissance onward of companies’ flags and regimental flags further complicated the matter. Flags also answered the need to recognize ships at sea. For around two centuries, the various national states recognized themselves and each other by the naval flags of each. The need for a true national flag came to Europe only in the mid-19th Century.

In wargaming, we often search for a symbol or a banner of a nation or a party that has a role in the simulation, forgetting that, for centuries, the concept of “nation” (meaning a people) did not exist at all; there were only states. A people existed *de facto* in the medieval Italian *comuni*, where the banners of the city (a kind of

symbol for a nation), those of the *comune* (symbols of the government of the *podestà*’s), and those of the people (symbols of the subjects and their captains) were different within the same army.

The most striking case was the city of Pisa, where the city banner that terrorized the seas was fully red (a “bloody flag” it was called), while the renowned Pisan flag with the Occitan Cross was merely the people’s banner common after the year 1300 and initially hoisted only by the people’s infantry (so not from Pisa’s ships).



Firenze’s Guelphs had their uniformly applied red lily or cross on white. But the knights companies of the city’s *Sestieri* each had their own signs: Oltrarno in white, San Piero Scheraggio cross of black and yellow; Borgo vertical bands of white and blue, San Pancrazio red and white, Porta del Duomo all vermillion, and Porta San Piero yellow.

Arts of War – Notes

This section details each side’s Arts of War Events and Capabilities with their texts, the Lords they affect, tips on implementing them, and historical background. The back of this booklet lists the Arts of War decks’ card titles at a glance.

Guelph Events

(top half of card)

F1. AMBUSH

Hold: Play as Enemy Avoids Battle (4.3.4). Enemy chooses 1 Avoiding Lord to Battle or Withdraw instead

Lords. Any Ghibelline.

Tips. Play of AMBUSH after one or a group of inactive Lords declare Avoid Battle (4.3.4) forces the owner to choose any one of those Lords (including Commander with Comune) to instead stay in the Locale and either Defend in Battle or Withdraw into a Friendly Stronghold there (if it has one). Other Avoiding Lords must depart.

History. On September 21, 1250, a Guelph ambush at Figline Valdarno routed what at that time was a Ghibelline army Firenze, an example of the many surprise attacks that characterized fighting in 13th-Century Tuscany. The winding dirt roads crossing the hilly region, rich in vegetation and forests, facilitated such ambushes, especially at obligatory passages in the journey from one locale to the next. Armies could be advantageously attacked while in the process of assembling at camp.

Ambush of the enemy while on the move was a key tactic to defend against raiders. In open country, a fast moving cavalry force could surprise an invader (see also Event F4 SUDDEN CLASH). In hills or mountains, it was foot troops that could best ambush an enemy.

Throughout the communal age in Italy, combatants also practiced raiding as bait, to lure the enemy into a prepared snare. In 1256, the Podestà of Padua masterfully applied the expedient against the

Bassanesi followers of Ezzelino da Romano: during the night of July 3rd, he moved to Cittadella with numerous knights and *berrovieri*. There, he told a core of them the next morning to “cross the countryside of Bassano and prey on its cattle” and lead them to Cittadella while he, with the rest of the contingent, remained hidden there. [DNa p46; AS p44]

F2. BETRAYALS

For each Stronghold with any Guelph Siege markers, roll on Revolt table *or* add 1 Treachery

Lords. Any Guelph (for Treachery).

Tips. Count the number of Sieges underway by the side playing the card (each Besieged Enemy Stronghold counts as one). That side may choose to roll on its Revolt table a number of times (1.4.2) plus select and add a number of currently set-aside Treachery cards to its Command deck (1.4.3) in sum equal to that number of Besieged Strongholds. The player may see the outcome of a Revolt roll before deciding what to choose next.

History. There are countless cases of treason to the word given affecting the siege of castles. In 1241, the marquis Giacomo del Carretto took the castle of Segno after a long and involved siege when a relief army betrayed the garrison by delaying its approach [https://www.treccani.it/enciclopedia/del-carretto-giacomo-marchese-del-finale_(Dizionario-Biografico)/]. The next year, Ezzelino da Romano took and ruined the Veronese fortress of Arcole in the same way. In 1260, the defenders of the castle and the very strong tower of San Zenone, where Alberico da Romano had locked himself up, after four months of resistance themselves handed it over to the enemy in order to ingratiate themselves with those who now seemed the sure winners. [AS pp 153-154]

F3. SURPRISE

Hold: Play upon Besieging a Stronghold where no other Lord (4.3.5). Place 2 Siege (not 1). Then Storm up to 3 Rounds, Walls –2

Lords. Any Guelph.

Tips. The Lord involved must be of the side playing the card and may not be a group (neither Commander with other Lords nor a Lieutenant, but may be a Commander with Comune). The Lord must have just Marched to an Enemy Stronghold Locale where there are neither Enemy nor Friendly Lords already. Place two Siege markers instead of the usual one (4.3.5). An immediate Storm for at least one Round is mandatory (4.5.2), costing no actions, and may continue to three Rounds even though there are only two Siege markers. Walls –2 means treat Walls 1-4 as Walls 1-2 (or 1-3 if Walls +1 marker). Siegeworks of two markers will give the Attacker Walls 1-2 (4.5.2).

History. A medieval force, if it approached an enemy stronghold quickly or stealthily enough or with the help of traitors inside or other local assistance, might seize it through sudden attack, a *coup de main*—perhaps by scaling the walls in dark of night. The Guelphs of Arezzo managed in this way speedily to subdue the rebels of Cortona—see Campaign History, page 21.

F4. SUDDEN CLASH

Hold: Play on a Guelph Lord in Battle. Round 1, that Lord’s Horse Melee precedes all Archery and selects its targets

Lords. Any Guelph.

Tips. Use of the Event shifts Melee by Horse units on one mat (not a Commander’s Podestà and Comune both) of the playing side in Round 1 ahead of both sides’ Archery in the Strike Initiative order (4.4.2). If both sides play SUDDEN CLASH, the selected Defending Lord’s Horse Melee is first, then affected Attacker’s, then the rest. Also, that Lord’s Horse Melee Round 1 selects targets as described under 4.4.2 ASSIGN HITS TO UNITS.

History. See Ghibelline Event S4 SUDDEN CLASH.

F5. ROAD WORKS – *Woodcutters clear the way*

This Campaign Guelph Lords treat Track as Road and move Laden as if Unladen

Lords. All Guelphs.

Tips. Any Guelph this March can take up to two Provender per Cart Unladen, but not more than that. Also, the first such March Way costs 0 actions even if Track (4.3.2-.3). Discard the card at Turn’s end.

History. In contrast to Roman times, medieval settlements sought out high ground to protect themselves from attacks. Access routes to these small towns were difficult and tortuous and often ran along ridges to grant a better view of the surroundings, avoid rivers or streams, and thereby reduce the danger of ambushes. Roman roads posed danger and often became neglected or travelled only for short stretches. Built on flatter land, those in abandoned areas often came under flood or landslide and were covered in mud.



The new medieval roads were seldom built outright. Rather, they evolved from paths worn by continuous passage of carts and animals, especially pack animals (mules), and human travellers. But a few examples were paved with sandstone slabs, bricks in a herringbone pattern, or other abundant and inexpensive local materials—generally, only for short stretches where drainage was poor. [Emanuela Morelli, *Strade e paesaggi della Toscana*, p60]

Firenze’s army in 1260 included 100 marraioli a body of workmen equipped with the marra, a sort of hoe with a triangular blade, to pave the ground in front of the marching army. They received a salary identical to the “wasters” 12 *denarii*, for each day of active service. Specialties in Firenze’s rural militia also included *segatori* (saw men), *picconari* (pickaxe men), and *palaiuoli* (shovel men). (See also Capability F2 GUASTATORI.) [DB p76; DNa p12]

F6. HILLS

Hold: May play Defending in Battle. Double Guelph Archery Hits, added Hits as Bowmen not Crossbow

Lords. All Guelphs.

Tips. Play HILLS at the outset of Battle (4.4.1 Events), not in Storm and only if Defending. It increases the Hits from all of your side’s Archery throughout that Battle. It does not affect Melee. Total all Hits against each target Lord, double that amount,

then round. Any added Hits from doubling Crossbow Archery do not reduce Enemy Armor and never select their targets (4.4.2 ASSIGN HITS TO UNITS). Round any such odd or half Hits to count as Crossbows.

EXAMPLE: Firenze with its Comune Flanking Strike a single Ghibelline Lord. The Podesta has 3x Militia and ARCIERI, which would usually total three Archery Hits. The Comune has 5x Armigeri with BALESTRIERI and PALVESARI, which usually would add five Crossbow Hits (–2 to Armor) that select targets. If Defending with HILLS, the two Firenze mats Striking a single Ghibelline Lord would double the usual eight Archery Hits to a mighty 16 Hits, of which still only five Hits would count as Crossbows and thus select their targets and apply a –2 to Armor Protection rolls.

History. Large areas of Tuscany are hilly. Hilltops—mandatory locales for villages as well as castles—saw any forests covering the summit cut for construction timber and the better to dominate access all around. A defending force could position on high ground to extend the range and field of view of its archers as any attacker approached. The importance crossbows—relatively slow-firing but stalwart and deadly accurate from a well-defended position (see Capabilities F9-F11 BALESTRIERI and F13-F15 PALVESARI)—meant that selection of good defensive ground remained a focus of communal armies’ battle tactics, including fieldworks such as timber barricades to give archers even more staying power against shock forces such as heavy horse. [DNa pp 37, 39; DNb p46]

F7. GREEK FIRE

Hold: Play on Besieging Lord to reduce to 1 Siege marker, remove 1 of his units, and discard 1 of his “This Lord” Capabilities

Lords. Any Ghibelline.

Tips. Play at any time (even in the midst of Storm). Choose any one Enemy Lord outside any Besieged Stronghold (the Lord need not be Active). Select one unit and one “This Lord” Capability card (if any) at his mat(s): he removes that unit to the pool and discards that card. Remove any Siege markers there beyond one.

History. Since both the attacker and the defender made use of incendiary compositions, all wooden materials exposed to the enemy in a storm had to be protected against fire by freshly skinned cattle skins, earth layers, or spongy materials soaked in vinegar. Wax, oil, and pitch could make liquid fire. Assault machines could rain not only stones but also fire on enemy works. But the main use of fire was to drop it from above onto besiegers working at or preparing to assault the walls. Siennese garrisons used pots of “greek fire” as early as 1229. [AS pp 77-182; DNa p40]



“It seems that the main ingredient was nephta (naphtha) or petroleum, the lightest of all oils, and that when it is pure, as soon as it is in contact with the air it ignites; the sulfur and pitch were mixed with it: the water was unable to extinguish it. In the burning it produced huge explosions.” [LP p138]

F8. SWAMP

Hold: May play Defending in non-Summer Battle. Ghibelline Horse does not Strike in Round 1

Lords. All Ghibellines.

Tips. Play at the outset of Battle (4.4.1 Events), not Storm, not on Attack, and not if the current Turn is in Summer. It prevents all Horse units of all Enemy Lords from Striking in the first Round. It does affect their ability to absorb Hits.

History. Tuscany’s steep slopes favored cultivation of hilltops’ lighter soils, neither arid nor susceptible to flooding, workable with a hoe rather than needing demanding and expensive plowing. It was therefore not just military matters that situated medieval villages on heights. The road system that climbed the hills was raised in between them to avoid the frequent flooding of the countryside. Therefore, in these areas away from dense settlement, the plains were left not only as meadow but often as marsh or swamp—poor ground for cavalry. [MV pXVI]

F9. GENOVA breaks Pisan blockade

Shift Firenze, Lucca, and Colle cylinder or Service 1 Calendar box each or add 1 of their Treachery

Lords. Firenze, Lucca, and Colle.

Tips. The Guelph player chooses the direction of all shifts so would shift all these Friendly cylinders on the Calendar left and Service markers right. Instead, the player could select any one Treachery card that is currently set aside (not one already available or in the Plan) to add to the Guelph Command deck.

History. As Italian affairs after 1250 shifted in focus away from imperial versus papal conflict to the contest among multiple hegemonic cities, Pisa emerged as a swing state between Firenze and Siena. A great sea trading and naval power, Pisa had interests and problems far beyond Tuscany, however. In the 1260s, it fought alongside Venice against its most dangerous Guelph maritime rival Genova, had to keep watch on its Guelph neighbor Lucca and a rebellious Volterra. Pisa therefore could send little help to Siena. (See also Campaign History, page 23; Guelph Event F19 VOLTERRA; and Ghibelline Event S11 VOLTERRA.)

Genova too might have intervened in the Tuscan conflict, particularly had it seen advantage in thereby thwarting or perhaps outbidding Pisan influence. Tommasi’s *History of Siena* mentions 2,000 Genovese archers joining Siena’s army. But of these there is no evidence on the battlefield, and there is no mention of them in the Genovese *Annals of Caffaro*, where those records discuss the day of Montaperti.

In reality, Guelph Genova could not send aid to anyone, because Pisan galleys blockaded it by sea. In *Inferno*, this Event supposes that the Genovese are able to get past the Pisans and choose to aid their fellow Guelphs rather than Ghibelline Siena. [CP p40]

F10. CLOSED GATES

Remove 1 gold Ruins *or*, if none, remove 1 purple Ruins where Stronghold then eligible for Revolt (1.4.1); it Revolts (1.4.4)

Lords. None.

Tips. Remove any one Ruins giving the other side ½VP. If there are none on the map, instead replace a Ruins benefitting your side with Allegiance markers equal to the Stronghold Value. Eligible means that there cannot be an Enemy Lord there.

History. Rebellious towns repeatedly renewed their resistance in this period, even after violent suppression. Siena in the summer of 1260 named Provenzano Salvani chief of an army to go storm Montepulciano, which the Sienese succeeded in subduing. But a year later, in June to July 1261, the still rebellious town at least briefly closed its gates to the Ghibellines until Siena again pressed them to concede: “Montepulciano promises to choose the Podestà among the Sienese, to pay a tax of 50 pounds and to consider the Sienese as their allies.” [FC entry for 5 July 1261; RS p13]

F11. POGGIO BONIZIO *answers Firenze's call*

Hold: Play if Poggio Bonizio Guelph to give a Lord Lordship +3 OR add 1 Treachery

Lords. Any Guelph.

Tips. Play the Event only at any moment that Poggio Bonizio (near map center) is free of Ghibelline 1VP (gold) Allegiance markers. Play it during either Muster (3.4) or, if declared, Call to Arms Allies (3.5.4) to add three to the Lordship rating of any one Guelph Lord. Or play it to select any one set-aside Guelph Treachery card—not one then in the Plan—to add to the Command deck.

History. A Florentine chronicle records the aid that Poggio Bonizio (modern Poggibonsi)—earlier resistant and a key point along the route from Firenze to Siena—afforded first Guelph offensive of 1260:



“In the Friday VIIIth exiting April [April 23rd], already anoted Location. It was stated and signed by Dominus Jacopinum Rangonis, by grace Podestà of Firenze, and by six older citizens of the City's People, who together went in Campaign and by the army Capitanei, under request by Sinibaldo Tornaquinci, for the Florentine Comune Podestà at Poggio Bonizio and the communal ambassadors of that town, what could have been useful to send: how many men of that town were allowed to be a part, temporarily, of the present army, which proudly had to march towards Siena.” [LM p68]

F12. CAMP ATTACK

Hold: My play in Battle. Round 1, take 2 Assets from each Enemy Lord there as Spoils, then remove 2 more from each

Lords. All Ghibellines.

Tips. Play CAMP ATTACK at the outset of Battle (4.4.1 Events), not Storm. Take and remove Enemy Assets as specified on the card (including from both a Commander's Podestà and Comune as separate Lords) at any one time during Round 1, distributing taken Assets among Friendly Lords at the Battle (4.4.3) even if

Conceding the Field. Spoils may not include Ships, but removed Assets may (representing other affairs diverting the Pisan navy).

History. In the Middle Ages, cavalry normally camped in the field without preparing the ground with special obstacles, as the art of encampments had declined. Mixed armies used to camp in different ways according to the customs of the country, the amount of forces, the aims of the military enterprise, and so on. There were fields of very different types: with tents and without tents; surrounded by small ditches and parapets, or simply protected by natural terrain obstacles; or more simply still defended by special troops, drawn from the bulk and in charge of vigilance and first resistance in the event of an attack—an event which was quite common. [LP pp 126-130]

F13. NO TIME FOR COWARDS

Shift Firenze, Arezzo, *and* Lucca cylinders or Service 1 Calendar box each *or* add 1 of their Treachery

Lords. Firenze, Arezzo, Lucca.

Tips. The Guelph player chooses the direction of shifts (Friendly cylinders left and Service markers right) or instead selects any one set-aside Guelph Treachery card to add to the Command deck.

History. Citizens of the largest and proudest Tuscan city-states often spurred military aggression:

“Messer Cece de' Gherardini rose to speak in the Florentine Council and was about to advocate the obvious wisdom of a short delay in the beginning of the war operations, when one of the elders of the people reminded him that any citizen speaking without the permission of the elders was liable to a fine of a hundred lire. 'I will speak and pay the fine,' said Cece. 'You have spoken and incurred the fine; and if you proceed will incur a repetition of it,' said the popular leader. 'So be it!' said Cece, and again proceeded to speak. 'Three hundred lire, if you utter another word' retorted the overbearing citizen. 'I will pay three hundred for the privilege of saving my countrymen from ruin' returned the patriotic Gherardini. But the 'Anziani' [elder], rising, told him that if he persisted further he should pay not with lire, but with his head. And this was a price difficult to sustain.” [Trollope T. Adolphus, A History of the Commonwealth of Florence, p153]

F14. PROVENZANO *sent as ambassador*

If Guelph Siege underway, shift Provenzano cylinder or Service 2 Calendar boxes *or* add 1 Treachery

Lords. Provenzano (for shift) or any Guelph (for Treachery).

Tips. Implement this Event only if at least one Guelph (purple) Siege marker is somewhere on the map. The Guelph player chooses whether to shift Provenzano's cylinder right or Service marker left (if either is on the Calendar) or to add any one set-aside Treachery card to the Guelph Command deck.

History. Siena on March 17th of 1260 sent an important embassy to Manfredi of Sicily to seek even more knights and soldiers to be able to face a building Florentine threat of open field battle.

“... Then a new embassy was decided, and again the Count Gerdano was prayed, that he would have also to send some of his family, to ask the king to provide for the Tuscany event well and

with honor (bene et honorifice). Accepting the proposal, the elected ambassadors left Siena. ... They were either, for the commune, Messer Buonatacca di Tacca Sansedoni, Messer Buonaguida Bocacci, and Provenzano Salvani or, for Count Giordano, Messer Guglielmo Villani, one of his advisers."

It took until May for Provenzano's mission to net Siena a southern reinforcement of German knights, Lucera archers, and "Greeks" (presumably Byzantine troops of some sort). [CP p19; RS p13]



F15. CASOLE

Hold: Play for Firenze Treachery at a Castle to succeed for 0 Coin or to add Firenze Treachery

Lords. Firenze.

Tips. Play at the moment that Firenze's Podestà uses his Treachery card for Revolt (4.7.5) or Bribe (4.7.6) when the target is or is at a Castle for that Treachery to succeed automatically without committing or paying any Coin. For Revolt, the Castle must be eligible (1.4.1). Or play whenever Firenze's Treachery card (only) remains or has been set aside (neither in the Command deck nor in the Plan) to add it to the Guelph deck.

History. On April 19th, 1260, the General Council of Siena heard that the Florentines "*intendunt venire in contrata de Colle, silicet tota militia et balestariis, et deinde ire ad exercitum apud Montemassi, et insultum facere in illos de exercitu*" (intended to come to Colle, with all militia and crossbowmen, and then proceed to Montemassi, for the army storm them). So, the Sienese headed for Colle first, arriving on April 21st; two days later they broke camp and took the way toward Mensano and Casole. The city of Siena sent warm exhortations the people of those two lands to hold firmly, with a promise to restore the damage that their enemies would do them.



But the large host of Guelphs arrived there first and easily seized Casole and Mensano, with just a few days' siege. Mensano's inhabitants surrendered at once, as only the Sienese garrison there resisted. The mayor of Casole on April 27th and the mayor of Mensano on May 6th submitted in the field to the government and elders of Firenze. They swore, on behalf of their communes and the people of their lands, that they wished Florentine rule from then on and were ready to make war on the Sienese. [RS p13]

F16. A BLOODY RED STREAM – Desperate stand

Hold: Play in Battle for first Guelph Lord who Routs instead to roll each unit's Protection now to recover from Rout

Lords. Any Guelph.

Tips. Play at the outset of Battle (4.4.1 Events). At the first moment (only) in that Battle that absorbing a Hit causes a Guelph Lord to Rout (4.4.2, possibly either a Commander's Podestà or Comune), pause and roll each of his Routed units' unmodified Protection as if checking for Loss (4.4.4)—success shifts those units back up into the Forces section of their mat; failure has no effect. If at least one Routed unit recovers, that Lord does not (yet) Rout. Then continue with any additional Hits and Battle steps.

History. On the 4th of September 1260, Guelphs and Ghibellines fought that great and long-remembered battle—Montaperti—that, as the poet Dante wrote, "*fece l'Arbia colorata in rosso*" (colored the river Arbia red). In truth, the solid strength of the German mercenary knights under their leader Giordano d'Agliano, the military prowess of the Ghibelline nobles, and the superior strategy of Florentine exile Farinata degli Uberti were more than a match for the far less homogeneous forces of the alliance of Guelph cities and towns. Despite those Guelphs' most desperate and unyielding valor, they suffered utter defeat. [Trollope T. Adolphus, *A History of the Commonwealth of Florence*, pp 154-155]

F17. FOREIGN HELP

Shift Guido or Orvieto Service 2 boxes or, if desired, set aside 1 Treachery from Guelph deck to shift their cylinders left to current Levy

Lords. Guido Guerra or Orvieto (for shifts) and any Guelph (for Treachery).

Tips. Shift Service right, or instead select any one Guelph Treachery card already acquired for and still in the Guelph Command deck (not from the Plan) to set aside again in order to shift one or both Guido Guerra's or Orvieto's cylinder into the current Turn's box from anywhere on the Calendar to the right of that box. If neither Service marker is on the Calendar, the Guelph player may but is not required to so set aside a Treachery card. If setting aside a Treachery card and only one of the two named Lords has a cylinder on the Calendar to the right of the current Turn, the player may move that cylinder only.

History. It was not only Siena's cause that sought military reinforcement from outside Tuscany: Firenze and the region's Guelphs called in allies from the southeast around to the north, where the Pope held sway. Collapse of the northern Italian Ghibellines in late 1259 (see Campaign History, Summer-Autumn 1259, page 21) opened the way to northern Guelph aid to Firenze, which in the spring engaged soldiers from the Lombardia and Romagna regions. The main residence at Poppi Castle Florentine Guelph noble Guido Guerra's family, the *Conti Guidi*, lay along an important route south from these regions.

When Siena in mid-1260 drove eastward to destroy the rebels of Montepulciano and free the route toward Cortona, Montepulciano sought and received urgent help on behalf of the Pope from the town of Orvieto (*Orbis Vetus*) to the southeast. [CP p32]

At Montaperti, troops from Milano, Bologna, and the northern Guelph League fought under Guido Guerra, (who held the title *Capitaneus pro Ecclesia* – "Captain of the Church") and who after the defeat in turn briefly found refuge in Romagna. As Guelph resistance in Tuscany reduced to, Guido Guerra as Captain of the people organized guerrilla warfare against the Ghibellines from there. [RS p13]

F18. GROSSETO

Hold: Play for Treachery at Grosseto to succeed for 0 Coin *or*, if Grosseto Guelph, to shift Santa Fiora cylinder or Service 2 boxes

Lords. Any Guelph (for Treachery) and Santa Fiora (for shifts).

Tips. For the first option, play for any Guelph Treachery Revolt or Bribe (4.7.5 or 4.7.6) to succeed automatically without committing or paying any Coin, as long as the target is or is at Grosseto. For Revolt, Grosseto must be eligible (1.4.1). The benefit is that the Lord on the card need not be near Grosseto but may be anywhere on the map, including Besieged or Bypassed.

For the second option, play at any time that Grosseto is marked with Guelph Allegiance markers to shift Santa Fiora's cylinder right (if on the Calendar) or his Service marker left (if he is Mustered).

History. Shortly after Count Giordano's arrival at Siena in December 1259, the town of Grosseto in the domain of the Aldobrandeschi Counts of Santa Fiora rebelled a second time against Ghibelline and Imperial authority. (See Campaign History, Early 1260—Grosseto's War, page 23). [CP p18]



F19. VOLTERRA

Hold: Play to use Treachery at Volterra to succeed for 0 Coin *or*, if Volterra Guelph, to shift Pisa cylinder or Service 2 boxes

Lords. Any Guelph (for Treachery) and Pisa (for shifts).

Tips. See Event F18 GROSSETO above: VOLTERRA works the same, applied instead to the Town of Volterra or to Pisa's Podestà.

History. The important bastion town of Volterra suffered a particularly complicated internal situation even by medieval Tuscan standards, as its Ghibelline *comune* struggled against the Guelph Bishop of Volterra. The *comune* benefitted from crumbling episcopal power in Volterra's countryside (*Volterrano*) and the nearby Val d'Elsa, as new communities, more modest than Colle, San Gimignano, or Poggio Bonizio, emerged and aspired to similar autonomy. But Volterra's bishop remained powerful. In the summer of 1254, Firenze intervened and subdued Volterra by force:



"Of the cities, in which the Ghibelline part in Tuscany was superior, one was Volterra, but the fortress of the site of that city, for which it was reputed for one of the strongest in Italy; because it was placed on a prominent place, it did not give the Florentines any hope of having victory. Therefore, we turned around more with the intention of giving it the fault around it, and returning to Firenze, than with thought to conquer the city. For this reason, when they arrived for the countryside and vineyards of Volterra, they started putting them on fire." [Scipione Ammirato, *Istorie Fiorentine*]

The machinations within and about Volterra affected Pisa's willingness and ability to aid Siena, as any Guelph control of Volterra threatened Pisa's flank. Volterra's Ghibelline sympathies similarly could rein in Guelph Colle, even nearer by. (See Ghibelline Event S11 VOLTERRA.) [RS p11; Paolo Cammarosano, *Storia di Colle di Val d'Elsa nel Medioevo* Vol.2 - Colle nell'età di Arnolfo di Cambio, Studi, CERM, Trieste, 2009.]

F20. HEAT & FROST

Play before Feed in Summer or Winter for Wastage (4.9.5) now, twice at Siege or if Moved / Fought. If Summer, remove 1 Ritter

Lords. All Ghibellines and all Guelphs.

Tips. Implement the Event only if Summer or Winter and immediately before any Lord(s) having Moved/Fought triggers Feed (4.8.1). All Lords of both sides conduct Wastage, each proceeding twice through 4.9.5 if at a Locale with Siege markers or marked Moved / Fought. The removed unit goes to the pool, not Captured Knights.

History. A large part of the military activity that would begin each the spring had its natural continuation in the summer—a good campaign season, though not always favorable. The heat of Italy's summer could feel oppressive and even become harmful, in particular to fighters from northerly regions. In September 1243, during a clash on the Mincio, many horses died of the heat. The Milanese Lodi expedition in July 1250 became known as the "army of the swelter" for the heat and dust endured during its return. More than 200 infantry died from the heat during the siege by Brescia and Mantova of the Cremonese castle of Covo in June 1266.



Along with the dust, the thirst and the danger of heat stroke, a summer war usually added the presence of annoying insects attracted by gatherings of men and the large numbers of animals that necessarily accompanied them. The siege of Brescia by Friedrich II in the summer of 1238 suffered an epidemic caused, according to a chronicler of Cremona, by the immense number of flies:

"You could [barely] eat without swallowing [them] with food because they flew directly into the mouth. ... The tops of the pavilions and other tents seemed tinged with the black color of the night by the quantity of insects that were placed on them." [AS pp 224-225]

Winter campaigns offered their own challenges, of course. As narrated by the Malavolti chronicle, the first Florentine campaign against Siena in 1260 began with wintertime raids and "cavallate" into Siennese territory. But the Florentines soon gave that up "because of the difficulties of the winter." Florentine writers are silent about these first forays that winter, but the report is realistic, as the city states often launched raids to harm and shame the enemy even before declaration of war. [CP p10]

F21. PRIMO POPOLO – Guelph merchant class

Shift Firenze *or* Arezzo cylinder or Service 2 Calendar boxes *or* add 1 of their Treachery

Lords. Firenze *or* Arezzo

Tips. Shift cylinder left or Service right. Add Treachery only if that card is set aside (not already added or in the Plan).

History. As historian David Nicolle ably summarizes, medieval Italy "saw the development of two distinct military systems, the feudal or largely rural armies, raised and led by the old local aristocracies, and the communal or urban forces raised by cities. ... The Pope-Emperor, Guelph-Ghibelline struggle overlapped this process, ... while political tensions within cities tended to emerge once external threats receded. This in turn led to the podestà system in which a respected

‘foreign’ or outside figure was invited to take control—though his powers were strictly limited and supervised by the city’s own consuls.” (See also Ghibelline Event S21 CONSTITUTO.)

The wealthy and populous Italian *comuni* could raise remarkably large militia armies. And even as republics, they could still levy forces from a local rural aristocracy, who recognized quasi-feudal obligations to the city as its surrogate “lord”.

But these large armies’ expense and the interruption to the commerce so important to the cities kept campaigns short and, even so, led over time to exorbitant taxes and stricter political controls. By the mid-13th Century, Lombardy’s communal militias waned, and heavily armoured, professional cavalry gradually regained dominance.

In Tuscany, however, communal militias survived to form the base for new republican government. In Firenze, for example, an increasingly influential merchant middle class in 1250 took over from established consular aristocracies and established a *Primo Popolo* (“First People’s”) government by the rich but often non-noble families that controlled the city’s companies of foot.

It was this *popolo* of Firenze (bourgeoisie, merchants, notaries, and craftsmen) who led the late-1250s insurrection that chased out the city’s great Ghibelline families and deepened Tuscany’s political cleavage. (See Campaign History, page 20.)

Florentine *Primo Popolo* political institutions actually followed a structure that the Ghibellines had created in 1244-46, with a double system: on one side the municipality with the podestà and two councils; on the other the people, with a captain (another foreigner, like the mayor) flanked by two further councils, one of 12 elders elected by the 20 military companies, therefore on a territorial basis, and another with 24 Consuls of the Arts. Legislative initiative belonged to the Captain of the People (*capitano del popolo*—leader of militia forces) and to the Council of Elders, with their laws requiring ratification by the consuls of the podestà.

On campaign, red and white Guelph banners signified and celebrated the power of the People. As Florentine chronicler Villani described, *“the lordly pride of the Primo Popolo and our ancestors was inspired by the pomp of the carroccio and the martinella.”* [DNa pp 4-7, 13-14; DNb pp 5, 7, 15, 29; GV §75]

F22. MANFREDI holds back

Select a Ghibelline Lord with Ritter. Shift his cylinder or Service 1 Calendar box *or* remove 3 of his Assets.

Lords. Any Ghibelline (who has or has obtained at least one Ritter).

Tips. The Lord affected must have at least one Ritter unit in his mat’s Forces area. It can be a Lord who has obtained a Ritter via Ransom, including either Siena mat. As the Lord involved is Enemy, shift his cylinder right or Service left. Alternatively, select up to three total of his Coin, Loot, Provender, Carts, and/or Ships and remove them to the Asset markers pool.

History. Chronicler Villani describes the back and forth between Tuscany’s Ghibellines and the King over the provision of military aid:

And when at last they had a mind to depart, and took their leave of him very ill-content, Manfred promised them 100 German horsemen for their aid. Whereon the said ambassadors were troubled at this his first offer, and were minded to make their reply in the way of refusing so sorry an aid, for they were ashamed to return to Siena, inasmuch as they had hoped for more than 1,500 horsemen.

But hereon Messer Farinata degli Uberti said, “Be not dismayed, neither refuse any aid of his, be it never so small. Let us have grace of him to send his standard with them, and when it be come to Siena we will set it in such a place that he must needs send us further aid.”

And so it came to pass; and following the wise counsel of the knight, they accepted Manfred’s offer, praying him as a grace to give his own standard to their captain, and so he did. And when they returned to Siena with so poor an aid, great scorn was made thereof by the Sienese, and great dismay came upon the Florentine refugees, which had looked for aid and support from Manfred beyond measure greater. [GV §74]

F23. TREASURERS

Hold: Play to pay 2 Coin to declare Call to Arms OR to add 1 Treachery

Lords. Any Guelph.

Tips. To use the Event, the Guelphs must be able to remove two Coin total from any Guelph Lord(s), (who may be Besieged). Play as desired during any Call to Arms segment to trigger Call to Arms, including after the Ghibellines have declined to declare Call to Arms. Or play at any time to pay the Coin to select any set-aside Guelph Treachery card to add to the Guelph Command deck.

History. Two army *camerlengos* (“chamberlains” or treasurers) organized the revenues and payments to enable the mobilization of Firenze’s offensives against Siena. In 1260, they were Drag-onettus Bonelle and Toringhellus Venture, elected on February 11th, assisted by notaries Legerius Inghilberti Acciarii and Ranerius Vinci.

To these treasurers the deliberations of the podestà and the captains would commit to pay wages and other expenses via these treasurers, active in their office as the army marched. Wages were owed from the day of the army’s first departure from Firenze, April 19th, although the *podestà* and the captains did not issue the first mandate for payment until arriving in Colle on April 23rd. [LM pp XX, 68]

F24. DOCTORS

Hold: Play in Battle or Storm for Firenze and Arezzo each to restore to their Forces half of their Lost units (round up)

Lords. Firenze and Arezzo

Tips. Play at the outset of a Battle or Storm (4.4.1 Events). At the end, after all Loss rolls (4.4.4), Arezzo, Firenze Podestà, and Firenze Comune, whichever are involved in the combat, each separately restore half their Lost units, including any Knights that received Quarter.

History. In the best equipped units of medieval Italy, there was no shortage of doctors under the orders of the municipality, able to provide both primary health care and battlefield services. The Florentine army that marched on Siena in 1260 could count on the work of three doctors whose names have been preserved in the *Book of Montaperti*. Among them, only “magister Rogerius”, who received a pay of three lire, was required to treat and to visit those suffering from fevers or other illnesses. The other two, paid a little less, were to limit themselves to treating wounds. Similarly, a doctor followed Perugia’s army operating in 1282 against Foligno.



The Ferrara statutes of 1287 exempted city doctors from the usual communal burdens by requiring them instead to serve upon military muster. Upon mobilization of 200 knights and 1,000 foot or more, two doctors—a physician and a surgeon, were to follow the troops as *comune* service or paid by the Marquis d’Este. Pay for each was a maximum of 20 “soldi” a day if they brought three horses and 15 for two horses. [AS pp 282-283; PG p121; DNa p16]

F25. VAL D’ORCIA – War

If a Castle marked Guelph, shift Colle cylinder or Service 3 Calendar boxes. Guelphs may declare Call to Arms

Lords. Colle (for shift).

Tips. Conduct shift (cylinder left or Service right) at the moment of drawing the Event if any originally Ghibelline Castle (not Town or City) has Guelph IVP markers. The Capability on the card will not be available that Levy. After Muster, Guelphs may trigger Call to Arms if desired (3.5), regardless of whether the rest of the Event text applied.

History. The proximate cause for Firenze’s first march on Siena of 1260, that in April (see Campaign History, page 24), was to lift the Ghibelline siege of Montemassi by a foray into the Val d’Orcia region (west of Montepulciano and Radicofani). Upon arrival within Siena’s territory, however, the Florentines conquered the castles of Casole d’Elsa and Mensano and decided to abandon their initial objective for a direct assault on Siena herself. [GV §75]

F26. MONTALCINO – War

If a Town marked Guelph, shift Firenze, Arezzo, AND Orvieto cylinder or Service 1 box each. Guelphs may declare Call to Arms

Lords. Firenze, Arezzo, and Orvieto (for shifts).

Tips. Conduct shifts (cylinders left or Service right) at the moment of drawing the Event if any originally Ghibelline Town (not Castle or City) has Guelph IVP markers. The Capability on the card will not be available that Levy. After Muster, Guelphs may trigger Call to Arms if desired (3.5), regardless of whether the rest of the Event text applied.

History. Firenze’s second great muster of 1260 sought to counter Manfredi’s reinforcement of Siena that summer, which itself would trigger a far larger mutual Guelph and Ghibelline mobilization to finally either relieve or crush the stubborn but hard-pressed rebels of Montalcino:



“... And when [Giordano’s German knights] were come to Siena, immediately the Sienese sent forth their host against the castle of Montalcino, which was under the commands of the commonwealth of Firenze, and sent for aid to the Pisans and to all the Ghibellines of Tuscany, so that, what with the horsemen of Siena and the Florentine refugees, and the Germans and their allies, there were found 1,800 horsemen in Siena, whereof the greater part were Germans.”

“At the same time the militias of the Terzo di S. Martino were armed and placed at the siege of Montalcino; the reconquest of that inhabited area was so pressing that the Government specially created a special Authority of 18 citizens (six for Third) with the unique and specific task of conquering it at any cost.”

“[In Firenze] immediately the said 10,000 golden florins were procured, and were deposited, and a council was assembled of magnates and people, and they represented that of necessity it behoved to send a host to Siena to strengthen Montalcino, greater than the one sent in May last to Santa Petronella. ... The Florentines, not wanting to tighten the siege on the latter, hurried and at the end of August 1260 moved their army.” [GV §76-78; LF pp 113, 117-118]

Guelph Capabilities

(bottom half of card)

F1. STORES & WELL WATER

Guelph Seats each can Supply up to 4 Provender, even to a Lord Besieged there

Lords. All Guelphs.

Tips. With STORES & WELL WATER in effect, Supply can provide providing up to four Provender from each Seat used as a Source, rather than Provender equal to Stronghold Size, including from Ruined Seats and from Outposts. The Capability also allows a Lord to take Supply actions while Besieged at his own Seat, using that Seat as a Source. Supply otherwise still follows the usual rules, including the need for Transport (4.6). STORES & WELL WATER does not affect Supply using Ships and Ports.

History. Not just the storehouse but the well was essential for defenders to prolong a siege. Though not something often thought of regarding a castle, but the well is perhaps the single most essential element. The only way to guarantee drinking water over a long siege was to have one or more wells in one’s courtyards. And, as water was precious, the idea of throwing boiling water from the walls is not very likely.



“In 1155 in Tortona besieged by Federico I the rapid fall of the lower city forced the entire population to take refuge in the upper part which had a single well; the besiegers of course quickly made it undrinkable, first by dipping carrion and decomposition corpses in it and then extinguishing torches impregnated with pitch and sulfur. After three months the citizens were forced to surrender—says Otto of Freising—not so much because worn out by the continuous attacks as because overwhelmed by thirst.” [AS pp 77-182]

F2. GUASTATORI – Sappers

This Lord's Siege adds 2 markers instead of 1. His Pass (4.7.7) replaces Enemy Siege there with Bypass.

Lords. Any Guelph.

Tips. A Lord with GUASTATORI when first Besieging a Stronghold still places just a single Siege marker (4.3.5). With enough Lords present to add markers by the usual Siege rules (4.5.1), he would add two markers instead of one when taking a Siege action, so increasing markers from one to three or from two to four (maximum) on a single card. If Besieged, a Lord with GUASTATORI when activated by his Command actions or Treachery card could Pass (and do nothing else, 4.7.7) to remove all Enemy Siege markers and place Bypass on the Enemy Lords at his Locale. A Comune mat with this card gives the Commander the effects. Other Lords at a Siege than the Lord with GUASTATORI do not gain either effect.

History. In the feudal Italy of the 12th Century, the poorest peasants served as pioneer laborers or auxiliary light infantry. In the 13th Century, that service began to incorporate the rural poor into urban foot companies as pioneers. Major cities could draw from their urban lower class (*plebe*) to add skilled combat engineers, and more effective mining techniques (along with better machines) began to characterize siegecraft.

Firenze and Siena in wartime often formed elite troops of 200 sappers, miners, and pioneers called *guastatores* or *guastatori* ("wasters"), also known in Firenze as *devastatori*, equipped with axes and other tools and whose dual purpose was to destroy enemy fortifications and to ravage the surrounding enemy countryside, the latter being a standard technique to help encourage a besieged enemy to surrender. Siena also formed a second auxiliary corps of *mastri falegnami e lapicidi* (military artisans).

In the spring of 1260, the Florentine municipal army recruited such a unit of 200 *guastatori* sappers who would receive pay of 12 *denarii* per day. Six special *uffiziali ai guasti* "waster" officers, chosen by the citizens, commanded them, and they flew their own flags. Firenze made provisions to increase the *guastatori* by another 600. And, in the Montaperti campaign later that year, it again paid for militia sappers and miners. Specific duties for Firenze's rural militiamen from its surrounding contado countryside included as *marraioli* (diggers or hoe-men), *picconari* (pickaxe men), *palaiuoli* (shovel men) and *segatori* (mowers or saw men). (See also Event F5 ROAD WORKS and Capability F5 WAR ENGINEERS.) [GE pp 13-14, 24, 35; CO p73; DB p76; AS pp 54-55; DNa pp 11, 12, 40; RM p34]

F3. SIEGE TOWERS

This Lord Attacking in Storm from Round 2 on Strikes first with Archery and Melee

Lords. Any Guelph.

Tips. Any Lord with SIEGE TOWERS at a Storm Locale gains the benefit; it need not be the Lord taking the Storm action. A Commander's Podestà or Comune mat with this card gets the effect, not both. On Round 1, there is no effect. For Round 2 and all later Rounds, Initiative order is all this Lord's Strikes first, then contin-

ue in the normal order for Garrison and other Lords (4.4.2, 4.5.2 STRONGHOLD EFFECTS).

History. The conquest of a fortress by storm required the use of missile and assault machines that recalled techniques from antiquity, recovered in practice from at least the first half of the 11th Century but applied rationally and completely only during the next century.

In 1243, during the siege of Viterbo, Frederick II raised a "tall



and unusual building called *maristella*", considered an invention of pirates: its oblong shape recalled a ship and could contain as many as 30 armored warriors capable of attacking with spears and arrows.

Covered on the front with iron sheets, it was equipped with a huge metal rostrum with very strong chains to hook and destroy a city wall.

The specific height of towers to be built at a siege needed special attention, to make them just tall enough to dominate the enemy's walls. The builders therefore had first of all to know the wall's measurement as accurately as possible. For this purpose, they used different methods: they could consider the shadow that the wall cast on the ground; they could count the rows of stones that made up the wall facing; and, those who had the necessary knowledge and tools, could venture into more complex trigonometric calculations. [AS pp 119-122]

F4. TREBUCHETS

This Lord Unrouted at Storm or Sally where 3-4 Siege reduces Enemy Siegeworks or Walls –1

Lords. Any Guelph.

Tips. Any Lord mat with this card participating in a Storm or Sally grants the effect to its entire side, so long as that mat (including a Commander's Podestà or Comune mat separately) has not Routed. **EXAMPLES:** *Storming with TREBUCHETS reduces Walls 1-4 to Walls 1-3 (4.5.2). Sallying with TREBUCHETS against three Siege markers reduces Siegeworks to Walls 1-2 (4.5.3).*

History. The first mention of the counterweight trebuchet appeared in the Byzantine region in 1165. Its diminutive form is mentioned in northern Italy not much later: in 1189: that year, a troop swearing allegiance to the comune of Vicenza promised not to shoot at the city "*Nec cum mangano, nec trabuchello, aut cum prederia*". Italy therefore must have formed the vanguard of the diffusion of this technology that in the early decades of the 13th Century extended to all of Europe.



A period of intense research opened, aimed at further improving the effectiveness of the devices. The work of Egidio Romano, writing in the 1270s captured the results: he mentions four types of throwing machines, also briefly indicating their operation. Next to the simple trebuchet, equipped with a fixed counterweight, there appeared the *biffa* (also called *blida*, *biblia*, or *briccola*) equipped with a mobile counterweight; and the *tripantum* or *tripontum* that had both. The fourth, the old *mangano* (mangonel), was a machine without a counterweight, using instead a manual traction gear. It remained in use alongside the new types, each with its own ballistic characteristics.

The trebuchet became the largest of the indirect shooting weapons available to besiegers of the 13th Century. This war machine was able to launch projectiles at a great height (in order to pass over walls) up to the considerable distance of 300 meters! Its ammunition varied, from smooth stones to simple boulders. Sometimes, to crack the morale of the defenders, trebuchets would throw human heads or, in the hope of causing an epidemic, infected animal carcasses.

The mangonel was much smaller than the trebuchet and movable. It could more quickly be drawn to and put in action at a siege, where trebuchets had first to be assembled on site by specialists. Mangonels also had another goal: to break down walls. Though with far shorter range, they launched stones with great violence and with an almost linear trajectory, in order to obtain the maximum impact. Mangonels even came into use in urban street fighting with Firenze. And mangonels were only type of stone-throwing engine that could be placed on top of a tower or a wall. Trebuchets were too heavy for tall stonework to support them and so launched indirectly from inside the walls. [CO pp 104-105; GS p148; AS pp 77-182; DNa pp 39-40]

F5. WAR ENGINEERS

This Lord's Siege adds marker to any size Stronghold. Besieged, he can use entire Command to reduce to 1 Siege there

Lords. Any Guelph.

Tips. A Lord with WAR ENGINEERS can upon his Siege action add a marker regardless of Stronghold Size or how many Lords are present. "Entire Command" means this Lord when Besieged may devote all actions on his Command action card (not a Treachery card) to remove all but one Enemy Siege marker there. A Comune mat with this card gives the Commander the effect.

History. Generally speaking, war engineers drew from populations of craftsmen, blacksmiths, and carpenters, in possession of an empirical knowledge acquired through practice and transmitted almost exclusively orally, from father to son or from master to apprentice. At the top of the hierarchy were the "architects" (later called *inzierii*, "engineers") who, was able to draw upon the experience of his subordinates to organize and direct the siege endeavor. Medieval sources only occasionally identify them, mostly itinerant men willing out of necessity or for profit to put their understanding of military technology at a client's disposal.

Emperor Frederick II was the first, in 1238, to welcome and enroll *inzierii* as new inhabitants, granting them privileges and exemptions or forcefully capturing them from the enemy in the field. The latter was said to have happened to the Spaniard Calamandrino, kidnapped while in the service of imperialist Ezzelino da Romano.

Later, engineers, auxiliaries, and other assistants came to contribute in good number to a military campaign. An expense report for the Florentine army informs us that an expedition against Pistoia in 1302 included 977 engineers, sappers, and saw men and 113 stone and timber masters, along with 42 porters, six coachmen, four tailors, and six players of wind instruments. (See also Capability F2 GUASTATORI and Event F5 ROAD WORKS.) [AS p97; PG p121; GE p14]

F6 & F7. FEDITORI – Vanguard knights

Up to 4 of this Lord's Cavalieri in Battle Melee Strike x2 Rounds 1 and 2

Lords. Any Guelph.

Tips. FEDITORI has no effect in Storm or from Round 3 of Battle on. A Commander's Podestà or Comune mat with this card gets the effect, not both mats. A mat may have only one FEDITORI card.

History. The economic rise of Italy's cities in 13th Century expanded an urban upper-middle class (*popolo grasso*) of merchants or artisans, many of whom could maintain a war steed and obtain the necessary armament to serve as armored horsemen alongside urban nobles (*magnati*). To win acceptance among the communal knights, these often young sons of rich but non-noble families first had to prove themselves in battle as *feditori*: "wounders" who had the honor and duty of the first charge and collision with the enemy.



If this perhaps more lightly armed but more highly motivated shock force could disrupt the foe's first ranks, very often the rest of the army would disorder and the battle be decided.

By late in the century, Firenze's *feditori* included both noble knights and city merchants. As fighting on horseback alone was no longer enough to admit one into the restricted circle of the nobility, this diversity within the military elite encouraged even more competition among horsemen over who was bravest in battle. That competition then evolved into the Italy's traditional urban horse races (*palii*). [GE pp 24, 45; LP p130; PG p118; DNa p12]

F8. BALESTRE GROSSE – Large crossbows

This Lord's Men-at-Arms in Storm have Crossbows x½, –2 to target's Armor, that select targets if Defending

Lords. Any Guelph.

Tips. BALESTRE GROSSE has no effect in Battle and, in Storm, enables this Lord's Men-at-Arms Crossbows to select targets (4.4.2 ASSIGN HITS) only if Defending, not if Attacking. Crossbow units Strike with both Missile and Melee. PALVESARI do not affect BALESTRE GROSSE Men-at-Arms Crossbows because they only enhance Armigeri. A Commander's Podestà or Comune mat with this card gets the effect, not both mats (should a Comune obtain Turncoat Men-at-Arms).

History. There is uncertainty and debate among historians as to the presence of handheld crossbows in medieval warfare. But we do know that large crossbow siege weapons mounted on frames or pedestals remained in widespread use from ancient times. Though they could be carried in mule packs during campaigns or mounted onto wagons for use on a battlefield, their main purpose was the defense of fortification walls and of homes within cities. (See also F9-F11 BALESTRIERI.)

One such large fixed weapon in use in 13th Century Italy was the reel crossbow (*mulinello*), larger than the others and therefore very powerful. It required several men operate and to a large winch to stretch the bow, the device from which the weapon drew its name. Surviving examples of "great crossbows" from the 14th Century measure 1.5 to 2 meters in length. [DNa p39; DNb pp 10, 12, 14; CM; Stuart Ellis-Gorman]

F9-F11. BALESTRIERI – *Crossbowmen*

Up to 3 of this Lord's Armigeri have Crossbows x1, –2 to target Armor, that select targets in Storm Defense

Lords. Any Guelph.

Tips. BALESTRIERI give up to three of this Lord's Armigeri Crossbow Archery in Battle or Storm, on Attack or Defense. Crossbow units Strike with both Missile and Melee. The Crossbowmen select targets (4.4.2 ASSIGN HITS) only if Defending in Storm, not if in Battle or if Attacking in Storm. See F13-F15/S13-S15 PALVESARI, however, which if with the same Lord enable all his Armigeri Crossbows always to select targets. A Commander's Podestà or Comune mat with this card gets the effect, not both mats. A mat may have only one BALESTRIERI card.

History. Effective use of the crossbow required less practice than the regular bow, since the crossbow's stock kept the bow in tension and the release mechanism allowed the archer to concentrate on aiming. This accessibility enabled the muster of crossbowmen in greater numbers than effective bowmen, an advantage on the battlefield despite the crossbow's slower shooting rate from its more complicated loading procedure.

Crossbowmen because of their weapons' width could not pack as tightly together as regular bowmen. Instead of showering a kill area with a mass of arrows arcing in from overhead, crossbows shot directly and accurately—especially if sniping from confined, covered positions such as in defending a fortification. Their stubbier bolts also had greater armor-piercing power than longer, wobblier arrows.



Handheld crossbows, in use in Spain, southern France, and Alpine Italy by the 11th Century, consequently spread rapidly throughout the Italian Peninsula in the 12th Century, especially for siege warfare. (See also F8 BALESTRE GROSSE.)

Firenze and other Italian cities in the 13th Century could field crossbowmen in profusion, and the Italian crossbowman became as feared in medieval Europe as the English longbowman. Ease of aiming meant that parttime militiamen could master accurate crossbow use. But communal crossbow companies nevertheless took training very seriously and often developed into highly effective elite units. The sophisticated political organization of the comuni provided the discipline to drill militiamen as teams of crossbowmen who could cover one another as they reloaded. Records at the first formation of its *Primo Popolo* republic in 1250 note the organization of crossbowmen into the municipal militia. The city that year ordered every citizen aged 15 to 70 to register in one of its military companies; each company in time of need had to deploy at least 20 crossbows, of which at least four had to be “large”. Florentine citizens commonly used crossbows in home defense, and now they would carry them on campaign. Communal crossbowmen would be fined or punished if they were caught without the required equipment.

Crossbows in the 13th Century fell into two main types: wooden bow and composite bow. (Steel bows arrived later.) Composite crossbows constructed from a combination of wood, horn, bone, and/or sinew for greater power and reliability were the most valuable—and *comuni* could produce and afford them in abundance.

Most crossbows had a stirrup for the archer's foot and/or various ingenious spanning systems making them easier to reload despite the bow's resistance.

Upon advance planning of a military campaign, a communal army would dedicate specific workers to the construction of crossbows, quarrels, arrows, and cords and would then call upon these armorers to follow the army. Crossbowmen received a higher wage than regular archers. In battle, companies of crossbowmen could open hostilities by harassing the enemy, to form a protective barrier behind which the cavalry could recover and regroup, or could try to break an enemy array as a heavy infantry assault formation. (See also F13 F15 PALVESARI.) [DNb pp 6, 10-16, 22-23, 49-52, 63; CM; LP p130; DNa pp 11-16, 33, 37-38; GE p22; LM pp 40-41; GS pp 178-182; CO pp 70-71; RM pp 29-32; Stuart Ellis-Gorman]

F12. ARMY RESERVE

Firenze, Arezzo, and Lucca Cavalieri in Battle Melee Strike x2 from Round 3 on

Lords. Firenze, Arezzo, and Lucca.

Tips. Firenze Podestà, Firenze Comune, Arezzo, and Lucca, whichever are involved in the Battle, each gain the effect. ARMY RESERVE has no effect in Storm or during Rounds 1 or 2 of Battle.

History. Roberto Marchionni in one of his booklets on Montaperti judges that “*considered individually the various elements of the Comune armies were of fairly poor quality; the cavalry was weak and the infantry, more or less unable to manoeuvre, was only capable of drawing up on a hill or around the carroccio waiting for the enemy cavalry. However, when they put their strength together, infantry and cavalry represented an opponent to be feared, capable from a defence position of defeating the best feudal armies.*” [RM p32]

In light of their overall emphasis on tactical defense, it is not surprising that communal armies made great use of reserves, both to defend their *carroccio* and to seal the battle's climax with a counterattack by a reserve of fresh troops. A reserve contingent of knights and infantrymen, hidden in the rear, had the task of aiding the main host when in difficulty and filling any gap that developed.

Commanders positioned the baggage train and camp followers strategically, closely behind the troops' array, in order to avoid a hasty and unjustified retreat. The *carroccio* itself was not merely symbolic but served in battle to as a rallying point to stop or delay a rout, as well as an elevated command post and place to tend to wounded.

Sudden attack by fresh reserves often determined the outcome of a battle. We can think of the strike late in the day at Montaperti by the Count of Arras with his 400 men, who had hitherto remained immobile and hidden behind the Guelph left wing, as such a decisive use of reserves. (See Campaign History, page 26, and Ghibelline Event S4 SUDDEN CLASH.) [DNa p35, LF p127]

F13-F15. PALVESARI – *Shieldmen*

This Lord's Armigeri have Armor 1-4, until 3 Rout. Their Crossbows always select targets

Lords. Any Guelph.

Tips. PALVESARI give the Armor benefit (an increase from Armor 1-2 to Armor 1-4) to all that Lord mat's Armigeri units. At the moment that a third Armigeri unit on that mat becomes Routed, the Armor benefit is cancelled for all Armigeri remaining among that mat's Forces. In addition, PALVESARI enables all Armigeri Crossbows (using BALESTRIERI at the same mat) to select their targets (4.4.2 ASSIGN HITS) regardless of Storm or Battle, Attack or Defense, even after three Armigeri rout. A Commander's Podestà or Comune mat with this card gets the effect, not both. A mat may have only one PALVESARI card.

History. Communal armies of the 13th Century made extensive and highly effective use of crossbowmen in open field battle. (See F9-F11 BALESTRIERI.) This naturally raised the problem that crossbowmen—already vulnerable because of their relatively low rate of fire—became key targets on field. If close-packed, they drew enemy crossbow shots. If isolated, they became highly vulnerable a charge of enemy knights. The solution was to create a corps of shield bearers to strengthen formed units of crossbowmen and protect them from the enemy arrows and shock—the *palvesari*.

Palvesari (*pavesari* or *pavesieri*) were infantrymen who held large rectangular shields called *palvesi* (*pavois* or *pavise*), as or almost as tall as a person, at least 150cm high and 70-80cm wide. The pavise shield could be fixed to the ground and supported by poles. The shieldman, heavily armored and armed with a long spear, would stand in front of and protect an archer, usually a crossbowman, especially while reloading. Probably to start, each pavise bearer had a spear; then it became the custom to add an infantryman with a pike to the crossbow-shield team. Two or three crossbowmen might stand behind each shieldman to provide an uninterrupted flow of shot from the position.

The drill required of the communal militiaman meant the pavise-pike-crossbow teams could organized into the most sophisticated and effective form of defense against cavalry charges available at the time. The *palvesari* would form a wall of shields with hedges of long spears and rows of crossbowmen shooting from behind. This protection enabled the massed crossbowmen to make full use of their weapon's accuracy. Well enough drilled, a phalanx of shieldmen and crossbowmen could even advance to the attack to break the enemy line—a sort of moving fieldwork.



The efficiency of this new combination of weapons, their discipline, and the numbers foot troops that a populous *comune* could generate for battle increased their role relative to the mounted knight beyond that in medieval Europe heretofore. The key to overcoming communal foot would be to deny them the three weapons' joint action. *Palvesari* remained a smaller elite. Firenze's *Sestieri* paired up to provide the city with three companies of 100 elite *palvesari* each. At Montaperti, it was just 300 *palvesari* who stood with 1,000 crossbowmen after the rout of the Guelph cavalry, before themselves breaking in the face of a Ghibelline horse charge. At other times, there might be inadequate numbers of crossbowmen. If missile fire and then horse charge could disrupt the combined-arms infantry formation, the knights could still achieve decision on the field. [CO p73] [RM pp 29, 32] [CM] [PG pp 118-119; GE pp 22, 34, 44; DNb pp 11, 16, 48-50; DN a p37; RM pp 29-32, 34; Stuart Ellis-Gorman]

F16 & F17. ARCIERI – *Bowmen*

This Lord's Militia have Archery x1

Lords. Any Guelph.

Tips. Bowmen Militia units Strike with both Missile and Melee. A Commander's Podestà or Comune mat with this card gets the effect (if they have Militia), not both mats. A mat may have only one ARCIERI card.

History. In the 12th Century, unarmored archers recruited from the lower-class were a key body of troops in the municipal armies. Gradually in the next century, crossbowmen came to outnumber the regular hand bowmen. (See F9-F11 BALESTRIERI.)



But archery companies remained in high esteem as selected, trained, efficient and well-paid soldiers, albeit not as highly paid as the crossbowmen, and similarly bearing their own unit insignia. *Arcieri* augmented the *balestrieri* in defending and guarding the walls, castles and towns, but they saw their main service on the military campaigns. At Montaperti, the Florentine army included four companies of archers: two with crossbows and two with regular bows. Both types went forward to harass the enemy line.

These specialized infantrymen were required to equip themselves for war at their own expense: in addition to bows and arrows, they had to acquire accompanying weapons such as falchions or cutters, axes or maces, and—if they could afford it—iron hats to protect the head and leather bodices with reinforced iron mesh sleeves to cover the bust and arms. [CO pp 72-73; LM p41; GS pp 178-182; GE p12; DN a pp 9, 11, 38; DNb 22-23, 29; RM pp 29-32, 34; Stuart Ellis-Gorman]

F18. LA CAVALLATA – *Long-range raiders*

This Lord may pay 1 Prov to use entire Command to Ravage adjacent Locale, not at Unbesieged Enemy Lord

Lords. Any Guelph.

Tips. This Lord must have or Share (1.5.2) one Provender and use all actions on his Command action card (not a Treachery card) to use this Capability. Expend the Provender and Ravage an adjacent

Locale, which for a Ghibelline Lord may be an Unravaged Guelph Outpost. The target Locale may not have an Unbesieged Enemy Lord, even if Bypassed. Otherwise follow Ravage rules—place a Ravaged marker and gain Loot or Provender normally (4.7.2). A Comune mat with this card gives the Commander the effect.

History. In almost all communal cities, there were two distinct forms of mobilization: a partial muster called *cavallata* or *cavalcata*, and muster of the real army (*exercitus*, called *oste* or host). The latter occurred only in dire emergency, as the disruption of the city's commercial life would be acute. A *cavallata*, in contrast, would as its name indicates require only the presence of privileged cavalymen and could be afforded more often. (The similar words “*cavallata*” and “*cavalcata*” in 13th Century Sienese *comune* records also mean the remuneration given to the city's knights for their military service.) While the army muster committed substantial and articulated forces for campaigns of longer duration and with more ambitious strategic aims, a muster of horse alone would serve limited objectives, such as a rapid incursion or raid into enemy territory.

“*La cavallata*” then became a synonym for a military action with horse. Troops could go fight either a war or merely a *cavallata*—a big raid that could lead to the devastation of the enemy's countryside or to a surprise assault on a stronghold, as probably occurred at Cortona in 1259 (see Campaign History, page 21). [PG p113; CAV pp 53-75; GE p13]

F19. GUALDANA – Horse marauders

This Lord treats any Horse unit as Berrovieri for Ravage

Lords. Any Guelph.

Tips. A Lord with GUALDANA and any Horse unit(s) on his mat(s) can Ravage for double Provender and Loot (4.7.2) even if none of his units are Berrovieri. A Comune mat with this card gives the Commander the effect, as long as either mat has at least one Horse unit.

History. The word “*gualdana*”, of Germanic origin and already in use by the Ninth century, seems in communal Italy to indicate an informal group of men on horseback as well as on foot that could have preceded an army on the advance or more simply, engaged in raid and pillage during open war. Chronicler Rolandino da Padova described *gualdana* as irregular marauders. This was a typical duty for regular light cavalry, in northern Italy in the 12th Century fulfilled by squires and in the 13th by the *berrovieri*.

The *berrovieri* were the later communal equivalent of feudal Italy's earlier light cavalry of prosperous peasantry. They were lightly armored professional horsemen drawn principally from rural environs. The tasks of the *berrovieri* horsemen were to scout, forage and ambush, to counter enemy raids of the countryside around the city, and especially to raid that of nearby enemy cities. In the second half of the 13th Century, *berrovieri* began to turn mercenary, hiring themselves out to other cities. At the end of a campaign, having lost their source of pay, they might become brigands.



In the Firenze of the 13th and 14th Centuries, the *gualdana* was made up of *ribaldi* (auxiliaries or “ruffians”) formed under their own flag, with the precise

task of stealing and burning houses on enemy territory. In 1260, *gualdana* was also deemed a military service required of all members of the *comune* army, day and night, similar to guard duty. [AS pp 22-23; GE pp 13-14, 24, 33; DNA pp 8, 12]

F20. MASNADIERI – Looters

This Lord may Ravage for 0 actions, taking no Loot

Lords. Any Guelph.

Tips. A Lord with MASNADIERI uses zero actions to Ravage instead of one at a Castle or two at a Town or City. The Lord must still be active on his Command actions card and otherwise follow Ravage rules (4.7.2). MASNADIERI can combine in effect with Gualdana for double Loot and Provender but does not aid Ravage adjacent with LA CAVALLATA because LA CAVALLATA requires an entire Command card rather than a set number of actions. A Comune mat with MASNADIERI gives that Commander the Capability's effect.

History. The *cavallata* strategic raid that was part of a concerted campaign plan of a general order (see F18 LA CAVALLATA) had a lower level tactical equivalent: local raids around fortified or dug in defenders to lure the opponent out into a trap. Such raiding as bait to lure the enemy into a snare was a usual practiced in Italy throughout the communal age.

Very often, the teams of *guastatori* (“wasters”, in Firenze also called *devastatori*) followed looting cavalry to destroy villages in hostile territory. Historian David Nicolle terms them “ravagers” in this capacity. While such *guastatori* served as sappers and combat engineers for siege, preparation of fieldworks, and clearing of roads, their universally added purpose was the destruction of enemy crops. They might professional woodcutters for the specific purpose of cutting down the enemy's fruit trees, for example. (See also Capabilities F2 GUASTATORI and F19 GUALDANA and Event F5 ROAD WORKS.) [AS pp 44, 54-55; DNA pp 7, 12; DNb pp 15, 45, 46; GE pp 13-14, 35; RM p34]

F21. DISTRINGITORES – Officers dress ranks

Each Round after Archery, a Guelph Podestà may roll 2 Routed units' Armor for them to recover

Lords. Firenze, Arezzo, Lucca, and Colle.

Tips. The owning side each Battle or Storm Round after all Archery and before all Melee that Round selects up to any two Routed units with Armos on that side (so, not Light Horse or Militia). Roll against modified Armor as applicable, Armigeri with PALVESARI would roll Armor 1-4 for example. If successful, slide recovered units back up into the mat's Forces section. “A Guelph Podestà” means a single Podestà Lord in Battle or Storm each Round, so may be a Commander's Podestà or Comune mat but not both in the same Round. Only Armored units may roll, not Unarmored Light Horse or Militia.

History. In Italian *comuni*, the *capitaneus* of a foot company—often a well-to-do merchant or artisan—began often to take on two assistants called *serramenti*. This Italian term *serra gente* (“arrange people closer together”) is the origin of the English military term “sergeant”. In battle, these veteran soldiers would deploy behind

a tactical formation to keep its ranks compact and in good order. (On the importance of compact order, see F13-F15 PALVESARI.) The Florentine army called such special officers *distringitores*. [GE p22; PG p115; DNb p27; GE p12]

F22. TAU COMPANY – Chivalric order

Firenze and Lucca have Lordship +1 and may Muster Altopascio for 0 actions

Lords. Firenze and Lucca.

Tips. Firenze and Lucca each receive the Lordship benefit every Muster and (if declared) Call to Arms segment that TAU COMPANY is in effect, whether or not Altopascio is Mustered to any Lord. Either may Muster Altopascio Special Vassal by the usual Vassal Muster rules, except that the Lord expends no Lordship to do so (3.4.2 ALTOPASCIO). A Comune mat with this card gives the Commander the effect, who may Muster Altopascio to either mat. Ghibelline Bribe may not target Altopascio (4.7.6).

History. Knights of the Tau are probably the oldest chivalric religious order in Europe. *Domus Hospitalis Sancti Jacobi de Altopassu* saw the order's economic fortunes closely connected to commerce along the *Via Francigena*. In addition to assistance to pilgrims, these friars maintained roads, bridges, and transport to a high technical and organizational level, evidenced by the construction of bridges to cross several rivers along the *Via Francigena*, such as the Arno, Elsa, Usciana, Taro, and Arda.

Already the end of the 11th Century, the order was flourishing economically, with goods from the friars' complex, Magione of Altopascio, reaching over a good part of the dioceses of Lucca, of the lower Valdarno and of the Valdinievole, north to the cities of Pistoia and Prato. The friars of Altopascio, or of the Tau, initially followed the rule of Saint Augustine; in 1239, they were assimilated to the rule of Saint John of Jerusalem, with the bull of Pope Gregory IX, which named them an equestrian order under the Hospitaliers of Jerusalem. [Enrico Acerbi]

F23. VIA FRANCIGENA – Pilgrims' road

Guelph Lords except Guido and Orvieto start at any Lord Seat (not Vassal Seat) that is Friendly Command +1

Lords. All Guelphs except Guido Guerra and Orvieto.

Tips. The effect applies to Firenze, Arezzo, Lucca, and Colle Podestà Lords. "Command +1" means that a Lord with Command Rating "2" instead could take three Command actions on his card, for example (1.5.3, 4.2.1). The added Command applies for that Lord's entire Command card, regardless of whether the Lord ends up still at a Friendly Lord Seat. Even though the Capability is named for the *Francigena* road, Lords do not need to be on or near any particular Way on the map to benefit from its effect.

History. An ancient road and pilgrim route running from England and France through Switzerland to Rome and Apulia, where there were the ports of embarkation for the Holy Land, was known in Italy as *Via Francigena* ("road from France") or *Via Romea Francigena* ("road from France to Rome"). In medieval times, it was an important road and pilgrimage route for those wishing to visit the Holy See and the tombs of the apostles Peter and Paul. [https://www.viefrancigene.org]



In hilly and forested Tuscany, the state of the roads and their control were critical for both trade and warfare, as navigable rivers could reach only a small part of the region and wagons formed the main military transport, pack animals in hillier parts.

In addition to the attention to pilgrimage routes, northern Italy's old Roman road system had fared better than some other parts of Italy or Europe. And something of a revolution in road building and revival occurred across communal Italy, with local militia patrols and fortifications protecting the road net. Firenze's *Capitano del Popolo* (militia commander) and other city officials were responsible for keeping roads free from robbers and their bridges in good repair. [DNa p34; DNb p45]

F24. ASTROLOGERS

Each Guelph Lord on his first Command card each Campaign on die roll of 1-2 is Command +1

Lords. All Guelphs.

Tips. When Astrologers is in effect, the side upon each of its revealed Command cards checks whether that is the first card for that Lord that Campaign (including any Treachery cards). If it is (and is an actions rather than Treachery card), the player rolls one die: on a roll of "1" or "2", add one to that Lord's Command Rating for that card. A Lord with Command Rating "2" instead could take three Command actions, for example (1.5.3, 4.2.1).

History. Thirteenth-Century Lords found indispensable support in the astrological and astronomical sciences and used them to guide their choices. Frederick II, in particular, collected astrolabes and astronomical instruments to facilitate the responses that he considered fundamental for both political balances and for the health of the body. The chroniclers of the time, and the same astrologer Guido Bonatti (circa 1220-1296), who was at his service, confirm that he surrounded himself with famous astrologers to guide him in choosing the most propitious moments for political decisions.



"It was the end of August 1259, indeed, it seems, on the 25th, at midday, when Ezzelino moved his army. The stars seemed propitious, or at least everything had been studied—by Ezzelino and his astrologers—because they were: the departure had been set in an hour and day certainly not suitable for the march of an army—in the height of summer, under the scorching sun—but coinciding, as the "science" of the time wanted, with the time and day of birth of the protagonist, which were auspicious (Ezzelino was born, as we know, on the noon and the 25th of a month). The enterprise, therefore, was born under the best auspices." [Giorgio Cracco, *Il Grande Assalto*, p163]

Ghibelline Count Guido Novello had an astrologer, Guido Bonatti, who was present at the Battle of Montaperti. [CP p42]

Religion and superstition seemed quite compatible:

“When the news of [Montaperti] came to the court of Rome, ... Cardinal Ottaviano degli Ubaldini, who was a Ghibelline, rejoiced greatly; wherefore Cardinal Bianco, who was a great astrologer and master of necromancy, seeing this, said: if Cardinal Ottaviano knew the future of this war of the Florentines, he would not be rejoicing thus.” [GV §80]

While trust in the Stars was an individual matter, common people as well held such superstition: “

The Florentines, like all Middle Ages men, were very superstitious, and when they felt predicted by some hired fortune tellers that they would die, for example, between—Good and Evil—knowing that they had set up camp between the Biena (bene in Italian meaning “Good”) and Malena (male in Italian meaning “evil”) streams, the onomatopoeia of the words terrified them.” [LF p124]

F25. REINFORCED WALLS

Guelph Tax may instead mark Seat used Walls +1 if not already marked. Remove if Ruins

Lords. All Guelphs.

Tips. Use of Reinforced Walls requires a Tax action by the usual rules (4.7.a) except that the Lord receive no Coin but instead places an available “Walls +1” marker in his side’s color at his Locale (his Stronghold Seat, 1.3.1 WALLS +1). The Seat may not be Ruins, an Outpost, or already marked Walls +1. Walls +1 markers are a limit on play, so the Capability has no effect if the side already has four such markers on the map. S23 ECONOMIC SANCTIONS when in effect blocks Guelph use of REINFORCED WALLS, since the latter requires Tax Commands.

History. In the 13th Century, Italian military architecture jumped forward from palisades or simple brick and stone curtain walls with a few towers. Incendiary weapons were becoming more effective, so stone and brick largely replaced timber. Increasing numbers of crossbowmen and better siege engines to improved fortification design. More money and more master builders meant higher walls and very high towers, sometime with elaborate overhanging machicolations. Egidio Colonna late in the century recommended building the walls with a filling of pressed earth to better resist the blows of the throwing machines and, at the same time, to use more solid and suitable shooting stones as projectiles.

Siege engines could achieve extensive destructive effect against particularly weak fortifications. In general, however, damage seems mainly to concern housing in a stronghold’s interior rather than the walls around them—damage nevertheless often sufficient to discomfort the garrison into surrender. Teodoro di Monferrato early in the 14th Century advised not to direct shot against walls, since few could be harmed, but instead to hit the bretèches and sentry boxes where enemy soldiers stood guard, dwellings, or outbuildings.

Though stories of towns erecting walls overnight are mythical, stonework could be improved over the course of a single military campaign. (See also F26 COSTRUTTORI). [DNa pp 33, 38-39; AS pp 77-182; <https://www.castellitoscani.com>; Giovanna Bianchi, *Le fondazioni di castelli*, p135]

F26. COSTRUTTORI – Master stonecutters

Guelph Lords for a full Command card, 1 Coin, and 3 Prov remove Ruins from their Locale

Lords. All Guelphs.

Tips. A Lord must have or Share (1.5.2) one Coin and three Provender and devote all actions on his Command actions card (not a Treachery card) to use the Capability’s effect, which is to remove any Ruins marker at his current Locale. Adjust Victory.

History. Increases in the 12th and 13th Centuries in itinerant groups of specialized workers at the service of richer clients led to an exponential increase in stone architecture. Cities, towns, and lords with the greater economic investment at hand also could take advantage of a greater number of masters, both stonecutters and bricklayers, at a time within a single construction site, even as specializations had become more complex and rich. When conquerors would dismantle gates, towers, or walls as punishment for resistance, the new rulers or later liberators might rebuild them over the course of the same conflict, as occurred after Arezzo’s sack and destruction of Cortona in 1259 (see Campaign History, page 23). [Giovanna Bianchi, *Le fondazioni di castelli*, p135]



Ghibelline Events

(top half of card)

S1. AMBUSH

Hold: Play as Enemy Avoids Battle (4.3.4). Enemy chooses 1 Avoiding Lord to Battle or Withdraw instead

Lords. Any Guelph.

Tips and History. See Guelph Event F1 AMBUSH.

S2. BETRAYALS

For each Stronghold with any Ghibelline Siege markers, roll on Revolt table or add 1 Treachery

Lords. Any Ghibelline (for Treachery).

Tips and History. See Guelph Event F2 BETRAYALS.

S3. SURPRISE

Hold: Play upon Besieging a Stronghold where no other Lord (4.3.5). Place 2 Siege (not 1). Then Storm up to 3 Rounds, Walls –2

Lords. Any Ghibelline.

Tips and History. See Guelph Event F3 SURPRISE.

S4. SUDDEN CLASH

Hold: Play on a Ghibelline Lord in Battle. Round 1, that Lord’s Horse Melee precedes all Archery and selects its targets

Lords. Any Ghibelline.

Tips. Use of the Event shifts Melee by Horse units on one mat (not a Commander's Podestà and Comune both) of the playing side in Round 1 ahead of both sides' Archery in the Strike Initiative order (4.4.2). If both sides play SUDDEN CLASH, the selected Defending Lord's Horse Melee is first, then affected Attacker's, then the rest. Also, that Lord's Horse Melee Round 1 selects targets as described under 4.4.2 ASSIGN HITS TO UNITS.

History. Attacking an enemy army, especially one on the march, with a smaller troop of fast-moving horse was a favored tactic in Italy from at least the 12th Century. [DNa pp 36-37]

At Siena on May 18th, 1260, 800 Germans captained by the fiery Count Giordano and a few dozen Sienese knights suddenly threw themselves at their enemy in a highly risky sally from the city. The Florentines had not foreseen such bold enemy aggression, as they foresaw themselves, if anyone, doing the attacking. They remained frozen, not even taking hold of their swords.

"The Germans, frenzied and hot for the wine, went out of Siena, and vigorously attacked the field of the Florentines, and because they had undergone a sudden ambush and with few guards, not having recognized the strength of the enemies, and also if the Germans were few people in that assault, they did great damage to the enemy camp, and many of the people and cavalry in that immediate assault made a bad impression, fleeing for fear that the assailants would be even more superior." [GV §75]

The attack was painful for the Florentines—its losses reached 1,300—and great shame fell on them. But the Germans and Sienese took proportionally greater damage—270 soldiers fallen—25 percent of the Manfredi contingent. Moreover, the Germans constituted the Ghibellines' psychological bulwark and the greatest cavalry force that Siena held at that time, so their losses caused great discomfort even in the victory. [LF pp 115-116]

At Montaperti, a Ghibelline reserve detachment under d'Arras made a wide ride around the Guelph host to attack suddenly from an unexpected direction, contributing to the Guelph panic. (See Campaign History, page 26, and Guelph Capability F12 ARMY RESERVE.)

S5. ROAD WORKS – *Woodcutters clear the way*

This Campaign Ghibelline Lords treat Track as Road and move Laden as if Unladen

Lords. All Ghibellines.

Tips and History. See Guelph Event F5 ROAD WORKS.

S6. HILLS

Hold: May play Defending in Battle. Double Ghibelline Archery Hits, added Hits as Bowmen not Crossbow

Lords. All Ghibellines.

Tips and History. See Guelph Event F6 HILLS.

S7. GREEK FIRE

Hold: Play on Besieging Lord to reduce to 1 Siege marker, remove 1 of his units, and discard 1 of his "This Lord" Capabilities

Lords. Any Guelph.

Tips and History. See Guelph Event F7 GREEK FIRE.

S8. SWAMP

Hold: May play Defending in non-Summer Battle. Guelph Horse does not Strike in Round 1

Lords. All Guelphs.

Tips and History. See Guelph Event F8 SWAMP.

S9. POPE AT BAY *flees to Viterbo*

Set aside 1 Treachery to shift any 2 Guelph cylinders or Service 1 Calendar box or Orvieto by 3

Lords. Any Ghibelline (for Treachery card removal), any Guelphs (for 1-box shifts), Orvieto (for 3-box shift).

Tips. Select any one Ghibelline Treachery card already acquired for and still in the Ghibelline Command deck (not from the Plan) to set aside again in order to shift cylinder(s) on the Calendar rightward or Service leftward.

History. As the imperial-papal conflict rooted down into Italian society, Rome itself became too Ghibelline for the Pope. Pope Alexander in 1257 withdrew to Viterbo, a town in the countryside of the Papal States that had itself traded between the parties but was then under Guelph sway. There he expanded what was to become a papal palace that would offer political refuge to a succession of popes, including Alexander's successor Urban, illustrative of the vulnerability of the Roman Pontiff to political factionalism.



"1261 A.D. By reason of the discomfiture of the Florentines, and of the other Guelphs of Tuscany at Montaperti, as we have afore said, King Manfred rose to great lordship and state, and all the imperial party in Tuscany and in Lombardy greatly increased in power, and the Church and its devout and faithful followers were much abased in all places. It came to pass that a very little while after, ... Pope Alexander passed from this life in the city of Viterbo, and the Church was vacant without a pastor for five months through the disputings among the cardinals; afterwards they elected Pope Urban IV, of the city of Troyes, of Champagne in France...." [GV §87]

S10. A BETTER PAID DEATH

Shift cylinder or Service of any 2 Ghibelline Lords who are not a Podestà 1 Calendar box or this Levy give 1 Lordship +2

Lords. Giordano, Astimberg, Provenzano, and Santa Fiora.

Tips. Shift two Ghibelline Lords' cylinders left and/or Service right. Alternatively add two Lordship to the rating of one Lord for both Muster (3.4) and, if declared, Call to Arms Allies (3.5.4) this Levy. No Lord involved may be a Podestà.

History. As happened at Montaperti, facing an imminent danger, the allied Ghibelline troops sent messengers to the city councils to contract a more profitable service. Sometimes, gold seemed to be lacking. On other occasions, wealthy Siennese in the emergency would step forward.

“Having heard what was the problem, Count Giordano put the discussion with brutal economic clarity: give double pay to the German knights and let’s get them on the field. The sum made available by a rich merchant, Salimbene, was brought ... to destination on a cart covered with precious fabric and adorned with olive branches; the sum underwent an increase, compared to the previous report, because it was counted in 118,000 (no more 100,000) gold florins. By the way, in the Anonymous Chronicle the sum seemed destined to pay also the armed service of the Siennese citizens, while on the contrary in the Montauri’s one there is no trace of all this and on its page the people of Siena spontaneously presented themselves in arms to defend the City without mentioning economic remuneration.” [DB p97]

S11. VOLTERRA

If Volterra Ghibelline, shift Colle Service 2 Calendar boxes or Pisa cylinder left to current Levy or add 1 Treachery

Lords. Colle or Pisa (for shift), any Ghibelline (for Treachery).

Tips. Implement the Event at the moment of drawing it only if Volterra (center west of the map) is free of Guelph Allegiance markers. Shift Colle Service left, or shift Pisa cylinder only if starting right of current Turn. Add Treachery only if that card is set aside (not already added or in the Plan).

History. See Guelph Event F19 VOLTERRA.

S12. CAMP ATTACK

Hold: My play in Battle. Round 1, take 2 Assets from each Enemy Lord there as Spoils, then remove 2 more from each

Lords. All Guelphs.

Tips and History. See Guelph Event F12 CAMP ATTACK.

S13. GENTLE USILIA ransoms prisoners

Hold: Play for the Guelphs (only) to conduct immediate Ransom (4.9.2)

Lords. All Guelphs (to conduct Ransom), any Ghibellines (to receive Coin, add Treachery).

Tips. Play at any time. The Guelph side must immediately conduct the usual Ransom procedure, out of and in addition to the usual sequence of play, including any Languish effect.

History. According to an anonymous chronicler writing about 50 years after the fact, a woman of Siena named Usilia (or Usiglia) following the Ghibelline army as a *treccola*, a grocer selling provisions to the troops, made her way onto the battlefield after Montaperti to take Florentine prisoners: “...a *treccola* Usilia led 36 prisoners tied up in a rope, because those who did not want to surrender, they were all dead.”



The 15th-Century chronicler Paolo di Tommaso Montauri enriched the cameo with more details, balancing Usilia between pity—she asks the defeated Florentines to surrender to spare their lives—and mockery—she binds the prisoners with a ribbon, her prisoners following her like chicks behind a hen. One telling has Usilia leading her line of 36 prisoners to Siena tied by their hands, “*beating them with a stick as if they were a row of geese.*” [MG p33]

Montauri goes further: the woman has with her a donkey that the Florentine troops had thrown inside Siena’s walls with a trebuchet, “*col trabocco drento a le mura di Siena.*” Usilia had collected the poor beast and brought it to Montaperti with her. The donkey thus becomes a mocking icon of the Florentine defeat. The 36 Florentine prisoners are to enrich the woman, because each must buy back his freedom by paying Usilia 18 gold florins, a final sum of almost 650 florins, enough for Usilia and her donkey lived well the rest of their lives. Montauri concludes, “*if a female grocer managed to catch so many prisoners, think of what the men did!*”

Historian Alberto Luongo explains that communal archives of Siena confirm that such a woman existed:

“She is expressly named in the fiscal records called ‘the Biccherne’ of 1249, where she is exactly called ‘Usilia treccola’, and in the record of the goods confiscated to the Ghibellines of 1281/1282. This last information confirms the reality of her active support to the Ghibelline party, to such an extent that she was banished from Siena and deprived of her goods when the Guelphs managed to stifle a Ghibelline riot. ... This is enough to assume at least a kernel of truth to this episode too, in particular the first version. The case of Usilia ... refers to one of the main traits of the war economy of that age, namely taking prisoners to collect the corresponding ransoms.” [Alberto Luongo, “Reflections on women’s behavior in war contexts in communal Italy” in *Women and Violence in the Late Medieval Mediterranean, ca. 1100-1500*, edited by Lidia L. Zanetti Domingues, Lorenzo Caravaggi, and Giulia M. Paoletti; DB pp 104-105]

S14. FRIARS sent to deceive Florentines

This Campaign Guelphs shuffle and play chosen Command cards without inspecting stack

Lords. All Guelphs.

Tips. The Capability on the card will not be available this Levy. When the Guelph form their Campaign Plan this Turn, the player selects the Command cards to be included, shuffles them, and places the stack face down. Neither player may inspect that stack. Reveal and use Command cards on Campaign as normal.

History. Florentine chronicler Villani reports Farinata’s scheme of July 1260 to trick the Guelphs into precipitate action thus:

“The Florentine refugees, by whose embassy and deed King Manfred had sent Count Giordano with 800 German horsemen, thought within themselves that they had done nothing if they could not draw the Florentines out into the field, inasmuch as the aforesaid Germans were not paid save for three months, and already more than one month and a half of this had passed, since their coming, nor had they more money wherewith to pay them, nor did they look for any from Manfred; and should the time for

which they had been paid pass by without having done nothing, they would return into Apulia, to the great peril of the state.

“They reasoned that this could not be contrived without skill and subtlety of war, which business was committed to M. Farinata degli Uberti and M. Gherardo Ciccia de’ Lamberti. These subtly chose out two wise minor friars as their messengers to the people of Florence, and first caused them to confer with nine of the most powerful men of Siena, who made endless show to the said friars that the government of Messer Provenzano Salvani was displeasing to them, who was the greatest of the citizens of Siena, and that they would willingly yield up the city to the Florentines in return for 10,000 florins of gold, and that they were to come with a great host, under guise of fortifying Montalcino, as far as the river Arbia; and then they with their own forces, and with those of their followers, would give up to the Florentines the gate of Santo Vito, which is on the road to Arezzo.

“The friars, under this deceit and treachery, came to Florence with letters and seals from the aforesaid, and were brought before the Older of the People, and proposed to them means whereby they might do great things for the honour of the people and commonwealth of Florence; but the thing was so secret that it must under oath be revealed to but few.” [GV §77]

S15. WAR LOANS

Shift Siena, Provenzano, Giordano, OR Astimberg cylinder or Service 2 boxes or this Levy give 1 Lordship +2

Lords. Siena, Provenzano, Giordano, or Astimberg.

Tips. Shift one listed Lord’s cylinder left or Service right. Alternatively, add two Lordship to one of their Ratings for both Muster (3.4) and, if declared, Call to Arms Allies (3.5.4) this Levy.

History. Sienese financiers proved critical to Ghibelline military fortunes. Chronicler Tommasi states that the Sienese, for the purpose of financing the war asked Salimbene Salimbeni for obtain the sum of 18,000 gold florins, and Niccolò Ventura reports in the same context provision of the no doubt exaggerated sum of 118,000 gold florins.

Siena’s chronicle reports:

“Whereby they gathered twenty thousand gold florins by the Compagnia de’ Salimbemi of Siena, which at the time were Merchants. The Comune of Siena gave, as a pledge, the Rocca a Tentennano, and more Castella del Comune. These castles were the fortress at Tentennano, Montecuccari, Castiglioncello del Trinoro, Castello della Selva, and Monte Orsajo.” [CS p31]

Per Florentine Villani, after Firenze’s Spring 1260 rebuff near Siena:

“The Sienese and the Florentine refugees, perceiving how ill the Florentines had fared in the assault of so small a number of German horsemen, considered that if they had a greater number thereof, they would be victorious in the war. Immediately they provided themselves with money, procuring from the company of the Salimbeni, which were merchants of those days, 20,000 florins of gold, and gave them in pledge the fortress of Tentennano and several more castles of the commonwealth, and sent their ambassadors again into Apulia with the said money to King Manfred ...” [GV §76]

S16. BOCCA DEGLI ABATI – Florentine betrays Guelphs

Hold: Play on Guelph Lord in Battle. His Cavalieri take 1 Hit each; 1 that Routs joins Unrouted Forces of your Lord there

Lords. Any Guelph (at the Battle, to take Hits), any Ghibelline (at the Battle, to receive unit).

Tips. Play at the outset of Battle (4.4.1 Events), not in Storm. If played on Firenze Podestà or Comune, the Event affects only the units on that one mat, not the other. At the moment played, each Cavalieri unit on the affected mat must roll once against its Armor, Routing normally if it fails. If any Rout, the Ghibelline player takes one of them and adds it to the Forces of any Ghibelline mat in the Battle.

History. Bocca di Ranieri di Rustico degli Abati was a Florentine Guelph nobleman. With his compatriots, he mustered for the second great Guelph expedition to Siena in 1260. But secretly, he organized a perfidious plot against his city’s Guelphs: he sealed a hidden agreement with the Ghibelline side, upon battle to strike at the Guelph host from within it. With the militias of the Abati and Della Pressa families at his side, just in the most important moment of the Montaperti battle, when it seemed that the Firenze’s Guelph army could overrun the Ghibellines:

“...that traitor of a Messer Bocca degli Abati was in his troop and near to him, struck the said Messer Jacopo with his sword, and cut off the hand with which he held the standard, and immediately he died.”

Jacopo (or Iacopo) del Nacca dei Pazzi was the flag bearer of the Guelph *carroccio*. Dying, he let the banner fall to the ground. The Florentine cavalry became discouraged in the belief that the banner was lost.

“... And this done, the horsemen and people, beholding the standard fallen, and that there were traitors among them, and that they were so strongly assailed by the Germans, in a short time were put to flight....” [GV §78]

While much of this detail probably stems from legend, Guelph Florentines would remember the gesture for centuries. To them, Montaperti was the ugliest defeat of the Guelph party on Tuscan ground—a defeat due to treason and not a true defeat on the battlefield. Dante Alighieri strongly despised Bocca and eternalized his deeds in *Inferno* (XXXII 73-111), placing him among the great traitors of the Homeland. [MG p28]

S17. Ghibelline Refugees

Hold: Play if Provenzano or Santa Fiora on map to shift the other’s cylinder 2 boxes or give each Lordship +2 or add 1 of their Treachery

Lords. Provenzano or Santa Fiora.

Tips. Play the Event only if one of the listed Lords is on the map. If the cylinder of the other is on the Calendar, shift it left. Alternatively, play upon either Muster (3.4) or, if declared, Call to Arms Allies (3.5.4) to add two Lordship to the Rating of one or both listed Lords. Or, play any time to add the set-aside Treachery card of one list Lord to the Ghibelline Command deck.

History. The military role of political exiles still deserves thorough investigation, however they are almost never lacking in the lists of the armed men who participated in the main battles of the second half of the 13th Century.

Some cities stood out for their welcoming capacity. Ghibellines from all over northern Italy and Tuscany moved to Verona, for example, and fought with its forces, some, such as Ugucione della Faggiola and Spinetta Malaspina, obtaining important command roles. [PG p144]

A passage from Villani illustrates how efforts to consolidate Firenze's environs on behalf of Guelphs drove out a hardened population of Ghibellines:

"And because the government of the Popolo was not pleasing to the greater part of the Ghibelline families in Florence, forasmuch as it seemed to them that they favoured the Guelphs more than was pleasing to them, and as in past times they were used to do violence, and to be tyrannical, relying on the Emperor, therefore they were even now unwilling to follow the people and the Commune on the said expedition against Pistoia, rather did they both in word and in deed oppose it through factious hatred; forasmuch as Pistoia was ruled in those days by the Ghibelline party; whereby was caused so great mistrust, that when the host returned victorious from Pistoia, the said Ghibelline families in Florence were banished and sent forth from the city by the people of Florence, the said month of July, 1251." [GV §43]

As we know, these Florentine exiles ended up not only serving with Siena's Ghibelline armies but helping to drive their musters and military campaigns.

S18. CORTONA

Hold: Play for Treachery at Cortona to succeed for 0 Coin *or*, if Cortona Ghibelline, to roll on Revolt table *or* add 1 Treachery

Lords. Any Ghibelline (for Treachery).

Tips. To play the Event for Treachery to succeed without rolling or paying Coin, all other requirements for Treachery must be met, including revealing a Treachery card in the Plan with that Lord in position and the target eligible. The Treachery may be either Revolt or Bribe, as long as the target is *or* is at Cortona. For Revolt, Cortona must be eligible (1.4.1). To play the Event for a roll on the Revolt Table roll *or* to select any set-aside Treachery card to add to the Ghibelline deck, Cortona must at the moment of play have Ghibelline Allegiance markers (so not Ruins).

History. The *comuni* of both Arezzo and Firenze coveted the territory of Cortona. A result, that town sealed a lasting and trusted "friendship" with the city of Siena. The years 1258 to 1261 saw the most dramatic period of this relationship, when the Aretine Guelphs occupied and put Cortona on fire (see Campaign History, page 21). Escaped Ghibelline Cortonese with Siennese help finally on April 25th, 1261, managed to retake the city and drive away the invaders. This event that freed Cortona, known as the "*Romare* (riot) of San Marco", made St. Mark the Evangelist one of Cortona's patron saints from that moment on. But for Firenze, it was an escalation with the Ghibelline cities and towns that would lead to misery:



"In Christ's year 1259, being Podestà of Arezzo, messer Stoldo Giacoppi de' Rossi of Florence, with his mind and courage he guided the Aretini, and at night with stairs they entered Cortona, which was very strong, but for bad watching lost for the Cortonesi, and the Aretini destroyed the walls and fortress, and made them their vassals; hence the Florentines, who were in their league, were very upset, and accused the Aretines of having broken their peace." [GV §66]

S19. BRIGANDS

Hold: Play as Enemy Marches within 2 Locales of Giordano or Astimberg for him to take 2 Coin *or* 2 Loot *or* 4 Carts and 4 Prov from that Enemy

Lords. Any Guelph (to lose Assets), Giordano or Astimberg (to receive Assets).

Tips. The target Guelph Lord must just have used a March action. (It may be merely to Encamp or Sortie.) Count the range to the destination Locale. If using Hidden Mats (1.5.2) and the first choice of Assets is not fully available, the Ghibellines may alter their choice, until declaring the last possible option (only).

History. Very often the medieval Italian countryside gave refuge to bands of brigands. Many were autonomous; however, the majority acted on behalf to some secret master, who sent them to disturb the enemy with looting.

A famous Italian case, somewhat later than our period is that of Ghino di Tacco. Excluded from the honors reserved for patrician families, the progenitor Tacco, together with his sons Ghino and Turino, set the village of Torrita on fire. In revenge, Siena executed, Tacco and Turino in its Piazza del Campo in 1285, but Ghino managed to escape.

Ghino took possession of the castle of Radicofani, which would become a base for kidnappings and robberies that made him famous as a brigand. On Christmas night in 1297, he began to ambush wayfarers who travelled along the *Via Francigena*. Ghino robbed them completely but left them to survive and also offered them a banquet. And he spared the poor and students. The exploits of this Robin Hood figure receive mention by Dante in *Purgatorio* and Boccaccio in the *Decameron*. [www.valdichianaliving.it]

S20. HEAT & FROST

Hold: Play before Feed in Summer or Winter for Wastage (4.9.5) now, twice at Siege or if Moved / Fought. If Summer, remove 1 unit from Guido

Lords. All Guelphs and all Ghibellines (for Wastage); Guido Guerra (for unit removal).

Tips and History. See Guelph Event F20 HEAT & FROST.

S21. CONSTITUTO – *City statute*

Hold: Play to shift Siena or Pisa cylinder or Service 2 Calendar boxes *or* give one of them Lordship +3

Lords. Siena or Pisa.

Tips. Play to shift the cylinder of one listed Lord left or his Service right. Alternatively, play upon either Muster (3.4) or, if declared, Call to Arms Allies (3.5.4) to add three Lordship to the Rating of one of them.

History. A medieval Italian city's constitution, such as the periodically updated *Constituto* of Siena, for example, included among its laws and guidelines not only how to govern the city but also precise requirements for conscription, training, mustering, arming, and command of the army.

Within the system of power created by Emperor Frederick II, who maintained his vicars in the city, Siena's government acquired its own structure intertwined with its complex and particular social context. In the 13th Century, command passed from the old Consuls to a foreign *podestà*. The customary practice at that time called to an allied or otherwise friendly city for an official of military or administrative expertise (a knight or a jurist, for example) to govern the city impartially without favors for any particular faction.

The mandate of a *podestà* was limited in time, from a few months to a year, with the power to command and lead the army and provide administration by directing the City Council. From 1234, the governmental structure became more complex, with the implementation of the so-called Government of the Twenty-four at the helm of the city, made up of 12 members of the *Popolo* and as many of Ghibelline merchants, which remained in power alongside a *podestà* until 1270. (See also Guelph Event F21 PRIMO POPOLO.) [DNb p15; LF pp 110-111]

S22. CLOSED GATES

Remove 1 purple Ruins *or*, if none, remove 1 gold Ruins where Stronghold then eligible for Revolt (1.4.1); it Revolts (1.4.4)

Lords. None.

Tips and History. See Guelph Event F10 CLOSED GATES.

S23. ECONOMIC SANCTIONS

This Campaign, no Guelph Tax

Lords. All Guelphs.

Tips. Guelphs this entire Turn's Campaign may not use Tax Commands, including for F25 REINFORCED WALLS. The Capability on this card will not be available this Turn.

History. As Guelphs and Ghibellines battled within Tuscany, they appealed to one another foreign markets to block commerce that might enrich the other side. Guelphs turned to Richard of Cornwall to intercede with his brother Henry III to chase Sienese businessmen from England on the basis of Sienese help to Manfredi's campaign to conquer central Italy, which damaged Richard's candidacy for the imperial crown. This Event postulates even more effective embargo efforts by Ghibelline exiles against Guelph merchants and bankers. [DB pp 130-131]

S24. DOCTORS

Hold: Play in Battle or Storm for Siena and Pisa each to restore to their Forces half of their Lost units (round up)

Lords. Siena and Pisa.

Tips. Play at the outset of Battle or Storm (4.4.1 Events). After all Loss rolls (4.4.4), Pisa, Siena Podestà, and Siena Comune—whichever are involved in the combat—each separately restore half their Lost units, including any Knights that received Quarter.

History. See Guelph Event F24 DOCTORS.

S25. MAREMMA – *War*

If Grosseto or adjacent Castle Guelph, shift 3 Ghibelline cylinders or Service 1 box each. Ghibellines may declare Call to Arms

Lords. Any Ghibellines.

Tips. Conduct shifts (cylinders left or Service right) at the moment of drawing the Event if any of Grosseto, Castiglione della Pescaia, Montemassi, or Montepescali have Guelph IVP markers. The Capability on the card will not be available that Levy. After Muster, Ghibellines may trigger Call to Arms if desired (3.5), regardless of whether the rest of the Event text applied.

History. When at the end of 1259 Grosseto, Montemassi, and some smaller towns of the Maremma region violently rebelled against Siena, the city government gathered immediately. Worry was dire that an open clash with Firenze or, worse, an internal riot in the city could follow. But Count Giordano was able to encourage the Sienese. Taking the floor, he personally declared that, if needed, his Germans would enter Firenze itself.



The Sienese government, so heartened, decided upon immediate instruction to the army with the troops of the *Terzo* of Camollia to move toward Grosseto under the command of the *Podestà* Francesco Troghisio. They left on January 19th, 1260 and besieged Grosseto four days later. That town hoped for aid promised by the Guelphs and initially resisted well. But the Sienese, seeking to close the matter as soon as possible, declared a general levy throughout the countryside, adding men thus recruited to those available to Siena's various besieging forces. Grosseto, seeing that no aid would arrive, gave up on February 5th. (See also Campaign History, page 23.) [LF p114]

S26. MONTEPULCIANO – *War*

If a Town marked Guelph, shift Provenzano *and* Siena cylinder or Service 1 box each. Ghibellines may declare Call to Arms

Lords. Siena and Provenzano.

Tips. Conduct shifts (cylinders left or Service right) at the moment of drawing the Event if any originally Ghibelline Town (not Castle or City) has Guelph IVP markers. The Capability on the card will not be available that Levy. After Muster, Ghibellines may trigger Call to Arms if desired (3.5), regardless of whether the rest of the Event text applied.

History. Montepulciano was a border town between the territories of Siena and *Arezzo*. The Siense conquered it in 1232. But its *comune* never accepted the domination, and Montepulciano became the object of a series of disputes between Siena and Arezzo and then Firenze as well.



After Firenze's first abortive march on Siena, the Siense decided on a drive eastwards to destroy Montepulciano's resistance and free the route to Cortona. In this, they succeeded. (See also Campaign History, page 24.)

After Montaperti, Manfredi granted the land of Montepulciano to the municipality of Siena by his Privilege written at Foggia on November 20th, 1260. Six years later the town once again rebelled again against Siena and returned to its status as a Guelph town. [CP p32]

Ghibelline Capabilities

(bottom half of card)

S1. STORES & WELL WATER

Ghibelline Seats each can Supply up to 4 Provender, even to a Lord Besieged there

Lords. All Ghibellines.

Tips and History. See Guelph Capability F1.

S2. GUASTATORI – *Sappers*

This Lord's Siege adds 2 markers instead of 1. His Pass (4.7.7) replaces Enemy Siege there with Bypass.

Lords. Any Ghibelline.

Tips and History. See Guelph Capability F2.

S3. SIEGE TOWERS

This Lord Attacking in Storm from Round 2 on Strikes first with Archery and Melee

Lords. Any Ghibelline.

Tips and History. See Guelph Capability F3.

S4. TREBUCHETS

This Lord Unrouted at Storm or Sally where 3-4 Siege reduces Enemy Siegeworks or Walls –1

Lords. Any Ghibelline.

Tips and History. See Guelph Capability F4.

S5. WAR ENGINEERS

This Lord's Siege adds marker to any size Stronghold. Besieged, he can use entire Command to reduce to 1 Siege there

Lords. Any Ghibelline.

Tips and History. See Guelph Capability F5.

S6. FEDITORI – *Vanguard knights*

Up to 3 of this Lord's Cavalieri in Battle Melee Strike x2 Rounds 1 and 2

Lords. Siena, Provenzano, Pisa, or Santa Fiora.

Tips and History. See Guelph Capability F6 & F7.

S7. LUCERIA – *Composite bow archers*

Up to 3 of this Lord's Militia have Archery x1½. Ignore this Lord's ARCIERI.

Lords. Giordano, Astimberg, or Provenzano.

Tips. A Lord with LUCERIA and three or more Militia units would Strike with five Archery Hits (4½ rounded up), doubled to nine Hits if Defending with S6 HILLS., for example. If the Lord happened also to have S16 or S17 ARCIERI, it would add no Hits.

History. In the 1220s, Emperor Frederick II subjugated Islamic Arab populations that had long resisted Christian rule from refuges in the mountains of Sicily. Impressed with their martial quality—especially their mastery of the composite bow—the Emperor resettled some to the Apulian town of Lucera, where he granted them a fief to rule as an autonomous Islamic republic—“*Luceria Saracenorum*” to Christian chroniclers. The so-called “Saracen” archers proved highly effective light infantry, more tactically flexible and naturally with a higher rate of fire than the vaunted communal crossbow-pavise teams.

Lucera archers formed a key part of the Emperor's armies, augmented the garrisons of the imperialist Ezzelino da Romano in Italy's north, and were likewise available to Manfredi. Muslim noblemen from Lucera accompanied Giordano north in December 1259. Provenzano's appeal for royal aid in Spring 1260 (Event F14 PROVENZANO) obtained reinforcements from Lucera, in addition to more Hohenstaufen *Ritter*, and these contingents may have fought alongside one another at Montaperti. [PC; GE pp 19-20, 22, 27, 44; DNb pp 16, 30; RS p13; RM p39; Stuart Ellis-Gorman].

S8. BALESTRE GROSSE – *Large crossbows*

This Lord's Men-at-Arms in Storm have Crossbows x½, –2 to target's Armor, that select targets if Defending

Lords. Siena, Provenzano, or Santa Fiora.

Tips and History. See Guelph Capability F8.

S9-S11. BALESTRIERI – *Crossbowmen*

Up to 3 of this Lord's Armigeri have Crossbows x1, –2 to target Armor, that select targets in Storm Defense

Lords. Any Ghibelline.

Tips and History. See Guelph Capability F9-F11.

S12. ARMY RESERVE

Siena, Provenzano, and Pisa Cavalieri in Battle Melee Strike x2 from Round 3 on

Lords. Siena, Provenzano, or Pisa.

Tips and History. See Guelph Capability F12.

S13-S15. PALVESARI – *Shieldmen*

This Lord's Armigeri have Armor 1-4, until 3 Rout. Their Crossbows always select targets

Lords. Any Ghibelline.

Tips and History. See Guelph Capability F13-F15.

S16 & S17. ARCIERI – *Bowmen*

This Lord's Militia have Archery x1

Lords. Any Ghibelline.

Tips and History. See Guelph Capability F16 & F17.

S18. LA CAVALLATA – *Long-range raiders*

This Lord may pay 1 Prov to use entire Command to Ravage adjacent Locale, not at Unbesieged Enemy Lord

Lords. Any Ghibelline.

Tips and History. See Guelph Capability F18.

S19. GUALDANA – *Horse marauders*

This Lord treats any Horse unit as Berrovieri for Ravage

Lords. Any Ghibelline.

Tips and History. See Guelph Capability F19.

S20. MASNADIERI – *Looters*

This Lord may Ravage for 0 actions, taking no Loot

Lords. Any Ghibelline.

Tips and History. See Guelph Capability F20.

S21. SOVRINTENDENTE – *Superintendent of castles*

Ghibelline Castle Garrisons replace their Militia with Crossbow x1 Armigeri.

Lords. None.

Tips. With SOVRINTENDENTE in effect, Guelph Storm of any Castle (whether originally Ghibelline or marked with Ghibelline Allegiance) will face a Garrison of one Men-at-Arms with Crossbows x½, one Armigeri with Crossbows x1, and one Cavalieri.



History. The *comuni* expended considerable effort to control their claimed territory, keeping hundreds of men perpetually under arms to guarantee their scattered strongholds. In the 13th Century, for example, the municipality of Verona in the north garrisoned some 30 fortifications, for example, with foot men-at-arms including crossbowmen, under the command of city captains. Treviso garrisoned 10 strongholds and the estuaries to the sea of the Piave and Boite rivers. Padua had captains in 11 *castra* with substantial garrisons of up to 100 men.

These garrisons all fell under the supervision of a special officer called *Sovrintendente* or Superintendent of castles. All these officers naturally needed to be the most strictly reliable of citizens.

Upon war, garrisons might be reinforced. The rival Papal States towns of Perugia and Foligno had each built and garrisoned castles to control commercially important access to the sea. When they went to war in 1282, Perugia's *comune* levied supplies of crossbows from its countryside to equip its new castles. [PG p120; DNb p46]

S22. MANFREDI

Ghibelline Lords except Pisa start at any Lord Seat (not Vassal Seat) that is Friendly Command +1.

Lords. All Ghibellines except Pisa.

Tips. "Command +1" means that a Lord with Command Rating "2" instead could take three Command actions on his card, for example (1.5.3, 4.2.1). The added Command applies for that Lord's entire Command card, regardless of whether the Lord ends up still at a Friendly Lord Seat.

History. Manfred (Manfredi in Italian) was the Italian-speaking Hohenstaufen King of Sicily (and thus southern Italy) at the time of Montaperti. Bastard son of Holy Roman Emperor Frederick II, Manfredi had become vicar of Italy and Sicily for his half brother Conrad IV but soon begun seeking the Sicilian crown for himself. Upon Conrad's death in 1254, a diet at San Germano ignored the imperial representative and elected Manfredi. Pope Alexander IV, however, excommunicated him. A papal army entered the Kingdom, but Manfred fought it successfully and was crowned King of Sicily at Palermo on August 10th, 1258. He further strengthened his position in 1260 by the betrothal of his daughter Constance to the *infante* Peter of Aragon. (See also Campaign History, page 20.)

As protector of the Italian Ghibellines, Manfred asserted himself also in Lombardy and especially in Tuscany. Reports Villani:

"King Manfred, who, having heard the tidings, was wrath, and with the money of the Sieneze, who paid half the charges for three months, and at his own cost, sent into Tuscany Count Giordano, his marshal, with 800 German horsemen, to go with the said ambassadors; who reached Siena in the end of July, the year of Christ 1260, and by the Sieneze were received with great rejoicing, and they and all the Ghibellines of Tuscany drew thence great vigour and courage."
[GS pp 113-116; LF p113; GV §76]



S23. TAGLIA – *Mercenary army*

Non-Podestà Ghibelline Lords may Muster 1 Unmustered Vassal of another; when they do, they add 2x Carts

Lords. Giordano, Astimberg, Provenzano, and Santa Fiora.

Tips. With TAGLIA in play, Giordano, Astimberg, Provenzano, and Santa Fiora each could Muster one Vassal to their own Forces, along with two Carts each, otherwise following normal Vassal Muster rules (3.4.2). The Vassals could be those of any other of those four Lords. The borrowed Vassals may not currently be Mustered, including as Turncoats (4.7.6). Borrowed Vassals Disband normally, such as when the host Lord Disbands (3.3).



History. After Montaperti, the Ghibelline League in the council at Empoli decreed the formation of the *Taglia*, the first official attempt in Tuscany to form mercenary army representing the alliance as a whole. (See Campaign History, page 29.)

As such a concentration of professional troops could become dangerous, the *Taglia* mixed soldiers from different cities, in proportion to the financial contribution that each *comune* had provided. The League entrusted command to an Italian nobleman—beginning with Count Giordano—but flanked by a council of delegates from the allied municipalities who dictated the general strategy.

The *Taglia* became a special corps of selected and collectively financed mercenary heavy horse. It was to remain small, however, serving to integrate rather than replace the city armies. For a campaign against Arezzo in 1287, for example, 300 professional *Taglia* soldiers formed a core for 1,500 municipal knights sent by various members of the League. At Campaldino in 1289, the Florentines deployed just 400 mercenaries. The spread of mercenary armies in Tuscany would remain slow. [GV §81; DB pp 71-73; PG p144]

S24. ASTROLOGERS

Each Ghibelline Lord on his first Command card each Campaign on die roll of 1-2 is Command +1

Lords. All Ghibellines.

Tips and History. See Guelph Capability F24.

S25. REINFORCED WALLS

Ghibelline Tax may instead mark Seat used Walls +1 if not already marked. Remove if Ruins

Lords. All Ghibellines.

Tips and History. See Guelph Capability F25.

S26. COSTRUTTORI – *Master stonecutters*

Ghibelline Lords for a full Command card, 1 Coin, and 3 Prov remove Ruins from their Locale

Lords. All Ghibellines.

Tips and History. See Guelph Capability F26.

Design Note

Not long after *Nevsky* inaugurated the *Levy & Campaign* Series, a friend let me know that Italian wargame designer Enrico Acerbi had said good things online about the game and even done up some L&C-style Italian medieval Lords. I got in touch with Enrico to see if he would have any interest in working on a volume for the Series. To my amazement, not three months later, he sent me a complete first draft of a design—even including Arts of War historical notes!

As with *Nevsky* and *Almoravid*, *Inferno* passed through a lengthy test and development process. Enrico's original gameboard, Lords, and Forces remained with only minor calibrations. Heavier refinement focused on newer mechanics such as Revolt, Bribe, and Ransom. Enrico's original "Revolt" cards as part of the Command decks evolved into Treachery cards that players had to earn before using and could trigger a Bribe in addition to Revolt. The Arts of War deck structure remains very similar to the original, but with lots of banging and bashing on the particulars. Scenario structure similarly remained the same as the original story that Enrico set out but with tuning of balance and play experience in each of them.

A particular challenge and joy that I had in co-design of *Inferno* was that sources on the military setting in English are few, hard to find, and sometimes inconsistent. It took me quite a bit of searching and sifting to obtain a coherent picture of the Tuscan campaigns of 1259-1261, and the effort produced a great satisfaction in having learned this story to a historical acuity not obtainable by any other means known to me. In that, I bear deep gratitude not only to Enrico's guidance but also the assistance from several consultants credited in this booklet.

At about the time that Volume II, *Almoravid*, went to press, *Plantagenet* designer Francisco "Pako" Gradaille set up a Discord server to support playtest of his new *Levy & Campaign* design. The idea occurred to us that we could host all the disparate L&C design efforts together in one place, not only to find and encourage precious playtest volunteers but also to leverage cross-pollination in order make new volumes at once consistent with core Series elements and ever fresh and innovative. Among the most exciting aspects of L&C for me is the fabulous success of this online Discord design studio, which now sees daily work and exchange on so many live projects that I have to keep track of them on a spreadsheet!

An equally exciting and to me surprising outcome has been the broad receptivity of boardgamers to a series of two-player wargames set in the Middle Ages. We all work hard to make *Levy & Campaign* games as accessible as they can be, while keeping the history that they deliver as vivid and accurate as possible. But the rules are not necessarily easy to learn. And they contain abstractions and compromises that naturally are open to more than reasonable debate. The dedication that so many players have shown to digging into these consims, to enjoying them as games, and to taking them seriously as a means of historical exploration is the most critical ingredient for *Levy & Campaign* to flourish as a Series. It also touches my heart.

—Volko Ruhnke
Virginia, May 2022



Development Notes

From Christophe Correia:

New Mechanics. Development of *Inferno* proceeded under direction of the game's designers, Enrico Acerbi and Volko Ruhnke. Development needs to both meet the designers' intent for the game and ensure game balance. A key effort here was to calibrate the two most important subsystems that the designers introduced into *Levy & Campaign* with this volume: Revolt/Treachery and Call to Arms/WAR Cards.

Revolt & Treachery. Treachery cards allow players to Bribe an Enemy Vassal or incite an Enemy Stronghold to Revolt to your side's Allegiance, especially to regain control of an Enemy Stronghold inside your own territory. Development of that part of the design came in several phases.

Inferno already had Storm and Siege. So, we needed to tune the mechanics to the right probabilities, so that all three ways to gain control of an Enemy Stronghold would be worthwhile and viable options. Otherwise, players would end up not using major mechanics in the game at all, and play would fail to represent what happened historically. (For example, in gameplay terms, Cortona historically had revolted against the Guelphs, got Stormed by Arezzo's Lord, then by Siena's Lords Revolted back over to the Ghibelline side.)

We balanced the probabilities for an earlier version of how Treachery cards worked, but the gameplay just wasn't engaging enough. We feared that players would just focus on Siege as their only tactic, for example. So we amped Treachery to the most powerful mechanic (but not by a big enough margin that it becomes the only viable potential approach), then limited it to the number of Treachery cards that players can get into their decks through Events, Disband of Enemy Lords, and so on. You can find great tips on how to use the Treachery cards in the chapter On Strategy near the front of this Background Book.

Call to Arms. Declaring war is a totally process in this volume. With a Call to Arms, Lords get some extra March and Muster. When WAR occurs, you can really feel the intensification of the conflict and the mobilization of your side for the upcoming clash. Battles become more likely, and Storming and Revolt rolls can shift the game very quickly.

Capabilities. We did a lot of work into computations to balance key Capability cards. For example, how strong should the PALVESARI be compared to opposing FEDITORI? Given the history, what percentage of damage should each type of arms—Archery, Foot Melee, and Horse—do? Compared to *Almoravid* and even *Nevsky*, the Crossbowmen are more efficient, while the heavy cavalry is less efficient than that for the Christian side in *Almoravid* or the Teutons of *Nevsky*.

We had to take each of these combat elements into account to give the player a proper offering. Some Capabilities will be more efficient for certain Lords (for example, the combination of PALVESARI and BALESTRIERI is very potent for Firenze's Comune). Since there are only a few of each Capability and limited room with each Lord, players need to assign cards where most needed. "Would you prefer to have WAR ENGINEERS or SIEGE TOWERS?" should be an interesting question.

Developing *Inferno* also meant tweaking numbers so a card is a choice you have to make, and that many cards are good on many Lords at many moments, but those cards could become a liability later down the road.

For example, LUCERIA without the limit to three units could give Giordano, with Turncoat or TAGLIA Vassals and HILLS, a massive number of Archery Hits that no opposing Lord could survive, skewing combat to undo any Guelph strategy. The unit cap on such Capabilities the represents historically the limited availability of these specialists.

We also broadened the pairing of particular Lords with particular Capabilities. Too strict or too obvious a pairing would have meant no real strategy in *Levy*, or at best an illusion of choice.

Stability. A core gameplay difference between *Inferno* and the Volume I and II of the Series is that competition in *Nevsky* and *Almoravid* is stable enough that you can (most of the time) confidently plan and execute your strategy. Not so in *Inferno*. The opportunities that Events grant you (WAR cards, those adding Treachery, SURPRISE, and so on) are more important, and swings in VP are far greater than in *Nevsky* and somewhat greater than in *Almoravid*.

In *Nevsky*, the game might be considered over with a 4VP difference at the start of the last Turn. Playtesting showed that, in *Inferno*, a side can come back from a 5VP deficit with Revolt rolls that add on to a Surrender, Disband of a Podestà Disband, or a final flurry of Treachery. A side going into the last Turn with a wide lead will still be heavily favored (as it should be), but many playtests saw such reversals—which helps keep players engaged.

Scenarios. Another notable difference is how *Inferno* is built historically. For the grand campaign scenarios in Volumes I and II, one side (Teutons or Christians) has the strength advantage in the early turns, while the other side (Russians or Muslims) is biding its time, awaiting the arrival of Aleksandr Nevsky or the Almoravids. The two sides in *Inferno*'s fratricidal conflict are roughly equal in strength and in their ability to shape the map to their advantage. When developing the game, we took into account that neither side can well count on overpowering the other in early Turns.

Other Differences. Those who have already played the *Levy & Campaign* series will notice differences within each volume. For example, *Nevsky* has Boats, Carts, Sleds, and Ships. Each of those is usable on a particular type of Way, and some are not usable at all in certain Seasons—representing the difficulties of logistics in northern Russia during the 13th Century. *Almoravid* uses Carts and Mules (and ships in effect, through cards). The reduced constraints on movement (as higher Command Ratings of various Lords also represent) allows for more operational mobility within the map's larger territory.

Inferno's use of just Carts (with Ships as an ancillary type of Transport) offers even less constraint on the players' logistical planning, compared to earlier volumes. The ability to gather a lot of Provender at once through Supply actions enhances that. In 13th-Century central Italy, logistics were less of a problem than in northwest Russia, as is represented in the earlier design. The wealth of Tuscany also shows in the number of Strongholds on the game map. In most scenarios, all Locales are Strongholds, either Castles, Towns, or Cities. In other scenarios, a Stronghold here or there is Ruined but can be rebuilt at a cost. Sides can acquire more Loot by Ravaging, due to the higher number of Strongholds, while some Locales in Tuscany's prosperous conditions will recover from Ravage every few Seasons.

Components. Live playtesting is of utmost importance not only to balance gameplay but also to refine presentational issues as how big markers should be or where icons need to appear on the cards. Which fronts and backs of counters should together—Guelph Ravage with Ghibelline Ravage, or the same color Ravage on both sides? Players will naturally arrange themselves around the map, and the results tell us what setup will feel the most intuitive.

Fortunately for *Inferno*, *Nevsky* was already out when this volume started development, and the number of components is not high enough for it to be a real problem as it can for other games. Some choices needed to be made for economy, but the only deliberate shortage the players may face during play of *Inferno* is the pool of Cavalieri and Ritter wedges, because of the Ransom mechanic.

Both someone with knowledge of the Guelph-Ghibelline conflict and interest in playing a game on that era and a seasoned wargamer who may not know a lot about that conflict should get something out of *Inferno*—whether it is the simulation's historicity, engaging mechanics, the background information in this booklet, or simply discovery of a historical setting found in few games, as was the case for *Nevsky* and *Almoravid*, Volumes I and II of the Series.

I hope that this game will be as enjoyable for you to play as it was for John and me and many others to playtest and develop!

From John Campbell:

Goals. Player goals in *Inferno* align much with the two previous *Levy & Campaign* volumes, in that you wish to outscore your opponent in Victory Points (VPs) by the end of the scenario. Conquering Strongholds by Siege or Treachery or destroying them by Storm, as well as Ravaging Enemy lands will garner

VP. There isn't a heavy sway in one direction or the other as to which is best, as we tried to make all options equally attractive.

Rules. One of the things that makes *Levy & Campaign* seem overwhelming at first is that there are lots of rules. The rules in and of themselves are not overly complicated, but it can feel that a lot is coming at you at one time initially. Fortunately, in terms of logistics, *Inferno* is less complicated than *Nevsky* or *Almoravid*. And the more or less symmetrical nature of the opposing forces trims down on need to memorize every card, as both sides have many similar Capabilities. Call to Arms with War is slightly more complicated than in Volume I or II, and there are Treachery, Revolt, and Bribe as well as Knights' Quarter to contend with. But, other than that, movement and Levy are very close to the same as in previous volumes.

Interaction. Of the three volumes, I would say *Inferno* has the most interaction and reaction. In *Nevsky*, up to some point, you can play Avoidance- and Ravage-heavy, then near end game seek decisive battle. In *Inferno*, with Treachery cards, Revolts and Bribes, and lots of Enemy Lords and Armies in play you cannot just adopt a strategy of just choosing your Plan and ignoring what your opponent might be doing. In that sense, the game mimics chess in that you should be analyzing both your opportunities and what your opponent might be doing as well. When Enemy Lords meet at a Locale, you more often have a difficult decision here regarding whether to give Battle, Avoid, or Withdraw within your Stronghold's walls.

Emergent Strategy. Chess is a classic of game design due to its emergent strategy. The base rules of the game are relatively simple yet the complexity that arises from the movement and positioning between two players seems infinite. In *Inferno*, your mind will want to seek patterns in order to model and understand it. You won't be able to predict everything your opponent will do because the other side's Command card stack is hidden and—if you play with the options that I do—its Forces and what Capabilities might be Levied are hidden as well. This adds a lot of surprise to the game and more tension to encounters. Furthermore, Siege rolls in *Inferno* are not a given but dependent upon Stronghold Size—a slight change from *Nevsky* carried over from *Almoravid*—in addition to the amount of investment (in terms of Siege and Ravage markers) spent at that location to get it to fall. The more you play the better you will get.

Balance and Resource Control. We made many efforts to lessen the impact of any one or two cards or Capabilities to decide a game. We have tested the full-length scenario as well as the shorter scenarios make them as balanced and evenhanded as we could. Both sides have relatively even resources, though in asymmetrical ways. the Guelphs are slightly stronger in wealth, while the Ghibellines have a central board position.

Presentation. *Inferno* card art, board art, and components are top notch, as always in *Levy & Campaign*. *Nevsky* had such an artistic map, with weathered features and slight shading for the boundary between Teuton and Rus. Here in *Inferno*, I think Robert and Mathew have done an outstanding job portraying medieval art style while presenting it along similar lines as in the previous volumes.

Selected Sources

Source abbreviations used in this booklet:

- AS** = Aldo Settia, *Rapine, Assedi, Battaglie*
CAV = Cesare Paoli, “Le Cavallate Fiorentine”
CM = Colloredo-Mels, *La battaglia di Montaperti*
CO = Philippe Contamine, *War in the Middle Ages*
CP = Cesare Paoli, *La Battaglia Di Montaperti*
CS = *Cronica Senese*
DB = Duccio Balestracci, *La Battaglia di Montaperti*
DNa = David Nicolle, *Italian Medieval Armies*
DNb = David Nicolle, *Italian Militiaman*
FC = Federico Canaccini, *Ghibellini e ghibellinismo*
GE = Gabriele Esposito, *Armies of Italian Wars*
GS = Grillo & Settia, *Guerre ed eserciti nel Medioevo*
GV = Giovanni Villani, *Nuova Cronica*
LF = Luca Fusai, *La Storia di Siena*
LM = *Il Libro di Montaperti*
LP = Lorenzo Pignotti, *Storia della Toscana*
MG = Marco Giuliani, “Legend” in Venturi, *Montaperti – La battaglia di nel diorama*
MV = Marco Valenti, *L’insediamento altomedievale*
PG = Paolo Grillo, *Cavaliere e popoli in armi*
RM = Roberto Marchionni, *Tuscan Armies*
RS = Riccardo Semplici, “Chronology” in Venturi, *Montaperti – La battaglia di nel diorama*

Chronicles of Medieval Italy

Dei, Andrea. *Cronica Senese dall’Anno 1186 fino al 1352, continuata da Agnolo di Tura in Muratori Ludovico Antonio, Rerum Italicarum Scriptores, Tome XV* (Milano, 1729). This is an original chronicle dating to 1300 in “volgare” language that narrates occurrences in Siena between 1186 and 1329, continued at a later time by Angelo di Tura (called “the Fat”) up to the year 1351. This Siennese chronicle also appeared under the Latin title *Chronicon Senense*. Edited by the Siennese philologist Uberto Benvoglianti, rather than a true chronicle, it appears to be an anthology of news, documents, and private memories, taken from other sources, some not official, and generally connected to each other in time and by relevance to the history of Siena in the 13th Century.

Il Libro di Montaperti – anno MCCLX. Cesare Paoli, editor (Firenze, 1889). This notebook is not a chronicle of the battle but the economic report of the 1260 Florentine military expeditionary force. It records all the variables of a medieval expeditionary force: soldiers and weapons, food, lords, and so on. This is the only official Florentine source concerning the 1260 war between the Guelphs of Firenze and the Ghibellines of Siena. Most of the notations concern the first expedition organized under the

war against Siena that culminated in the clashes of May 17th and 18th, 1260.

Villani, Giovanni. *Nuova Cronica dal principio all’anno MC-CCXLVIII* (online in English at <http://www.gutenberg.org/files/33022/33022-h/33022-h.htm>). Florentine Giovanni Villani composed this chronicle, abruptly interrupted when he got the Plague in 1348. One of the most successful of European medieval books, as many as 111 manuscript copies have been found. Villani was a merchant but also very present on the city’s political scene, often serving in important public roles. He conceived the idea of writing the “new chronical” during his pilgrimage to Rome in the Jubilee Year 1300. Like many other medieval sources, most of which are from clerical authors, his narrative is very biased against anyone outside of or opposed to Firenze. He remains nevertheless our most reliable source for the period.

Italy in the 13th Century

Artusi, Luciano. *Firenze araldica – Il linguaggio dei simboli convenzionali che blasonarono gli stemmi civici* (2009). Richly illustrated book that describes the heraldry of medieval Florence. The author has conducted accurate research in the varied public heraldic sectors, analyzing the numerous coats of arms and recurring images on the palaces of Florence, evoking famous families, institutions, corporations or characters who have played a leading role in the city’s life.

Browning, Oscar. *Guelphs & Ghibellines—A Short History of Mediaeval Italy from 1250-1409* (London, 1894). Dated but readable introduction in flowery English to the party politics of medieval Italy.

Cammarosano, Paolo. *Storia di Colle di Val d’Elsa nel Medioevo: Vol. 2 Colle nell’età d’Arnolfo di Cambio* (Trieste, 2009). Very important local historical study about the *comune* of Colle di Val d’Elsa and how tightly that town’s affairs bound to those of its powerful neighbor Siena. This volume is very useful for understanding the commercial and military dynamics of a town at the border between Guelph and imperial influence.

Canaccini, Federico. *Ghibellini e ghibellinismo in Toscana da Montaperti a Campaldino, 1260-1289* (Roma, 2009). A second Italian book that, like Semplici’s chapter in Venturi’s Montaperti diorama book, includes a chronology of the Guelph-Ghibelline conflict. This one pays particular attention to the changing allegiances and fills in some blanks.

Cenni, Alessio. *L’arco e gli arcieri nell’Italia Medievale* (Bologna, 1997). Important work which, for the first time in Italy, presents a comparative background on all matters regarding bows, crossbows, and archery of the Italian Middle Ages. In particular, it details the role of the archer in communal and feudal Italy and what the real effectiveness was of bow and arrow in hunting and in battle. It also covers the relationship between those weapons and tactics for defensive use.

Esposito, Gabriele. *Armies of the Medieval Italian Wars 1125-1325* (Oxford, 2019). A third Osprey volume (along with the two earlier booklets from David Nicolle) full of illustrations and information on the fighting men of medieval Italy.

Favini, Vieri and Alessandro Savorelli. *Segni di Toscana – Identità e territorio attraverso l'araldica dei comuni: storia e invenzione grafica (secoli XIII-XVII)* (Firenze, 2006). Heraldry is definitively one of the sources of history. Starting from the Middle Ages, the use of heraldic signs extended beyond the feudal lords to new “impersonal” subjects. Cities, corporations, hospitals, factions, companies, and others helped create forms of symbolic self-representation of territory, society, and political membership. This volume gives us a key to understanding the phenomenon of public heraldry in its development, clearing away many clichés that afflict studies on the subject. Tuscany offers an extraordinary field of investigation on the history of symbols, preserving one of the largest visual and archival documentary records in Europe.

Fusai, Luca. *La Storia di Siena dalle origini al 1559* (Siena, 1991). This is an old volume that offers some interesting information on the government of Siena in 1200-1300 but is more interested in giving us the origins of the *contrade* neighborhoods and the famous *Palio* horserace.

Guerre ed eserciti nel Medioevo. Paolo Grillo and Aldo A. Settia, editors (Bologna, 2018). Important book collecting various essays that provide new perspectives about medieval Italian armies. The essays do not represent medieval wars as the usual clashes between knights but rather describe the complex operation and difficulties of fielding and supplying an army. Especially interesting is the part regarding sieges, which would be prepared with great care. This volume also is a trove of information on the refinement of technology such as more advanced weapons.

Guerra e guerrieri nella Toscana medievale, Franco Cardini and Marco Tangheroni, editors (Firenze, 1989). This volume is a collection of essays edited by two of the major Italian historians of the 1990s. The most important essays for *Inferno* were:

“Le battaglie campali” (Field battles),

“Il controllo politico di un esercito durante il Medioevo: l'esempio di Firenze” (The political control of an army during the Middle Ages: the example of Florence),

“Difese urbane e fortificazioni del territorio toscano in età comunale: strutture superstiti e fonti iconografiche” (Urban defenses and fortifications of Tuscan region in the Communal age: surviving and iconographic sources),

“Delle insegne di guerra e delle Compagnie del Popolo in Toscana nei secc. XIII-XIV (On war banners and those of the People's Companies in Tuscany in the 13th–14th Centuries), and

“Allora fu battaglia aspra e dura.’ Memoria e ritualità della guerra nella Toscana del Dugento” (“Then he was harsh and hard battle.” Memory and rituality of the war in Tuscany of the 1200).

Guerre e assoldati in Toscana: 1260-1364. L.G. Boccia and M. Scalini, editors (Firenze, 1982). This is the catalog of an exhibition held at the Stibbert Museum in Florence, specializing in Renaissance weapons. It is a book full of interesting details, especially on the type of soldiers who fought in Tuscany in the 13th Century.

Grillo, Paolo. *Cavaliere e popoli in armi: Le istituzioni militari nell'Italia medievale* (Roma-Bari, 2008). An important book that informs about the ways in which the armed forces that secured and expanded the different dominions in Italy from the Fifth to the 15th Centuries were organized, rewarded, and controlled. Extremely interesting discussion of communal infantry, the “*Venticinquine*”, and the recruitment and command system.

Nicolle, David. *Italian Medieval Armies 1000-1300* (Oxford 2002) and *Italian Militiaman 1260-1392* (Oxford 1999). Osprey booklets packed with English-language illustrated information on troops and equipment.

Paoli, Cesare. “Le Cavallate Fiorentine nei secoli XIII e XIV” in *Archivio Storico Italiano* (Leo Olschki, editor), serie III, tomo 1, parte I (Firenze, 1865). This magazine article describes the “*Cavallate*” and how they differed from common wars of the 13th Century.

Pieri, Piero. *L'evoluzione delle milizie comunali italiane* (Torino, 1966). Professor Piero Pieri can be considered the father of Italian military history, which had become a regime history during the years of fascism. Even if his historiographical setting is very close to that of Hans Delbrück, Pieri gave us a great history of the *Risorgimento* and this work on the military life of the communal armies. Brilliant in particular is his article “I Saraceni di Lucera nella storia militare medievale”.

Pignotti, Lorenzo. *Storia della Toscana sino al Principato*, volumes II, IIIa, IIIb (Firenze, 1821). This is a very old book—the first edition was in 1813. It is, however, the sole large work that provides a general guide to medieval Tuscany (not just Firenze or Siena). Although very generic, useful information on minor towns emerges here and there.

Settia, Aldo Angelo. *Comuni in Guerra – Armi ed eserciti nell'Italia delle città* (Bologna, 1993). The works of Aldo Angelo Settia are considered the starting point for any historical research concerning the age of Italian municipalities. This book explores the theme of the equipment of the communal infantry and army. Many new aspects here eliminate stereotypes of medieval armies and highlight their management on campaign.

Settia, Aldo Angelo. *Rapine, assedi, battaglie – La guerra nel Medioevo* (Roma-Bari, 2002). A great book for a general look across war in the Middle Ages. That it concerns above all Italy and the comuni makes it even more valuable, a “Contamine” for Italian medieval warfare. The structure relies on anecdotes, that is, after an introduction, the author reports the events connected to that topic. Settia describes the preparatory elements in conflicts such as rules of march, organization of logistics, and choice of battlefield. He also pays attention to elements not directly connected to war, such as *battagliole* (“little fights”) and urban simulations of battle, that characterized the urban communal context.

Valenti, Marco. *L'insediamento altomedievale delle campagne toscane – Paesaggi, popolamento e villaggi tra VI e X secolo* (Firenze, 2004). Data from recent years on European archeology of late ancient and medieval buildings. The volume also discusses landscapes, scattered settlements and wide open spaces, and the structure of Tuscan villages as adjacent to castles or castles themselves.

The Battle of Montaperti

Balestracci, Duccio. *La battaglia di Montaperti* (Roma-Bari, 2019). All Italian conflicts drove to Montaperti, a battle that seemed to mark a turning point in the history of Italy. This volume is not so much the story of the battle itself but more of the political situation of the period. It succeeds in explaining why the Ghibelline victory quickly turned into the beginning of the crisis of Ghibellinism and the turning point that returned the Popes and the Guelphs to the center of Italian political life.

Colloredo-Mels, Pierluigi Romeo di and Mario Venturi *La battaglia di Montaperti – Storia e cronaca di una battaglia del Duecento, Vol.1-2*, (Bergamo, 2019). Small, light publications, but with exceptional illustrations of the heraldry of the battle, background on the development of the Guelph-Ghibelline conflict, tactical organization of troops, and pertinent lists of the contingents from various states. Very easy and exciting to read.

Marchionni, Roberto. *Eserciti Toscani (1) – Senesi e Fiorentini a Montaperti (Tuscan Armies (1) – Sienese and Florentines at Montaperti*, Siena, 1996), and *I Senesi a Montaperti* (Siena, 1992). The books of Marchionni at first sight seem quite superficial and light, but they contain much useful information, obtained from antique sources, especially regarding the city of Siena and its Terzi. Tuscan Armies considers various sources and opines on the specific makeup of the contingents that fought on the 4th of September, 1260—a valuable resource for the development of orders of battle for a wargame.

Paoli, Cesare. *La Battaglia Di Montaperti* (Siena, 1869). This work is obviously affected by the age in which it was written. It turns out to be a good guide to the Sienese version of the battle, with the story of the legends connected to it. There is a very hard bias favouring the Ghibelline view.

Venturi, Mario (editor). *Montaperti – La battaglia di nel diorama* (Firenze, 2000). A booklet dedicated to the making of a diorama of the battle, it contains a chapter in Italian and English by Riccardo Semplici of exquisite use to development of the historical timeline that *Inferno* was to depict: “Chronology of the principal events at the time of Montaperti”, a summary of political and operational activities from 1214 to 1260 related to the Guelph-Ghibelline conflict between Firenze and Siena. Another chapter, “The Legend of Montaperti” by Marco Giuliani, provides engaging details of the summer and fall 1260 campaigns, the day of the great battle. A further chapter from Guiliani, “Arms, armour, and organization of the army” covers tactical aspects going beyond the battle itself to characterize forces of the time. The little volume abounds with closeup photography of diorama scenes and with other illustrations relevant to the battle.

Warfare in the Middle Ages

Cardini, Franco. *Alle radici della cavalleria medievale* (Milano, 2004 new edition). Cardini is an emeritus professor of medieval history in the Italian Institute of Human Sciences / Superior Normal School. He is also Directeur de Recherches in the École des Hautes Études en Sciences Sociales of Paris and Fellow of Harvard University. Acute analysis of cavalry and cavalrymen,

including Italian. It is a complete representation of the evolution of cavalry, between history and epic, the story of a millenary myth and its lasting reflections.

Cardini, Franco. *Quell'antica festa crudele: Guerra e cultura della guerra dal Medioevo alla Rivoluzione francese* (Firenze, 1988). Important work about the idea of war: not only from the point of view of technical and strategic evolution but also and above all from that of ideology and mentality. In short, it discusses cavalry, its “culture”, and the place that it had in society. Ranging over a very long period of time, it focuses on but goes beyond the High Middle Ages to show a picturesque gallery of literary and other testimony.

Contamine, Philippe. *War in the Middle Ages* (Oxford-New York 1986). Classic European history book with tremendous depth and insight into the feudal structures and legal systems around warfare in the Middle Ages. It also gives insights into how the nobility owed their position to their military obligations and how the rise of currency-based economies eventually led to their obsolescence in society. Not an easy read, but intriguing.

Delbrück, Hans. *History of the Art of War, Volume III: Medieval Warfare* (Lincoln and London 1990), originally *Geschichte der Kriegskunst im rahmen der politischen Geschichte* (Berlin, 1923). The relevant portion of a traditional bible for wargame designers dealing with pre-20th Century military operations, herein analysis of the rise of knights out of the Roman collapse, the 40-day feudal obligation and its blending into mercenary and finally professional soldiery, and more as this scholar sought a century ago to glean what could be learned from key battles along the way. Delbrück observations on medieval warfare were controversial. He made a distinction between knights, warriors on horseback, and cavalry and considered the medieval warrior as an independent fighter, unable to form units with a decisive tactical meaning. Subsequent scholars, in particular Belgian historian J.F. Verbruggen, contested these conclusions.

Nicolle, David. *Medieval Warfare Source Book: Warfare in Western Christendom* (London, 1995). This book takes an “everything you want to know” approach and is largely successful for any common reader. The “High Middle Ages” (1100-1275) are detailed also in a section of miscellanea such as how booty was distributed, how prisoners were treated, heraldry and insignia, arms manufacture, and so on. The whole book is very heavily illustrated. A worthy general approach.

Oman, Charles. *A History of the Art of War in the Middle Ages* (London, 1924). Brief, readable, fundamental essay on the nature of medieval warfare, but deemed to overemphasize the role of the heavy knight in obtaining decision on the battlefield and long since superseded by modern scholarship.

Verbruggen, J.F. *The Art of Warfare in Western Europe During the Middle Ages* (1997 translation of 1954 original). The most influential 20th-Century work on the general topic; a corrective to or at least elaboration of Delbrück and Oman regarding, for example, the supremacy of the armored horseman, Verbruggen gave more examination to the impact of a combined arms system of elite cavalry, numerous pike-armed foot soldiers, and supporting archers.

† NFERNO

Front, Sheet 1

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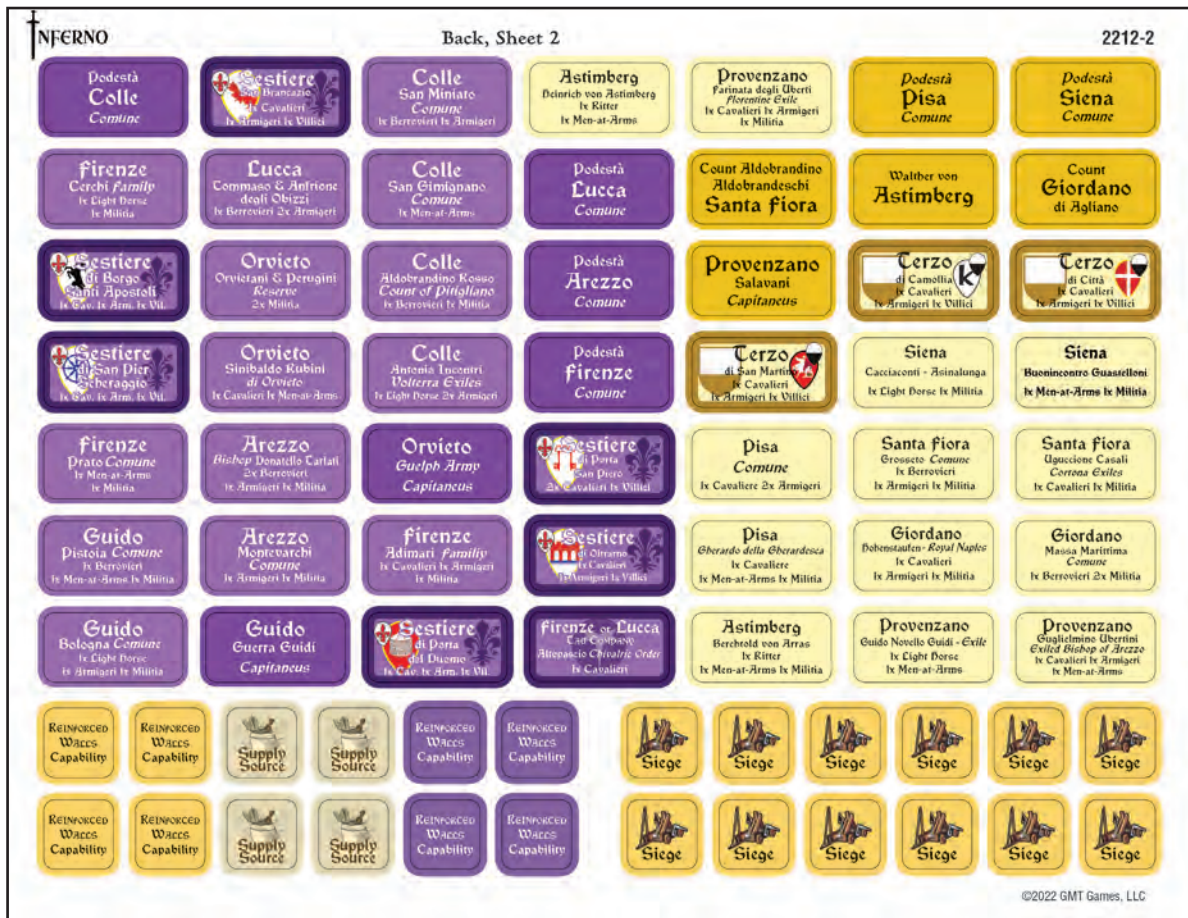
† NFERNO

Back, Sheet 1

2212-1



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† INFERNO

Front, Sheet 3

2212-3

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† INFERNO

Back, Sheet 3

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Arts of War – List

This chart provides at a glance the numbers, titles, and pairings of each side's Arts of War cards.

See pages 33 to 55 for detailed notes on each Event and each Capability.

No.	Guelph Events	Guelph Capabilities	No.	Ghibelline Events	Ghibelline Capabilities
F1	AMBUSH	STORES & WELL WATER	S1	AMBUSH	STORES & WELL WATER
F2	BETRAYALS	GUASTATORI <i>Sappers</i>	S2	BETRAYALS	GUASTATORI <i>Sappers</i>
F3	SURPRISE	SIEGE TOWERS	S3	SURPRISE	SIEGE TOWERS
F4	SUDDEN CLASH	TREBUCHETS	S4	SUDDEN CLASH	TREBUCHETS
F5	ROAD WORKS <i>Woodcutters clear the way</i>	WAR ENGINEERS	S5	ROAD WORKS <i>Woodcutters clear the way</i>	WAR ENGINEERS
F6	HILLS	FEDITORI <i>Vanguard knights</i>	S6	HILLS	FEDITORI <i>Vanguard knights</i>
F7	GREEK FIRE	FEDITORI <i>Vanguard knights</i>	S7	GREEK FIRE	LUCERIA <i>Composite bow archers</i>
F8	SWAMP	BALESTRE GROSSE <i>Large crossbows</i>	S8	SWAMP	BALESTRE GROSSE <i>Large crossbows</i>
F9	GENOVA <i>breaks Pisan blockade</i>	BALESTRIERI <i>Crossbowmen</i>	S9	POPE AT BAY <i>flees to Viterbo</i>	BALESTRIERI <i>Crossbowmen</i>
F10	CLOSED GATES	BALESTRIERI <i>Crossbowmen</i>	S10	A BETTER PAID DEATH	BALESTRIERI <i>Crossbowmen</i>
F11	POGGIO BONIZIO <i>answers Firenze's call</i>	BALESTRIERI <i>Crossbowmen</i>	S11	VOLTERRA	BALESTRIERI <i>Crossbowmen</i>
F12	CAMP ATTACK	ARMY RESERVE	S12	CAMP ATTACK	ARMY RESERVE
F13	NO TIME FOR COWARDS	PALVESARI <i>Shieldmen</i>	S13	GENTLE USILIA <i>ransoms prisoners</i>	PALVESARI <i>Shieldmen</i>
F14	PROVENZANO <i>sent as ambassador</i>	PALVESARI <i>Shieldmen</i>	S14	FRIARS <i>sent to deceive Florentines</i>	PALVESARI <i>Shieldmen</i>
F15	CASOLE	PALVESARI <i>Shieldmen</i>	S15	WAR LOANS	PALVESARI <i>Shieldmen</i>
F16	A BLOODY RED STREAM <i>Desperate stand</i>	ARCIERI <i>Bowmen</i>	S16	BOCCA DEGLI ABATI <i>Florentine betrays Guelphs</i>	ARCIERI <i>Bowmen</i>
F17	FOREIGN HELP	ARCIERI <i>Bowmen</i>	S17	GHIBELLINE REFUGEES	ARCIERI <i>Bowmen</i>
F18	GROSSETO	LA CAVALLATA <i>Long-range raiders</i>	S18	CORTONA	LA CAVALLATA <i>Long-range raiders</i>
F19	VOLTERRA	GUALDANA <i>Horse marauders</i>	S19	BRIGANDS	GUALDANA <i>Horse marauders</i>
F20	HEAT & FROST	MASNADIERI <i>Looters</i>	S20	HEAT & FROST	MASNADIERI <i>Looters</i>
F21	PRIMO POPOLO <i>Guelph merchant class</i>	DISTRINGITORES <i>Officers dress ranks</i>	S21	CONSTITUTO <i>City statute</i>	SOVRINTENDENTE <i>Superintendent of castles</i>
F22	MANFREDI <i>holds back</i>	TAU COMPANY <i>Chivalric order</i>	S22	CLOSED GATES	MANFREDI
F23	TREASURERS	VIA FRANCIGENA <i>Pilgrims' road</i>	S23	ECONOMIC SANCTIONS	TAGLIA <i>Mercenary army</i>
F24	DOCTORS	ASTROLOGERS	S24	DOCTORS	ASTROLOGERS
F25	VAL D'ORCIA <i>War</i>	REINFORCED WALLS	S25	MAREMMA <i>War</i>	REINFORCED WALLS
F26	MONTALCINO <i>War</i>	COSTRUTTORI <i>Master stonecutters</i>	S26	MONTEPULCIANO <i>War</i>	COSTRUTTORI <i>Master stonecutters</i>